Reference Grammar

Contents

Language Reference: Working Sketch

Version: v3 (June 2026) **Predecessor:** v2.7 and earlier — see §9 (Versioning Notes).

A starting-point descriptive grammar for the conlang: an a priori conlang derived from General American English (GA) through a designed cascade of regular sound changes and grammaticalizations. Many features are still under analysis; this document captures current commitments and flags open questions. It is the top-level document of a set — see §8 for the full document hierarchy.

How to read this document set

Conventions used throughout this document and its siblings:

- **GA reconstructions** are written in italics with an asterisk (*sodium*), marking them as the proto-form. **Conlang surface forms** appear in plain italics (working orthography, diacritics included) or in slashes /…/ for phonological discussion.
- **Status tags:** **[Settled]** — committed; downstream design depends on it. **[Provisional]** — current best analysis, expected to hold but open to revision. **[Open]** — explicitly undecided, flagged for future commitment.
- **Examples** aim for a four-line format: conlang orthography, IPA, morpheme-by-morpheme gloss (Leipzig conventions), free translation. Where the conlang surface form is not yet derivable, a GA-calque stand-in is used and flagged [Placeholder: …] — unflagged calques are errors, not data.
- **Glossing** uses the compact tags registered in terminology-registry.md (VOL, NVOL, REC, ITER, VIS, NVIS, HAP, SELF.BEN, THRESH, BACK, …). Running prose spells terms out; each spelled-out term and its gloss tag are paired in the registry.
- **Terminology** follows terminology-registry.md, the canonical registry of the conlang's descriptive terms, their shorthands, and their naming history. A term marked there as retired may appear in older versioning notes but not in current prose.
- A **mora** — the unit of syllable weight, roughly one beat of vowel — appears throughout prosodic discussion: a short vowel is one mora, a long vowel two, a syllabic consonant one.
- **Abstracts and stubs.** Each sibling deep-dive document opens with an architecture-level **Abstract**. Sections of this document whose topic has a sibling contain only an assembly directive and a copy of that Abstract (an *orientation abstract* — non-normative, regenerated from the sibling, never hand-edited). The full grammar PDF is assembled as Part-per-document concatenation; cross-references are filename-based and survive assembly.
- **Analytical notes** (blockquotes beginning *Analytical note* or *Origin*) carry justification, history, and diachronic background. They are skippable: the body prose alone is a complete synchronic description.

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1. Design Philosophy

The conlang's relationship to GA is not one of disguise but of *evolution under controlled conditions*. The intent is that:

- A native GA speaker who hears the conlang cold should not perceive it as English. The phonological distance should sit at roughly the French–Sicilian or Dutch–Swiss-German range, well beyond Spanish–Portuguese.
- The same speaker, given the GA cognate after the fact, should reach an *aha* — a sense that the form follows from regular processes.
- Sound shifts handle vocabulary; vocabulary is therefore *latent* rather than novel. The intellectual ambition lives in the grammar.
- Grammar reshapes the semantic space. New categories — the volitional go-ahead / non-volitional get-oneself system, polarity, and the recognitional-iterative nominal — emerge from grammaticalized GA function-words and phrases, slicing meaning differently than GA does.

The phonology is largely settled in its rule set, though some reanalyses are still being worked through. The grammar is more open and is being refined as design proceeds.

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2. Phonology and Orthography

> **Orientation abstract** — canonical content in phonology.md. This text is copied from that document's Abstract; edit it there, never here.
>
> The phonology derives from General American English through a designed cascade of regular sound changes, frozen at a synchronic stage. Its character: a small, reorganized consonant inventory; widespread vowel clusters and long vowels from intervocalic elision; permissive onsets against restricted codas; post-stress syllabic-consonant material housed in a prosodic appendix; and pitch dissociated from stress, analyzed as the residue of GA prominence after stress migrated to the word-final position. Suprasegmentals — pitch, length, nasalization, breathy voice — do as much expressive work as segments. This document is the canonical reference for the inventories, the syllable and metrical structure, the rule cascade with worked derivations, and the phonological open-questions backlog.

> **Orientation abstract** — canonical content in orthography.md. This text is copied from that document's Abstract; edit it there, never here.
>
> The writing system is Latin script with load-bearing diacritics in the manner of Vietnamese: the marks are not decorative, and ignoring them collapses minimal pairs. Diacritics and digraphs encode vowel length, nasalization, consonant devoicing, gemination, pitch, stress, and pitch-stress coincidence. Several conventions deliberately invert what a GA-literate reader expects, including position-dependent letter values and doubled vowels marking hiatus rather than length. This

document is the canonical reference for the grapheme inventory, the diacritic placement rules, and the open spelling questions.

3. Morphology

This section is more provisional than the phonology, though several pieces are now settled enough to commit. The verb system is treated as a sibling document (verbal-system.md); §3.4 below is its orientation stub.

The noun-side subsections (§3.2 Nouns, §3.3 Adjectives, §3.5 Pronouns, §3.6 Adpositions, §3.7 Demonstratives and topic particles) currently live in this document. If they reach maturity together — most are still light or open — they may spin out into a sibling nominal-system.md parallel to verbal-system.md. §3.7 is the most developed of the set and the natural anchor for that future grouping; pending the spin-out, §3.7 is the *canonical home* for the visibility-particle system and is therefore deeper than this document's usual summary altitude.

3.1 Word-Class Inventory

The major content classes — nouns, verbs, adjectives — are inherited from GA and largely intact, though boundaries blur where grammaticalization has fused phrases.

A closed class of grammaticalized markers carries volition, aspect, polarity, and defective person/number agreement (agreement that is real but does not distinguish every person/number combination). These appear bound to verbs in the **frame** (technically, the light verb complex) and behave as inflection rather than as independent words. A second grammaticalized pair — the **recognitional marker** (from GA *the*) and the **iterative marker** (from GA plural *-s*) — operates on deverbal nominals: morphology in §3.2.1, the construction they build with the frames in verbal-system.md §7 and §12.

3.2 Nouns

Noun morphology in the working draft is light. Number marking is consistent and largely transparent (deriving from GA *-s* and irregular plurals); irregular plurals tend to be preserved or have undergone independent sound changes that obscure the alternation. No derived plural forms have yet been entered in the dictionary to exemplify this. [**Open: example plural pairs pending dictionary work**]

Possession and case-like marking are still under design. Likely candidates for grammaticalization:

- A possessive marker from a fused GA *of*-construction. (Attested possession-adjacent items — *bauyǫ* "my own," *obii* "go by (a name)" — await dictionary entry. [Lexicon: bauyǫ, obii pending])
- Locative/directional case-like elements from prepositions that have phonologically fused with their nominal heads (especially likely given the heavy elision processes).

These remain open pending further design work. A distributive element *-au* (from GA *all*) is attested fused onto object marking (*ŕeushiię·au* "cherishing it all"); its place in number marking is [**Open**]. [Lexicon: -au pending]

3.2.1 The recognitional and iterative markers

Two grammaticalized morphemes operate on **deverbal nominals** — a verb's action treated as a noun:

- **Recognitional marker (REC)** — descended from GA *the*. Marks shared-knowledge type reference: "you know the kind." Not a definite article (verbal-system.md §7.3). Surface forms: *þ* before consonants, *y* /i/ before etymological vowels, inheriting the GA allomorphy.
- **Iterative marker (ITER)** — descended from plural *-s*. Adds a repeated-instances reading on top of the type-marking. Surface form: *-ś*.

They stack productively — REC alone gives shared-knowledge type reference; REC + ITER adds iterated instantiation — and are attested together in *þ rishś* "the dishes (you know the chore)." Glossing pattern: REC-stem-ITER. The construction they build with the verbal frames, and the helper-verb syntax it requires, are described at verbal-system.md §7 and §12; the etymological-doublet origin (GA *the* → referential *o*, recognitional *þ* ~ *y*) is at verbal-system.md §7.3.

Open questions, scoped to the morphology:

- **Does REC occur without ITER productively?** Bare REC (shared-knowledge type, non-iterative) is predicted licit; examples needed. **[Open]**
- **Does ITER occur without REC?** Bears on whether the two morphemes are independent or whether ITER requires REC as a host. **[Open]**
- **Scope of REC and ITER relative to other nominal morphology** (case-like marking, possession). **[Open]**

3.2.2 Definiteness

The GA definite article *the* has not survived as a definite article, and no general definite article has re-emerged. Instead, definiteness is recapitulated across several smaller systems — syntax and pragmatics doing the work GA morphology did:

- **The merged article *o*.** GA *the* (in its referential use) and *a* collapsed into a single article *o*, neutral for definiteness: *Ritm o rhémstwè* "(I) got them the book." Its recognitional sibling *þ* ~ *y* is the other half of the doublet (§3.2.1).
- **The definite-object suffix *-et*** (from GA *it*), fused onto the verb, presupposing an already-established referent: *beuheun nou·et* "went ahead and committed it to memory." **[Provisional — distribution to be confirmed]** [Lexicon: -et pending]
- **The visibility particles** (§3.7) carry referent-tracking and shared-reference signaling through a [±VIS] dimension rather than a [±DEFINITE] one.
- **Dislocated topics are definite.** A topic postposed by right dislocation retains definite coloring even with its visibility particle stripped (§3.7.3).

The result is a definiteness *ecology* rather than a definiteness *category*: no single morpheme answers GA *the*, and learners coming from GA must redistribute its functions across the article, the object suffix, the particles, and topic syntax. **[Provisional as a system statement]**

3.3 Adjectives and Descriptive Modification

Adjective forms inherit largely from GA. Comparative and superlative formation is open. Adjective ordering and stacking conventions are open.

Adjectival predication uses the "on the X side" pattern: *aų* X *hii* — attested in *piies aų nibii hii* "it appears on the nippy side." The pattern combines with both volition axes ("going ahead toward the sick side" vs. "got ourselves on the sick side" — deliberate decline vs. happenstance affliction). [Placeholder: volition-axis examples pending conlang surface forms] The closing element *hii* is plausibly the regular reflex of GA *side* (/s/ → /h/ debuccalization, /aɪ/ → *ii*, final /d/ elided), which would make it homophonous with the see-particle; an alternative reflex *sii* also appears in working notes. **[Open: analysis of predicative *hii/sii* and its homophony with the see-particle]** Because *hii* carries the phrase-final stress, the adjective itself escapes the usual final-stress pattern. [New rule needed: adjective stress under the stress-bearing predicative element]

3.4 Verbs

> **Orientation abstract** — canonical content in verbal-system.md. This text is copied from that document's Abstract; edit it there, never here.
>
> The verbal system grammaticalizes the subject's relationship to the event: every framed verb commits to either the volitional go-ahead frame (the subject deliberately undertook the event) or the non-volitional get-oneself frame (the subject's relationship to the event is qualified in some other way). The go-ahead side is deliberately compact; the get-oneself side is richer, hosting four readings — happenstance, effortful self-benefit, threshold, and backdrop — selected jointly by frame aspect, concord shape, and the verb's own event structure. The frames do not stand alone: they combine with a pronominal system in which pronouns are aspect carriers, while the language's only tense lives in a small class of matrix particles that scaffold whole clauses with modal meaning. A possession construction derives having, getting, choosing, and giving from frame-plus-nominal combination, with the recognitional-iterative nominal as its deverbal special case; three stative-domain strategies carry the meanings the morphology cannot host. This document is the canonical reference for all of these systems; the verb-lexicon-building methodology lives in its Appendix A.

3.5 Pronouns

The pronominal system's canonical home is verbal-system.md §5: pronouns are aspect carriers — fusing aspect, modality, and negation — in weak (clitic) and strong (tonic) paradigms, with left dislocation and a resumptive pronoun as the route by which full noun phrases reach the system. No further content is held here; the §3.4 assembly directive covers the whole verbal-system document.

3.6 Adpositions and Spatial Language

Many GA prepositions have phonologically fused with their hosts and are on a path toward case-like behavior. The full system remains open.

A specific case worth flagging: *with* in the frame's complement structure (see verbal-system.md §12) appears to have grammaticalized from a preposition into a verbal-complementizer-like role. Whether this generalizes to other prepositions, and whether a productive case-like system emerges, is [**Open**].

3.7 Demonstratives and topic particles

The conlang has a closed set of two **visibility particles**, grammaticalized from the imperatives of GA *see* and *know*: the **see-particle** and the **know-particle**. They mark a fronted topic constituent for a [±VIS] feature, where VIS encodes presence and perceptibility while NVIS covers absent, abstract, generic, and discourse-given referents.

This is the second of the language's flagged grammatical innovations on the nominal/discourse side, alongside the recognitional-iterative nominal (verbal-system.md §7). The two systems are orthogonal: REC/ITER is verbal-system morphology operating on deverbal nominals, while the visibility particles are pure information-structure marking on any topic constituent. They can co-occur on the same noun phrase without interaction.

3.7.1 Inventory and forms

The particles are **fossilized**: not verbs, not imperatives, not inflecting. They show a single morphological alternation — a fossilized portmanteau pattern reflecting historical incorporation of the GA article — but speakers do not synchronically decompose the long forms.

Particle	Gloss	Bare form	Article-incorporating form	Clausal form
See-particle (present, perceptible)	VIS	*hii* /hi/	*hiie* /hiɛ/	*hiho* /hiho/
Know-particle (absent, abstract, generic)	NVIS	*no* /no/	*nou* /noː/	*noho* /noho/

The bare form occurs before article-less nominals (proper nouns, pronouns, bare nouns where no article would have been present). The article-incorporating form occurs before what was historically an article-bearing nominal. The clausal form introduces a clausal topic.

The know-particle is homophonous with the **know-that matrix particle** (verbal-system.md §11) but syntactically distinct: matrix *no* takes a noun phrase or a full clause and yields a complete sentence, while topic *no/noho* raises a topic the listener expects elaborated. The two can co-occur — *No Báuyà, no Báuyà* "You know Báuyà? (Well,) I know Báuyà" — topic first, assertion second.

> *Origin.* The GA article *the/a* reduced to schwa in pre-conlang colloquial speech and cliticized onto the preceding particle, where it was absorbed as length (and, for *hii*, as a quality-shifted second mora); the article did not survive as an independent morpheme, and this alternation is its only grammatical residue. The clausal forms arose from fusion with GA *how* (*know how Christmas is coming up*, *see how the americano is steaming*); the fused form is a single unit, unrelated to the article-incorporation pattern. Etymological notes on the individual forms: *no* /no/ < GA *know* /noʊ/ shows shortening below the regular /oʊ/ → /oː/ reflex, attributable to high-frequency

function-word reduction (parallel to the reduction of GA *the* itself). *hii* /hi/ < GA *see* /siː/ shows regular /s/ → /h/ debuccalization (phonology.md §4.1) and the GA-/iː/-as-gliding-/i/ pattern (orthography.md §3.3). *hiie* /hiɛ/ shows /i/-fronting of the absorbed schwa to /ɛ/; the orthographic shape is the first attestation of a diphthongal long vowel (orthography.md §3.3). *noho* and *hiho* preserve the /h/ of GA *how*, which was a strong onset-/h/ of a stressed syllable at the time of fusion.

3.7.2 Function

The particles mark a fronted topic for visibility-deictic information.

See-particle (*hii, hiie*) — the topic referent is present and perceptible to the discourse participants, typically visually but extending to other modalities. Functions as a proximal demonstrative pointing-to-the-immediate, with topic-marking as its discourse role.

Know-particle (*no, nou*) — the topic referent is absent, abstract, generic, or discourse-given. Functions as a distal/abstract demonstrative or "as-for" topicalizer.

The contrast can do real disambiguating work on the same noun phrase, distinguishing physical referent from abstract type:

> *hiie nou·rítuiitsã* — [Placeholder: the form of "violin" awaits dictionary work; the example illustrates the particle contrast] VIS-REC violin "see the violin" — the physical instrument in the room, perceptible
>
> *nou nou·rítuiitsã* — [Placeholder: as above] NVIS-REC violin "know the violin" — the violin-as-skill or violin-as-instrument-type, abstract

Worked examples from each form:

> *hiie* americano today, it would be immaculate — [Placeholder: only the particle is conlang surface] VIS-REC americano today, … "(see) the americano today, it would be immaculate" — the americano is on the counter, visible.
>
> *no* Alice, she is also learning the violin — [Placeholder: only the particle is conlang surface] NVIS Alice, … "(know) Alice, she is also learning the violin" — Alice as topic, not present.
>
> *noho* Christmas is coming up, … — [Placeholder: only the particle is conlang surface] NVIS-CLAUSAL Christmas is coming up, … "(know how) Christmas is coming up, …" — clausal topic, abstract / discourse-introduced proposition.

Pragmatic extensions of the know-particle toward "discourse-given" / "as-we've-been-discussing" readings are expected to develop, parallel to the trajectory of Japanese *wa* and similar topic particles, but are not yet committed.

3.7.3 Syntax and scope

- **Position:** strictly clause-initial. The particle precedes the topic constituent, which precedes the comment — and the whole topic phrase precedes any matrix particle: **topic particle** > **matrix particle** > **clause** (verbal-system.md §11.3).
- **Scope:** marks a single topic constituent — a noun phrase or a clause (the latter via the clausal forms *noho*/*hiho*).
- **Stacking:** multiple topic-particle phrases in sequence are licensed, allowing chained topics with mixed visibility (*hiie* X, *no* Y, …). Worked examples await further data.
- **Negation, questioning, embedding:** the particles do not combine with negation, do not occur in questions, and do not embed under matrix predicates. They are root-clause information-structure marking.
- **Right periphery:** the particles are **left-periphery-only.** A topic postposed after the clause (right dislocation) cannot carry a visibility particle; it is tagged instead with the strong-pronoun *on-X-end* phrase and retains definite coloring (verbal-system.md §5.4). [**Provisional — wants worked conlang examples**]
- **Topic discontinuity:** whether the topic constituent can be discontinuous (split between particle and comment by intervening material) is [**Open**].

3.7.4 Interaction with other systems

- **Recognitional-iterative nominal (verbal-system.md §7):** orthogonal. A topic constituent can independently bear REC and/or ITER on a deverbal nominal head. The particles do not select for or block them.
- **Volition (verbal-system.md §2–3):** orthogonal. Topic-particle marking is on the topic noun phrase or clause, not on the predicate; volition is on the predicate's frame. They co-occur freely.
- **Definiteness:** the visibility particles handle a substantial portion of what GA conveys with the definite article — referent-tracking and shared-reference signaling — but through a [±VIS] dimension rather than a [±DEFINITE] one. The conlang has no definite article and is not expected to develop one; the wider ecology is §3.2.2.
- **Matrix particles (verbal-system.md §11):** the topic phrase precedes the matrix particle, and under the appears particle the choice of visibility particle carries an **evidential division of labor** — *hiie ossii, piies aų nibii hii* "look at the outside — it *looks* nippy" (perceptible evidence) versus *nou ossii, piies aų nibii hii* "you know the outside — it *seems* nippy" (non-perceptible evidence). The GA *look*/*seem* contrast survives as particle choice rather than as two verbs.

3.7.5 Origin

The grammaticalization path *imperative-of-perception-verb* → *demonstrative* / *topic particle* is well-attested cross-linguistically (Latin *ecce*, French *voici/voilà*, similar uses in Mandarin and elsewhere). The visibility distinction is also typologically standard for demonstrative systems with deictic-perceptual marking.

The recruitment of GA *know* into the particle system, rather than into the verbal lexicon, had a side effect on the verb side: the canonical GA stative *know* did not survive as a lexical verb. The gap is filled not by a stative strategy but by a **second, independent grammaticalization of the same etymon** — the know-that matrix particle (verbal-system.md §11), which covers both know-that (full clause) and know-person/thing (noun phrase) with one device. GA *know* thus grammaticalized twice, into the topic layer and the matrix layer, and survives as a verb in neither.

3.7.6 Glossing

- **VIS** — see-particle (perceptible / present topic).
- **NVIS** — know-particle (non-perceptible / abstract / generic topic).

The bare and article-incorporating forms are not separately glossed at the morpheme level — the alternation is fossilized. Where the article-incorporating form occurs, it may optionally be noted as VIS+art or NVIS+art in pedagogical contexts to flag the historical structure. The clausal forms are glossed VIS-CLAUSAL and NVIS-CLAUSAL.

A separate TOP gloss is not used: these particles are inherently topic-marking, and stacking TOP.VIS would be redundant. If the conlang later develops a topic-marking construction without visibility, TOP may be added then.

3.7.7 Open questions

- **Pragmatic know-particle extensions.** Discourse-given vs. discourse-new readings, expected to develop but not yet committed.
- **Stacking patterns.** Worked examples needed to determine whether mixed-visibility chained topics are pragmatically natural and what the ordering constraints are.
- **Topic discontinuity.** Whether material can intervene between the particle-marked topic and the comment.
- **Phonemic status of medial /h/.** See orthography.md §6 history and phonology.md §2.3. Bears on whether *noho* / *hiho* need disambiguating notation.
- **Clausal-form productivity.** Whether *noho* and *hiho* are the only fused-with-*how* clausal particles, or whether further fusions (with *what*, *that*, etc.) might exist or develop.

3.8 Connective particles

A small inventory of discourse connectives has grammaticalized from the perception/attention verbs of the *nouś/not* convergent pair fused with GA *though* and *how* — the same fusion pattern that produced the clausal topic forms *noho/hiho* (§3.7.1):

Particle	GA source	Function
notto	*note though*	adversative — “but, mind you”
nousso	*notice though*	additive — “furthermore, and notice”
not·ho	*note how*	presentative — “voilà, there you have it”

Particle	GA source	Function
nousso	*notice how*	presentative for new, small, or hard-to-perceive referents

The two *nousso* are homophones from distinct fusions; context and what follows (clause vs. referent) disambiguate. [**Provisional — inventory expected to grow**] [Lexicon: notto, nousso (×2), not·ho pending] [New rule needed: intervocalic glottal stop in notto]

> *Origin.* The path parallels §3.7.5: high-frequency perception verbs grammaticalize into discourse particles. Where the visibility particles fossilized imperatives, the connectives fossilize whole hedging collocations (*note though …*), preserving the convergent pair's two stems in their frozen forms.

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4. Syntax

Largely deferred. Working assumptions:

- Word order is broadly SVO, inherited from GA, but topic-prominent fronting may be more common than in GA.
- Question formation beyond yes/no (see verbal-system.md §5.5), relative clauses, and complement clauses are open.
- The interaction of volition marking with subordinate clauses is a question of particular interest — does an embedded verb inherit volition from the matrix, or carry its own? [**Open**] First adjacent data: a clause scaffolded by the end-up matrix particle keeps its own frame but surrenders its **aspect** to the particle's government (verbal-system.md §11.3).
- **Periphery asymmetry:** left dislocation is marked with a visibility particle; right dislocation strips it and is tagged with the strong-pronoun *on-X-end* phrase (§3.7.3; verbal-system.md §5.4). [**Provisional**]
- The argument structure of the frame: bare-nominal complements vs. preposition-mediated complements. [**Open**] See verbal-system.md §4.1.

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5. Semantics and the Lexicon

5.1 The Etymological Engine

The lexicon is generated, not listed. Each entry is fundamentally:

- A **GA etymon** (the proto-form).
- A **gloss** (intended conlang meaning, which may or may not match the GA word's meaning).
- **Semantic drift notes** where the conlang meaning has diverged.

- **Irregular form overrides** for the small number of forms that resist regular derivation.

Surface forms are produced by running the etymon through the sound-change applier. Adjusting a sound rule regenerates surface forms across the lexicon. The dictionary (dictionary.md) is the canonical lexicon record; the methodology for building its verb side is in verbal-system.md Appendix A, with the descriptive-grammar side in verbal-system.md §8.

5.2 The lexicon inherits GA verb uses, not GA verbs

The conlang's verb territory is carved differently from GA: what survives are specific GA *constructions* — shaped by selection (frequency, colloquial grammaticalization, fit with conlang grammar), reanalysis into the conlang's systems, and loss-with-replacement where sound change collapses forms. Homophonous merger from sound change is itself a productive lexical source: the frames and the reading grid do the disambiguating work GA did segmentally. The canonical treatment is verbal-system.md §8.4.

5.3 Productive Semantic Drift

The lexicon is *not* a one-to-one mapping of GA words to conlang forms. Drift is encouraged where it serves the conlang's identity: **narrowing** (*countenance* → *hoʔnʔnts*, "face" specifically), **broadening** (*rhiiynii* extends GA *need* to also cover "want"), **specialization driven by grammar**, and **accretion of grammatical material** into stems (the *rhiiy-* prefix from bleached *really* — fully grammaticalized in *rhiiynii* "to need" and *rhiiysseunnou* "to be different," still transparent in *rhiiyepplii* "to apply oneself" — is the worked example of this stratification). The shift patterns are treated canonically in verbal-system.md §8.4; two lexicon-design notes specific to this document:

- **Productive false friends.** Words that look like their GA cognates but have meaningfully shifted, occasionally in misleading directions. Pedagogically useful: they punish lazy back-translation and reward genuine engagement with the conlang's meanings.
- A small inventory of **"untranslatable" words** — concepts the conlang lexicalizes that GA does not — is a design priority. These anchor the cultural texture of the conlang's setting and require learners to acquire concepts rather than mappings.

5.4 Cultural Embedding

The conlang is spoken by anthropomorphic-animal residents of a planet. Their culture, customs, and social structures are still being designed, but should be reflected in the lexicon's organization:

- Greeting and politeness vocabulary tied to time of day, social distance, or occasion.
- Specialized vocabulary for whatever this culture cares about (a space-station town might have rich vocabulary for travel, weather, supplies, longing).
- Volition-marked idioms that reveal cultural attitudes toward intentionality, accident, and obligation.
- Recognitional-iterative idioms that reveal what shared-knowledge events the speakers treat as cultural touchstones.

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6. Sample Forms

A small handful of attested derivations to anchor the system — **illustrative only**: the canonical records are dictionary.md and the phonology.md §4.5 worked-derivation tables, and this table is regenerated from them rather than maintained independently.

GA etymon	Conlang	Gloss	Notes
sodium	*hoiiǫ*	"salt"	/s/ → /h/; intervocalic /d/ elision; labial /m/ colors schwa to /o/, then elides leaving nasalization
countenance	*hoʔnʔnts*	"face"	Heavy schwa elision; prosodic appendix with multiple syllabic-consonant nuclei
Rochester	*ritsstw*	(toponym)	/st/ → /ts/; vowel elision; appendix /w̩/
carrot	*ŕeut*	"carrot"	M1 rhotic metathesis; /h/ as devoicing feature on tap
today	*ŕe*	"today" / "now!"	Light-monosyllabic foot; high-frequency irregular shifts
pass out	*beussou*	"to fall asleep"	Geminate /sː/ at stressed-syllable boundary; lexical /ʔ/-drop
really need	*rhiiynii*	"to need / want"	/ɪji/-smoothing → /iː/; bleached *really* prefix

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7. Open Questions and Next Commitments

Areas where the grammar is not yet committed:

- **Pitch contrastiveness** (placement is settled); the phonology.md §5 backlog, including the /ai/ conditioning bucket and the compound-junction rules.
- **Number marking** and basic noun morphology. **Politeness register** and greeting forms. **Numerals.**
- **Adjective system**, ordering, and modification.

- **Locative/directional case-like marking; motion verb morphology.**
- **Imperatives**; sequential connectives (a first connective inventory is at §3.8; sequencing/then-words remain open).
- **Nominal possession marking** (predicative possession is settled — verbal-system.md §12), **relative-clause-like constructions**, **descriptive extension.**
- **Aspect system** in extended discourse.
- **Volition paradigm refinement** (reading-inventory unification, self-benefit billing, stative-strategy frequency); **polarity reconciliation** with the cell × reading structure; **concord affix inventory and surface forms**; **frame argument structure**; **nested negation glossing convention**. See verbal-system.md §9 and §10.
- **Surface forms of the concord endings** — the highest-priority example gap (verbal-system.md §4.2, §14).
- **Written register**, formal vs. casual contrasts.

Each commitment, once made, is recorded in the affected document's §"Versioning Notes" entry with date and reasoning, and its consequences are propagated through the lexicon engine.

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8. Methodological Note

This document is a living specification, refined as design proceeds and explicitly versioned. It serves three purposes simultaneously: a working reference for the designer, the canonical context to feed into LLM-assisted conlang reasoning, and the seed of an eventual full descriptive grammar.

The project's current document set:

- **language_reference.md** (this document) — top-level descriptive grammar. Carries the front matter, the design philosophy, orientation stubs for the sibling documents, and canonical content for topics without a sibling (nominal morphology, syntax, the lexicon framework, the visibility particles).
- **phonology.md** — full phonological reference. Inventory, sound-change rules, derivational cascade, metrical analysis.
- **orthography.md** — full orthographic reference. Diacritic conventions, length and gemination conventions, pitch and nasalization placement.
- **verbal-system.md** — full reference for the verbal system. Go-ahead and get-oneself paradigms and frame forms (§2–§4); the pronominal system (§5); stative-domain strategies (§6); recognitional-iterative nominal (§7); verbs and the verbal system (§8); open questions (§9); polarity and negation (§10); matrix particles (§11); possession construction (§12); mood (§13); assembled clauses (§14); verb-lexicon methodology (Appendix A).
- **terminology-registry.md** — canonical registry of descriptive terminology: each term's shorthand, gloss tag, plain-language definition, status, and full naming history.
- **dictionary.md** — the lexicon, with per-entry sound-change derivations and a running changelog.
- **skills/dictionary-updater.md** — the procedure for adding dictionary entries. Invoked with "Let's update the dictionary"; see CLAUDE.md "Skills."

- **skills/reference-grammar-section-drafting-and-integration.md** — the procedure for drafting and integrating reference-grammar sections, including the house-style canon this document set follows.
- **verb-paradigm-verdict.md** — sibling working note: cell-by-cell predictions and analytical history for the verbal-system paradigm.
- **translation-frequency-task.md** — instrument for gathering usage-weighted data on stative-strategy frequency, reading-inventory unification, and other open questions in verbal-system.md §9.

Superseded documents

- **verb-terminology.md** (May 2026, retired) — superseded by verbal-system.md. The terminology committed there is preserved through terminology-registry.md, which also records the subsequent renames. The file is no longer maintained.

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9. Versioning Notes

v3.2, June 2026 — nominal and discourse integration (Session L)

§3.2 gains §3.2.1 (REC/ITER morphology — canonical home migrated from verbal-system.md §7.1/§7.4 per the demotion decision; surface forms *þ* ~ *y*, *-ś*; the three morphology-scoped open questions travel with it) and §3.2.2 (the definiteness ecology: merged article *o*, definite-object suffix *-et* [Provisional], visibility-particle givenness, definite coloring of dislocated topics). Possession bullet gains attested-items flags; distributive *-au* flagged. **§3.3** gains the *aų* X *hii* adjectival-predication pattern with the *hii* < *side* analysis flagged [Open] and the adjective-stress rule flagged for phonology. **§3.7**: homophony note for the know-that matrix particle (3.7.1); topic > matrix particle ordering and the right-periphery restriction (3.7.3); matrix-particle interaction bullet with the evidential division of labor (3.7.4); the verb-side *know* gap **closed** in 3.7.5 (filled by the know-that matrix particle — GA *know* grammaticalized twice and survives as a verb in neither layer) and removed from 3.7.7. **New §3.8** connective particles (*notto*, *nousso* ×2, *not·ho*). **§4** gains the periphery asymmetry and the matrix-government data point. §3.1, §3.6 pointers updated; §7 list adjusted (connectives, possession). Spin-out to nominal-system.md deliberately **not** executed: §3's own trigger ("the noun-side subsections reach maturity together") is unmet — possession, case, and plurals remain open. Sources: 2026-06-10 translation exercise; phase4-triage-2026-06.md §3; verbal-system v2.1.

v3.1, June 2026 — cross-reference sweep for verbal-system v2.1

Cross-references to verbal-system.md updated for its v2.1 renumbering (former §11–§14 → §13–§16, accommodating new §11 The matrix particles and §12 The possession construction): §7 open-questions list (REC/ITER surface-form gap removed — closed by verbal-system v2.1; concord-endings gap retained), §8 document list, §9 prior-note pointer (§14 → §16). The §3.4 stub regenerated by re-copying the revised verbal-system Abstract (which the source document had lost while the stub retained the v2 copy — drift incident recorded in verbal-system v2.1). The REC/ITER morphology migration remains with the nominal-side session.

v3, June 2026 — conformance pass: house-style canon and terminology registry adopted

Stub-abstract model adopted (second pass on this draft, user decision June 2026). §2 (retitled "Phonology and Orthography") and §3.4 converted from hand-maintained summaries to generated stubs — an assembly directive plus a copy of the sibling document's new Abstract; §3.5 converted to a plain pointer stub (the §3.4 directive covers verbal-system.md §5). Internal references into the removed §2.x/§3.4.x subsections retargeted at the siblings. §6 marked illustrative-only. The model is specified in skill v1.1 §1.5; the assembly script is pending.

Front matter added. A new unnumbered "How to read this document set" section consolidates the reading apparatus (etymon convention, status tags, four-line example format, gloss-tag channel, registry pointer, mora paraphrase, analytical-note convention). Section numbering is unchanged.

Terminology. All prose normalized to terminology-registry.md (June 2026 batch): *volitional go-ahead* / *non-volitional get-oneself* (shorthands *go-ahead* / *get-oneself*) replace *volitive* / *non-volitive*; *frame* and *frame aspect* replace prose *LVC* and *LVC.TAM*; the four readings are named *happenstance*, *effortful self-benefit*, *threshold*, *backdrop* (replacing PH/AB/INC/PS); *iterative marker* (ITER) replaces nominal *HAB*; §3.4.5 retitled *recognitional-iterative*; the visibility particles gain the prose names *see-particle* and *know-particle* (gloss tags VIS/NVIS unchanged); *prosodic appendix* used where document appendices are in scope.

Voice. Project-history narration removed from body prose: the document opener no longer narrates the latest revision; the *sesquisyllabic* retirement parenthetical is dropped from §2.2 (record remains in phonology.md); §3.7's etymological and grammaticalization material is consolidated under marked *Origin* blocks (§3.7.1, §3.7.5). A surviving mini-game reference in §4 ("storyteller, mystery, and letter-writing games") is removed, completing the v2.3 cleanup.

Deduplication. §5.2 and §5.3 trimmed to summaries pointing at the new canonical home verbal-system.md §8.4 (selection/reanalysis/loss and the semantic shift patterns); §5.3 retains only the lexicon-design notes specific to this document (false friends, untranslatables) and the *rhiiy-* worked example.

Examples and flags. GA-calque examples flagged [Placeholder: ...] throughout (§3.4.3, §3.4.5, §3.7.2). New [Open] flags: example plural pairs (§3.2); REC/ITER and concord surface forms promoted into §7 as the highest-priority example gaps. §3.4.3's worked example upgraded to use the attested pronoun and frame forms.

§8 document set updated. Added terminology-registry.md and skills/reference-grammar-section-drafting-and-integration.md; verbal-system.md entry updated to its v2 section layout; superseded-documents entry simplified to point at the registry.

Staleness repairs. §2.1, §2.4, and §7 updated to reflect the phonology.md v2.3 closures (single phonemes /ɪ/ and /ɑ/ with [ɨ]/[ɔ] allophones; nasalization phonemic; breathy voice allophonic) that the v2.x summaries had not absorbed; the *sodium* headword updated from stale *hoiom* to the committed *hoiię̨* /ˈhoiõ/ in §2.2 and §6.

Cross-references. verbal-system.md §A.3 references updated to §6/§A.3 per that document's v2; §3.7.5's strategy pointer now cites §6. No section renumbering in either document.

v2.7, May 2026 — pronominal system summary added; verbal-system cross-references updated

§3.5 Pronouns expanded. The two-sentence placeholder is replaced by a proper high-level summary pointing at verbal-system.md §5 (The Pronominal System, added in verbal-system v1.3). Commitments documented: weak vs. strong pronoun paradigms; pronouns as aspect carriers; GO-AHEAD animacy agreement vs. GET-ONESELF person/number agreement; bare, imperfect, modal (would/could), and n't.quite negative fusions; restriction of modal fusions to pronouns; 2PL/3PL syncretism at modal/negative cells; strong pronoun three-reading system from GA *on* [*POSS*] *end*; intonation-only interrogative with *ea* particle [Provisional]; left dislocation with resumptive pronouns [Settled]; pro-drop and WERE irrealis [Open].

Cross-references to verbal-system.md updated throughout to reflect v1.3 renumbering (former §5–§13 shifted to §6–§14 to accommodate new §5): §6→§7 (recognitional-habitual), §7→§8 (verbs and verbal system), §8→§9 (open questions), §9→§10 (polarity), §13→§14 (versioning notes). Updated in §3.2, §3.4.4, §3.4.5, §5.1, §7, §8 document list, §8 superseded docs, and prior versioning notes.

v2.6, May 2026 — pitch-residue summary propagation; skill pointer

§2.2 pitch summary updated. Propagates the v2.2 pitch-residue reframing from phonology.md §3.4. The placement claim (pitch on the syllable that carried GA primary stress) is unchanged. The summary now: drops the "separate prosodic dimension" framing; mentions the residue analysis (pitch as F0 residue of GA-style prominence after loudness and length transfer to the final vowel under final-stress); makes the etymologically-determined / not-synchronically-derivable distinction explicit, with the English lexical-stress comparison; and notes that low minimal-pair density is structurally expected under the residue analysis and is not on its own evidence about contrastiveness. Detail is held in phonology.md §3.4 per the no-duplication-upward rule; the §2.2 entry stays high-level.

§8 document set list updated. dictionary-updater.md was previously listed as out-of-tree. It is now in-tree as skills/dictionary-updater.md and the entry is repointed accordingly with a brief note pointing at CLAUDE.md's "Skills" section for invocation.

v2.5, May 2026 — verb-recipe folded into verbal-system Appendix A

Cross-references repointed. verb-recipe.md (formerly out-of-tree sibling working note) is now folded into verbal-system.md as Appendix A (see verbal-system.md v1.2 changelog). Repointed in lang_ref: - §5.1 methodology pointer: "in verb-recipe.md" → "in verbal-system.md Appendix A". - §3.7.5 stative-strategy reference: verb-recipe-v2.md §3 → verbal-system.md §A.3. - §3.7.7 verb-side gap question: same. - §8 document set list: verb-recipe.md line removed (no longer a sibling).

v2.4, May 2026 — cross-document propagation and nominal-spinout placeholder

§2.1 long-vowel summary updated. Reflects the diphthongal long-vowel admission from orthography.md v2.1 and propagates the parallel inventory addition in phonology.md v2.1: long vowels are now framed as bimoraic nuclei in two surface types (monophthongal /iː, ɛː, oː, aː, ɨː/ and diphthongal /iɛ/).

§3 lead paragraph anticipates a nominal-system spinout. Notes that §3.4 is the verb-side summary pointing to verbal-system.md and that the noun-side subsections (§3.2, §3.3, §3.5, §3.6, §3.7) may eventually spin out into a sibling nominal-system.md once they mature together. §3.7 is identified as the natural anchor for that grouping; it stays in lang_ref pending the rest catching up.

v2.3, May 2026 — pedagogical-game references stripped

Rationale. The grammar is now treated as a self-standing descriptive reference rather than as the language layer of an in-development game. References to the game, its mini-games, the player, and the in-world setting are removed throughout. The substantive content — open questions, design priorities, cultural-embedding gestures — is preserved on its own terms.

§7 restructured. The numbered list "in roughly the order they will be forced by the mini-game build sequence" is converted to a bulleted list of "areas where the grammar is not yet committed." Question groupings are preserved verbatim; the parenthetical mini-game labels (*phonology mini-game*, *ice cream shop*, *market*, *delivery*, *kitchen*, *lost-and-found*, *storyteller*, *mystery / witness*, *letter-writing*) are removed. The closing sentence on changelog protocol is rewritten to reference §"Versioning Notes" entries directly rather than the mini-game cadence.

Smaller deletions. Sentences referencing mini-game forcing are removed or reworded in §2.3, §3.2, §3.3, §3.5, §3.6, §5.3, and §5.4. The §8 closing reference to "in-world artifacts the player can read in the game's school and library" is dropped.

v2.2 changelog entry trimmed. The §3.7 changelog bullet on open questions is reworded to drop the "mini-game build sequence" framing while preserving the substance (questions are scoped to §3.7, not promoted to §7).

Cross-document consequences. Parallel cleanup is applied to CLAUDE.md, orthography.md §5, verbal-system.md (three open-question entries), and a dictionary.md entry note. See each affected file's own §"Versioning Notes" where applicable.

v2.2, May 2026 — visibility-marked topic particles

New §3.7 Demonstratives and topic particles. Documents a closed set of two visibility-marked topic particles, grammaticalized from the imperatives of GA *see* and *know* and marking a fronted topic for [±VIS] (perceptibility-deictic). The set has fossilized bare, article-incorporating, and clausal forms (*hii*/*hiie*/*hiho*; *no*/*nou*/*noho*), reflecting historical incorporation of the GA article and of *how*. Sits alongside the recognitional-habitual nominal (§3.4.5) as the second flagged grammatical innovation on the nominal/discourse side; the two systems are orthogonal.

§3.2 definiteness paragraph revised. The closing sentence on definite reference is rewritten to point at the visibility-particle system as handling a substantial portion of the work, with the [Open] tag removed since a real mechanism is now in place.

Open questions added. Six new questions are flagged in §3.7.7: pragmatic NVIS extensions, stacking patterns, topic discontinuity, the *know*-as-stative verb-side gap, phonemic status of medial /h/ (cf. orthography.md §6), and clausal-form productivity. They are scoped to §3.7 and not promoted to §7.

Cross-document propagation. The orthographic shape *hiie* /iɛ/ forced the diphthongal long-vowel admission in orthography.md v2.1 (§3.3) — a generalization of the long-vowel system to two surface types (monophthongal and diphthongal). The *noho*/*hiho* medial-/h/ pattern raised a new open question on phonemic /h/ vs. breathy voice in orthography.md §6.

v2.1, May 2026 — verbal-system spinout

Verbal system spun out to sibling document. A new document verbal-system.md has been created as a sibling to phonology.md and orthography.md. The verbal-system-description session of May 2026 produced a substantially refined paradigm structure (volitive vs. non-volitive, with four sub-modalities, two structurally blocked cells, and three stative-domain strategies) that warrants treatment as an independent reference.

§3.4 Verbs trimmed to high-level summary. Five subsections (§3.4.1–§3.4.5): tense-as-aspect; the volition system; the LVC and concord; polarity (new flag); the recognitional-habitual nominal. The verb-volition typology, deverbal nominal layer, and mood subsection from v2 §3.4 moved to verbal-system.md.

Terminology shift: involitive → non-volitive. The v2 document used *involitive* (sourced from Sinhala) as the marked term opposite *volitive*. The May 2026 verbal-system-description session worked with *modulated* as a positively-named alternative. v2.1 adopts *non-volitive* — privatively named for readability, with the principled-asymmetry argument preserved in prose framing rather than encoded in the term. See verbal-system.md §16 for the full terminology history.

Polarity preserved with reconciliation flag. v2 §3.4.2 had a four-cell VOL/INVOL × POS/NEG grid as the central organizing structure. In v2.1, polarity is preserved as a separate grammatical dimension (§3.4.4) but flagged as needing reconciliation with the cell × sub-modality structure described in verbal-system.md. The polarity discussion proper lives in verbal-system.md §10.

Recognitional-habitual moved. The full discussion of REC and HAB, including the DEF → REC grammaticalization and its open questions, has moved to verbal-system.md §7. A summary remains in language reference §3.4.5.

Document set list updated (§8). Added verbal-system.md, verb-paradigm-verdict.md, and translation-frequency-task.md to the sibling-document list. Marked verb-terminology.md as superseded; verb-recipe.md confirmed as sibling working note.

Open questions list updated (§7). Item 8 (mystery/witness commitments) expanded to reflect the new structure: sub-modality unification, AB billing, stative-strategy frequency, polarity reconciliation, concord affix inventory, LVC argument structure, nested negation glossing.

v2, May 2026

Verb-terminology integration (volitive/involitive committed; LVC, concord affixes, REC/HAB committed); pitch-revision integration; phonology summary harmonized with phonology.md v2 and orthography.md v2.

See full v2 changelog in earlier versions.

v1 (original)

Original document. Established the design philosophy (§1), the phonology summary (§2), the morphology sketch (§3) with volition system and nested negation, the lexicon framing (§5), and the sample-forms anchor (§6).

Phonology Reference

Version: v2.4 (May 2026) **Predecessor:** v2.2 (pitch-residue reframing); v2.1 (diphthongal long vowel /iɛ/, audience-fit reframings); v2 (top-down reorganization and dictionary-batch closures); v1 (original).

This v2.2 revision reframes pitch in §3.4 as the **phonetic residue of GA-style prominence** after stress migrated to the final vocalic position, rather than as an independently assigned prosodic dimension. The placement rule is unchanged; the analytical framing is sharpened, and a structural account of why minimal pairs are scarce is added. §1.1, §2.3, §4.4.5 (S3), and §5 are updated to align. Specific changes are listed in §7 (Versioning Notes).

Status tags used throughout:

- [**Settled**] — committed; downstream design depends on it.
- [**Provisional**] — current best analysis; expected to hold but open to revision.
- [**Open**] — explicitly undecided; flagged for future commitment.

GA reconstructions appear in italics with an asterisk (*sodium*). Surface forms appear in slashes (/…) for phonemes or in plain italics for the working orthography.

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1. The phonology in outline

1.1 Character of the system

The conlang's phonology has a recognizable shape that organizes most of what follows. Five interlocking choices define it.

Small consonant inventory, reorganized. GA's consonant set has been substantially reduced through targeted mergers — /d, dʒ, n, j, g, v/ collapsed into a tap, /m, p/ into /b/ in onset, /f/ into /θ/, /s/ debuccalized to /h/. The surviving inventory is smaller than GA's, but distributed in unfamiliar ways: most of the segments occur in GA, but their distribution and patterning are foreign.

Vowel-cluster-friendly. Intervocalic consonant elision has produced widespread vowel hiatus, long vowels from smoothing, and diphthongs from reanalysis. Where GA has a single intervocalic consonant, the conlang often has a long vowel or an open hiatus. *sodium* /ˈsoʊdiəm/ → *hoiom* /ˈhoiom/ is canonical.

Cluster-permissive in onsets, restricted in codas. Long onset clusters survive (*ritsstw* "Rochester"); coda phonotactics is tighter, with most coda consonants reduced to /ʔ/ or eliminated outright. The asymmetry is a familiar one cross-linguistically; the closest natural-language parallel is Ancient Greek (cluster-permissive onsets, /n, r, s/-only codas), though the conlang's coda restrictions are even tighter.

Post-stress consonantal appendix. A subset of words have substantial syllabic-consonant material *after* the stressed vowel — *Jennifer* /ˈrɛ̃ːθw̩/, *countenance* /ˈhoʔn̩ʔn̩ts/, *Rochester* /ˈritsstw̩/. This material is weight-bearing (the syllabic consonants are moraic) but stress-invisible (primary stress stays on the leftmost full vowel). Earlier drafts called this *sesquisyllabic*; that label is misapplied (see §3.5) and the structurally accurate term is *appendix*.

Pitch-stress dissociation. Stress falls on the final vocalic position; pitch sits on the syllable that carried primary stress in the GA etymon. These are usually different syllables, producing the characteristic shape of *Emma* /ɛma/ — pitch on the first vowel, stress on the second. The two are best analyzed not as independently assigned features but as a redistribution of GA prominence across the word: loudness and length transfer to the final vowel under the conlang's final-stress rule, while F0 stays behind on the etymological-stress syllable as residue. See §3.4.

The unifying thread is that suprasegmentals do as much expressive work as segments. Pitch, length, nasalization, and breathy voice are all phonemically active; the orthography reflects this with a load of diacritics that are not decorative. A reader treating the diacritics as ornamental will collapse pairs the language treats as fully distinct.

1.2 How this differs from GA

The conlang's prosodic and segmental shape inverts GA almost completely.

GA is stress-timed, with aggressive vowel reduction in unstressed positions, initial-leaning stress, default trochaic feet (DUM-bah), and stress as the primary locus of prominence. The conlang is closer to syllable-timed, with the GA reductions *frozen into the surface lexicon* rather than performed live. Stress is final, the default foot is iambic (bah-DUM), and pitch carries a melodic dimension that GA does not have. A GA listener hears the conlang's segmental material as recognizable but the rhythmic shape as foreign — which is exactly the design intent.

Three further inversions worth flagging up front:

- **Schwa is not a reduction vowel.** GA's pervasive schwa has either been absorbed into long vowels (smoothing), elided (creating consonant clusters and syllabic consonants), or strengthened to /a/ or /ɛ/ depending on position. Where GA distributes schwa across most unstressed syllables, the conlang has none.
- **The rhotic system is reorganized.** GA's single rhotic /ɹ/ has split into a tapped /ɾ/ and a retroflex /ɻ/, with /ɻ/ becoming /ɾ/ near another /ɾ/ (alveolar wins). Where GA uses /ɹ/ for /d, dʒ, n, j, g, v/-mergers, the conlang uses the tap.
- **Coda /ʔ/ is stable.** GA's variable /t/-glottalization has phonologized: /ʔ/ is the regular reflex of GA coda /t/, and it does not elide further (with one lexical exception, see §4.4).

1.3 Typological position and stability

> *Background section.* This subsection situates the conlang within natural-language typology and is intended for readers interested in the analytical justification or the design context. It is *not* required for using or learning the language; readers focused on inventory and rules can skip to §2.

The system is naturalistic but unusual. Each component sits in attested typological territory; the assembly is not exactly matched by any single natural language.

The closest precedents:

- **Tashlhiyt Berber** for the segment inventory in syllabic-consonant position. Tashlhiyt licenses almost any segment, including voiceless obstruents, as a syllabic nucleus (*tkkst stt*, *tftktstt*). The conlang's appendix nuclei /s, θ, ʔ/ sit in the same low-sonority range that has driven Tashlhiyt's analytical literature.
- **Nuxalk (Bella Coola)** for the upper bound on appendix length. Nuxalk's all-consonant words (*xɬp'χʷɬtʰɬpʰɬːskʷʰt͡s'*) demonstrate that low-sonority syllabicity is attested at substantial length. The conlang's *countenance* /ˈhoʔn̩ʔn̩ts/ — four post-stress nuclei depending on parse — sits within this range.
- **English and Slavic languages** for the structural mechanism. English *rhythm* /ˈɹɪð.m̩/, *button* /ˈbʌʔ.n̩/, *little* /ˈlɪɾ.l̩/, plus Czech and Polish post-stress syllabic liquids, are the direct structural parallel: weight-bearing post-stress syllabic-sonorant material that does not compete for stress. The standard analysis is *appendix adjunction* (Selkirk, Itô-Mester), the same mechanism this document adopts in §3.5.
- **Ancient Greek** for the segmental-prosodic combination. Greek's /s/-debuccalization (*hex* < *seks*), pitch accent on a vowel-quantity-contrasting system, and cluster-permissive-onsets-with-strict-codas asymmetry are the closest segmental-and-prosodic parallel to the conlang's overall shape.

Other resonances that surface in the design but aren't structural matches: Hawaiian and Japanese for vowel-cluster tolerance; Latin → Modern Parisian French as a diachronic-feel model (dramatic reduction producing a barely-recognizable daughter); Vietnamese for the orthographic philosophy of load-bearing diacritics; Swedish for the prosodic-overlay sensibility (geminates and pitch coexisting on a stress system); Arapaho and Minnesota Ojibwe for the small-inventory + length + pitch combination.

The combination most distinctive to the conlang — Polynesian-style vowel hiatus and small consonant inventory **with** Salishan-style syllabic obstruents and clusters **with** Swedish-style pitch overlay **with** Vietnamese-style diacritic load — is hard to find a direct natural-language match for. Each piece has clear precedent; the assembly is unusual.

On stability. Languages with rich post-stress syllabic-consonant tails tend to evolve in one of two directions: further reduction (the appendix nuclei elide or merge into the preceding coda) or secondary-stress development (some appendix nucleus acquires its own foot). Old English's *-ende* participles reduced to modern *-ing*; Latin post-stress material became Spanish secondary stress. The conlang's current state is best read as a **synchronic snapshot of a language mid-restabilization** — captured at a moment after aggressive schwa elision has produced the appendix material, but before the typologically-expected next step has occurred. This framing aligns with the conlang's stated diachronic origin story (regular sound changes from GA producing the surface forms) and gives the document a coherent answer to "is this naturalistic?"

For a conlang fixed at a synchronic stage, this is not a problem. The diachronic story produces exactly the right origin for a system at this stage: regular sound changes from a recognizable source language, stopped before they have run further to completion.

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2. Inventories

2.1 Consonants

Stops: /b, t, ʔ/. **[Settled]**

Note on /k/: surface [k] occurs only in /kj, kw/ clusters. The current working analysis is that **/k/ is not a phoneme**: surface [kj, kw] are allophonic realizations of underlying /hj, hw/, with [k] arising as fortition of /h/ before a glide. **[Provisional, under analysis]**

Coda /ʔ/ is the most stable coda segment in the language and serves as a reliable anchor in derivations. It does not elide under the regular rules; one lexical exception applies (see §4.4). **[Settled]**

Fricatives: /θ, h, ts, s/. **[Settled]**

- /h/ derives from GA /s/ via debuccalization in most positions, and from GA onset /k/ in parallel.
- /ts/ derives from the historical /st/ cluster.
- /s/ as a phoneme survives in contexts where the historical /st/ produced it (taking the synchronic place of /s/ in clusters), and in geminate /sː/ position (see below).

Geminates: /sː, nː, pː/ are attested as a sub-inventory.

Geminates arise from two diachronic feeds:

1. **Phonologization of GA ambisyllabic consonants** in stressed-second-syllable environments. *beussou* /ˌbɛːˈsːoː/ "to fall asleep" (< *pass out*) and *epplii* /ˈɛpːli/ "to apply" both phonologize the slight gemination GA already has at these boundaries.
2. **Cluster collapse.** *rhiiysseunnou* /ɹ̥iːsːɛːnːoː/ "to be different" shows /nd/ in coda → /nː/ by regressive assimilation (/d/ → /n/, then geminate). The same form's /sː/ comes from GA /st/ at a stressed-syllable boundary.

The /s/ → /sː/ rule at syllable boundary preceding stress is in tension with the more general /s/ → /h/ debuccalization rule; the gemination wins in this specific environment. See §4.4 for the rule.

Nasals: /n, m/. **[Settled]**

Liquids/Tap: /r/ (tapped), /l/ (clusters only), /ɹ̥/ (assimilates to /r/ near another /r/). **[Settled]**

Glides as syllabic consonants: /w, j/ — occur as unstressed allophones of /o, i/ in syllabic-consonant position. **[Settled, per current note]**

Syllabic consonants generally: /n, m, s, θ, ʔ, w, j/ — and possibly /r/. These segments occur as syllabic nuclei in **appendix position** (post-stress, foot-external; see §3.5). They are moraic but stress-invisible. **[Provisional]**

Voiceless sonorants: /n̥, m̥, ɾ̥/ exist as distinct surface forms, arising from elided coda obstruents and from the M1 mechanism (see §4.4). The orthography marks devoicing with an acute accent on the consonant.

Aspiration is treated as fully allophonic (English-style: voiceless stops aspirate in stressed onsets) and is not represented orthographically. **[Settled]**

Notable gaps relative to GA. Sounds present in GA but absent here: /k, dʒ, tʃ, ʒ, g, ŋ, v, f, d, p, ʊ, ʌ, u/. Most have specific merger paths (see §4.4). /k/'s "absence" is the analytical move — surface [k] in /kj, kw/ is reanalyzed as allophonic /h/ + glide. **[Settled, with /k/ analysis Provisional]**

2.2 Vowels

Short: /i, ɪ, ɛ, o, ɑ/ **[Settled]**

The /i/ vs. /ɪ/ contrast deserves a note: /i/ is the short tense vowel inherited from GA "long-e" /ɪi/, with its gliding quality preserved synchronically. It is a single nucleus, not a sequence. The orthography spells this ii (see *Orthography Reference* §3.2 for the contrast with hiatus iyi and with long /iː/ iiy).

Long: Bimoraic nuclei in two surface types. **[Settled]**

- *Monophthongal long vowels.* /iː, ɛː, oː, aː, ɨː/. Both morae carry the same vowel quality; the IPA carries ː. These arise from intervocalic-consonant elision plus smoothing, and from reanalysis of historical diphthongs. **/iː/ is a phoneme** of the conlang, arising principally from /ɪji/-smoothing (the /ɫ/-glide-becoming pathway, e.g., *Emily* /ˈɛməli/ → /ɛˈmiː/, *rhiiynii* /ɻiːni/ "to need" < *really need*). It is spelled iiy orthographically.
- *Diphthongal long vowels.* /iɛ/ is the first attested case: a bimoraic nucleus whose two morae carry different vowel qualities (here /i/ and /ɛ/). The IPA does *not* carry ː — the second-quality vowel is what makes the digraph bimoraic. /iɛ/ arises from /i/-fronting of an absorbed schwa: a base vowel /i/ absorbs a following schwa as length, with the schwa raising to /ɛ/ under the influence of the preceding /i/ rather than smoothing into pure length. Attested in *hiie* /hiɛ/ "(see), VIS-REC" (cf. language_reference.md §3.7). Spelled iie orthographically. Additional diphthongal long-vowel digraphs (e.g., /io/ as iio) are predictable by analogy but currently unattested. **[Open: whether other /i/-initial diphthongal long vowels occur]**

Diphthongs (monomoraic): /ei, oe, ia/ **[Settled]**

The conlang has two diphthong classes, distinguished by mora count: monomoraic diphthongs above (with /j/ or vocalic glide as the consonantal second element) and bimoraic *diphthongal long vowels* under "Long" (with a vocalic second mora). The contrast ei /ei/ (monomoraic) vs. iie /iɛ/ (bimoraic) is the cleanest minimal pair for the distinction. See orthography.md §3.3–3.4.

Suprasegmental contrasts on vowels: see §2.3.

2.3 Suprasegmental contrasts on vowels

Vowels contrast in nasalization, breathy voice, and pitch in some environments. All three arose from elided coda consonants (nasals, /h/, weak obstruents) leaving residual features on adjacent vowels.

- **Nasalization** is phonemic. **[Settled]**
- **Breathy voice** is not phonemic — the VhV surface pattern is an allophonic realization, not a contrast in the inventory. **[Settled]** Medial /h/ in fused-function-word contexts (*noho*, *hiho*) has the same allophonic status; the proposed phonemic distinction (VhV consonantal vs. VhU breathy) is not adopted.

- **Pitch accent** is dissociated from stress in placement (see §3.4). Placement is settled: pitch sits on the syllable that carried primary stress in the GA etymon. The placement is **etymologically determined** (fully derivable from the etymon) but **not synchronically derivable** (a speaker without etymological access has to know it word by word, the same epistemic status English lexical stress has). Contrastiveness — whether minimal pairs distinguishable only by pitch placement actually exist — is **[Open]** pending audio-recorded verification.

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3. Syllable and metrical structure

3.1 Syllable structure and phonotactics

The language permits both substantial vowel clusters (*hoiom* /ˈhoiom/ "salt" < *sodium*) and substantial consonant clusters (*hoʔnʔnts* /ˈhoʔn̩ʔn̩ts/ "face" < *countenance*; *ritsstw* /ˈritsstw̩/ "Rochester"). The two distributions arise from different processes: vowel clusters from intervocalic consonant elision (§4.4 E1), consonant clusters from systematic schwa elision (§4.4 E3).

Onset phonotactics is permissive. Long onset clusters survive, including sequences violating sonority sequencing in moderate ways. The /st/ → /ts/ shift produced /ts/-onsets that are phonotactically normal in the conlang but unusual cross-linguistically.

Coda phonotactics is restrictive. Most coda consonants have either elided outright (the /l, d/-paths in §4.4), reduced to /ʔ/ (the /t/-path), or assimilated and geminated (the /nd/ → /nː/ path). The surviving codas are sparse.

Syllabic consonants (/n, m, s, θ, ʔ, w, j/, possibly /r/) serve as syllable nuclei. They occur predominantly in appendix position (§3.5) but can also occur foot-internally where elision has stranded them.

A **mora (μ)** is the unit of syllable weight: a short vowel is 1μ, a long vowel is 2μ, a syllabic consonant is 1μ. A syllable is **light** (1μ) or **heavy** (2μ) depending on its moraic content. The conlang's stress and foot rules are weight-sensitive.

3.2 Foot construction

Feet are built **right-to-left** and are **trochaic** by default (left-headed): the leftmost syllable of a two-syllable foot bears prominence within the foot. The **rightmost foot** is the head foot of the prosodic word and bears primary stress.

Feet may be one or two syllables. **Degenerate (single-syllable) feet are licensed** at the right edge regardless of syllable weight. Light-monosyllabic words like *ŕe* /ˈr̥ɛ/ "today" are fully grammatical; an earlier draft's minimality clause restricting degenerate feet to heavy syllables is retired.

3.3 Stress placement

The descriptive rule: **stress falls on the final vocalic position of a word.** Because syllabic consonants count as nuclei, “final vocalic position” may be a syllabic consonant rather than a full vowel.

Three things follow from the right-headed foot construction in §3.2:

1. In a monosyllabic head foot, the head is that single syllable — which is the final vocalic position. Stress lands there.
2. In a disyllabic head foot, the head is the leftmost syllable of the foot by default (trochee) — but the rightmost syllable bears stress, by the right-headed prosodic-word rule. The two interact such that stress effectively lands on the rightmost full vowel.
3. **Quantitative metathesis** — what earlier drafts called the “rightward stress shift” in dactyl-shaped words — is not a separate rule. It falls out as a consequence of right-headed foot construction applied to a foot where no rule has reduced the rightmost syllable.

If an unstressed vowel followed the final vowel historically, one of three things happened: it smoothed into the stressed vowel (lengthening), elided (creating clusters), or received the stress instead (becoming the new final vocalic position).

3.4 Pitch placement

Pitch falls on the syllable that carried primary stress in the GA etymon. The placement claim is the basic descriptive fact and has been settled since the May 3 2026 session.

The analytical framing this v2.2 commits to: pitch is best understood as the **phonetic residue of GA-style prominence** after stress has migrated to the final vocalic position, rather than as an independently assigned prosodic dimension. Speakers do not target pitch as a separate articulatory dimension; they retain GA-style prominence on its inherited syllable (where prominence in English already bundles loudness, length, and F0) and superimpose the conlang’s final-stress rule on top. Loudness and length transfer to the final vowel; F0 stays behind on the etymological-stress syllable. The audible “pitch on V_1, stress on V_final” pattern falls out of this redistribution, rather than being assigned by a separate rule.

Pitch and stress are usually on **different** syllables. Where GA stress was initial (most multisyllabic GA etyma), the conlang’s stress has migrated to the final position while pitch has stayed where it was. *Emma* /ɛma/ has pitch on /ɛ/, stress on /a/. *Emily* /ɛmiː/ has pitch on /ɛ/, stress on /iː/.

When pitch and stress would land on the same syllable, the result is a single-prominence word. Monosyllables coincide trivially. Some longer forms also coincide where the GA etymon’s stress was final or where derivational reductions have placed both prominences on the same vowel — *ŕeut* /r̥eːʔ/ “carrot” coincides because the GA *carrot*’s stress was on the first syllable, which is now the only syllable left.

Diachronic pathway

Stage 0 (GA): σ_1 {loud + long + high F0} σ_2 ... σ[illegible] {weak}
full English prominence on the lexically-stressed syllable

Stage 1 (transitional): σ_1 {long + high F0} σ_2 ... σ▯ {emerging final prominence}
final-stress constraint begins applying; loudness migrates

Stage 2 (current): σ_1 {high F0, slight length} σ_2 ... σ▯ {loud + long, primary stress}
stress is now on σ▯; F0 residue on σ_1

The end state has two prominences competing on one word: an inherited one phonetically reduced to mostly F0, and a new one carrying loudness and length. This is the dissociation pattern.

The pathway has cross-linguistic parallels. The standard analysis of how Tokyo Japanese pitch accent emerged from earlier accent-with-stress is roughly this — stress simplifies to its F0 correlate while a separate prominence dimension takes over. The development of tone from accent in some Bantu lineages has a similar shape. The conlang is in well-attested typological territory.

Etymologically determined, synchronically opaque

The placement is **etymologically determined** — fully derivable from the GA etymon's stress location. From the historical-linguist's viewpoint, it is a regular reflex.

It is **not synchronically predictable** — from the speaker's viewpoint, with the GA source no longer accessible, pitch placement is lexical information attached to each word. A speaker cannot derive it from the conlang surface form. This is the same epistemic status English lexical stress has: a speaker has to know that *récord* and *recórd* differ word by word.

The two senses of "predictable" are different and were conflated in earlier framings. Calling pitch "predictable" in the sense that closes the question of whether it is lexical is sloppy; "predictable from the etymon" does not entail "predictable from the surface form." Pitch is **lexical**, in the same sense that lexical-stress systems are lexical. Whether it is also **contrastive** (carries minimal-pair distinctions) is a separate question, treated below and in §5.

Why minimal pairs are scarce

The minimal-pair scarcity is **not** evidence that pitch is weak. It is evidence that GA stress is loud — in the information-theoretic sense — and has already eaten most of the territory in which pitch could carry contrast.

GA stress is not just a prominence diacritic. It restructures everything around itself: stressed vowels are full, unstressed vowels reduce to schwa or elide, syllable weight and segment count depend on where prominence fell. By the time GA stress has done its work, two words sharing the same stress pattern have largely the same shape, and two words with different stress patterns have largely different shapes.

The conlang's cascade compounds this. Vowel mergers, consonant mergers, schwa elision, the appendix system — all operate on already-stress-conditioned material. The result is that residual segmental skeletons that could converge on a homophonous form while differing only in pitch almost never exist.

The territory left for pitch to carry contrast is mostly **GA stress-shift derivational pairs** — pairs like *récord* /

recórd, *présent* / *presént*, *súbject* / *subjéct*, where both members share segments under different prominences. These are the cleanest candidates for true conlang minimal pairs distinguishable by pitch alone, because they are the cases where GA's segment-shaping power is held constant across the pair.

The reframed picture: pitch's potential workspace was mostly absorbed by the segmental consequences of the prominence pattern it descends from. Low functional load on pitch follows directly from this and is not, on its own, evidence about whether pitch is contrastive, allophonic, or vestigial.

Phonetic predictions

Under the residue analysis, V_1 should retain phonetic correlates of GA-style prominence beyond pure F0:

- **Slight length.** V_1 should be marginally longer than a comparable unstressed vowel, because length was part of the inherited prominence package and would not fully transfer to the final.
- **Slight fullness or amplitude.** V_1 should not reduce all the way to schwa-like quality even when stress has clearly moved off it.
- **F0 peak roughly aligned with the syllable nucleus**, not displaced to a syllable margin (which would suggest a contour-tone analysis).

A "true" pitch-accent system fully grammaticalized away from its stress origin would have F0 doing the work alone, with V_1 otherwise indistinguishable from any other unstressed vowel. The conlang should *not* look like that under the residue analysis. Acoustic recordings (pending; see §5) are the falsification test.

Orthography

Pitch is marked with **acute** on a vowel; stress is marked with **grave** (normally unwritten because predictable, marked in formal/pedagogical text); coincidence is marked with **circumflex** in formal register. The acute-on-consonant devoicing convention is unaffected — pitch and devoicing live on different segment types.

The orthographic conventions are not affected by the residue reframing. Pitch is still marked because it is still lexical, regardless of whether it is analyzed as a feature target or as residue.

Pedagogical note

For GA-speaking learners, the framing matters in practice. "Pitch accent" as a label triggers a mental block: learners begin consciously controlling F0 in unnatural ways and overshoot. The technique implicit in the residue analysis avoids this — say the word with English-style prominence on the etymological-stress syllable, then put extra weight on the final vowel. The pitch pattern emerges automatically without being thought of as pitch.

This is a teaching artifact, not a phonological claim, but it matches the analysis: if pitch is residue rather than target, the right way to teach it is as residue too.

3.5 Appendix structure

Some conlang words have substantial syllabic-consonant material following the stressed vowel:

Form	Stressed nucleus	Post-stress material
Jennifer /ˈrɛ̃ːθw̩/	/ɛ̃ː/	/θ/ + syllabic /w̩/
Rochester /ˈritsstw̩/	/i/	/tsst/ + syllabic /w̩/
countenance /ˈhoʔn̩ʔn̩ts/	/o/	/ʔ/ + /n̩/ + /ʔ/ + /n̩/ + /ts/

This material is **weight-bearing** (the syllabic consonants are moraic) but **stress-invisible** (primary stress stays on the leftmost full vowel even when there are multiple post-stress nuclei). It can be **substantial** — *countenance* has up to four post-stress nuclei depending on whether /ts/ is parsed as a complex coda or a fourth nucleus.

The right structural analysis is **appendix adjunction**: the post-stress material is adjoined to the prosodic word at a level above the foot, rather than being foot-internal-but-invisible.

```
    ω (prosodic word)
   / \
  F   App (appendix)
  |    \
  σ    σ σ ... (syllabic-C nuclei)
 /|
μμ
```

The foot F contains the stressed syllable. Everything to the right of F is appendix material adjoined to ω, foot-external by virtue of attaching at a higher level.

This analysis is standard for English word-final consonant clusters that violate sonority sequencing (*sixths* /sɪksθs/), German word-final extrametrical consonants, Japanese moraic nasal codas, and Polish/Czech post-stress syllabic sonorants. The mechanism handles the conlang's pattern cleanly:

- It naturally permits multiple nuclei in the appendix zone (no single-constituent restriction).
- It correctly predicts stress-invisibility (the appendix is outside the foot domain).
- It correctly predicts weight-bearing (the appendix nuclei are moraic syllables, just attached higher).

On terminology. Earlier drafts called this material *sesquisyllabic*. The label was misapplied. Sesquisyllabicity is a defined left-edge phenomenon in Mainland Southeast Asian (Mon-Khmer, adjacent Tibeto-Burman) languages: a reduced presyllable precedes a major stressed syllable, and the prosodic word is iambic in shape. The conlang's pattern inverts every defining property — the reduced material *follows* the stressed nucleus, the shape is trochaic-with-tail, the reduced nuclei can be lower-sonority than MSEA presyllables typically host, and the appendix can be longer than half a syllable. The borrowed term locates the asymmetry on the wrong side and imports typological expectations that don't apply. *Appendix* is the correct term; *sesquisyllabic* should not be used in new descriptions.

Extrametricality — a related concept that licenses single peripheral constituents to be invisible to foot construction — does some work for the simpler cases (*Jennifer* with one peripheral syllable) but doesn't scale to the multi-nucleus cases. The classical formulation permits one peripheral constituent to be invisible; *counte-*

nance's up-to-four post-stress nuclei break that. Iterative or persistent extrametricality has precedent (Cairene Arabic, some Berber varieties) but is non-standard. Appendix adjunction is the cleaner analysis.

> *Analytical sources.* The appendix-adjunction mechanism originates in the prosodic-phonology literature (Selkirk 1986, 1996; Itô & Mester 1992 and later). Cited here for completeness; not required reading for using the language.

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4. Diachronic development

4.1 Overview

The conlang's surface forms derive from GA etyma by a designed cascade of regular sound changes. The high-level shape:

- **Aggressive schwa elision** in unstressed positions, producing consonant clusters and syllabic consonants where GA had vowel-bearing syllables.
- **Intervocalic consonant elision** for /d, dʒ, n, j, g, v/, producing widespread vowel hiatus and feeding the long-vowel inventory.
- **Debuccalization** of /s/ to /h/ in most positions, and of onset /k/ to /h/ in parallel.
- **Massive consonant mergers**, especially /d, dʒ, n, j, g, v/ → /r/ (tap), /m, p/ → /b/ in onset, /f/ → /θ/, /w, j/ → /ɻ/.
- **Coda reduction**: /t/ → /ʔ/, /d/ → ∅, /l/ along several paths (still under analysis), with coda /ʔ/ stable.
- **Vocalic mergers**: /u, ʊ, ʌ/ → /ɨ/, /ai/ → /iː/ ~ /eː/ ~ /i/ (conditioning open), /au, or/ → /o(ː)/, /æ, er/ → /eː/.
- **Suprasegmental residue**: nasalization on vowels adjacent to elided /n/, breathy voice from elided /h/ and weak obstruents, pitch retained on the GA-stress vowel even after stress migrates rightward.
- **Final-vowel stress assignment**, with the historical stress vowel keeping its pitch — producing the pitch-stress dissociation.

The cascade is best understood as a feeding pipeline rather than a flat list of rules. The ordering encodes a design preference for vocalic events over consonantal ones: vowel clusters and long vowels are typologically rarer than consonant clusters, and the conlang aims to foreground them.

4.2 The cascade in overview

Four processes apply in feeding order:

1. **Consonant elision** (intervocalic and coda). Creates vowel hiatus and feeds vowel resolution. M1 (rhotic metathesis) also fires here as an alternative way to vacate the intervocalic position.
2. **Vowel resolution.** Smoothing of hiatus into long vowels (when conditions are met), or retention of hiatus.
3. **Vowel elision.** Applies to inputs that survived process 1 unchanged. Creates consonant clusters, often with syllabic-consonant promotion.

4. **Stress and pitch placement.** Stress is assigned to the now-final vocalic position. Pitch lands on the syllable that historically carried GA primary stress.

The crucial ordering claim is that **process 1 bleeds process 3**: once an intervocalic consonant has elided, the vowels it separated are no longer in an environment for vowel-elision. A word is either a "vowel-event" word (long vowel or hiatus) or a "consonant-event" word (cluster, syllabic consonant), but not both at the same locus. **[Settled]**

4.3 The cascade in detail

Notation: for a CVCVC input, $\mathbf{C_0\,V_1\,C_1\,V_2\,C_2}$. For a dactyl-shaped CVCVCVC input, $\mathbf{C_0\,V_1\,C_1\,V_2\,C_2\,V_3\,C_3}$. Cs may be clusters; Vs include diphthongs.

Cascade for CVCVC

Step	Rule	Condition	Output
1a	E1: elide C_1	$C_1 \in$ {ɾ, dʒ, n, j, g, v}	$C_0\,V_1\,V_2\,C_2$ → step 2
1b	M1: relocate C_1 if /ɻ/	C_1 = /ɻ/ AND $C_0 \in$ {/h/, ∅}	rhotic moves to onset; /h/ becomes devoicing feature → /ɽ̥/. Hiatus created. → step 2
1c	M1 blocked / no rule fires	C_1 = /ɻ/ but C_0 is something else; OR C_1 not in any set	unchanged → step 4
2	Smoothing	(a) one participant is /ə/, OR (b) participants are articulatorily close	$C_0\,V_1\!:\,C_2$
2	Hiatus retention	neither smoothing condition met	hiatus preserved; stress placed on final V (see §3.3)
3	Stranded schwa	V_2 = /ə/ in resulting open syllable	strengthen ə→a
4	E3: elide V_2	$V_2 \in$ elision set, intervocalic position not vacated	$C_0\,V_1\,C_1\,C_2$ → step 5
4	E3: skip	otherwise	→ step 6
5	Syllabic-C promotion	C_1 or $C_2 \in$ syllabic-eligible	$C_0\,V_1\,C_1\,\c{C}_2$ (foot + appendix)
6	E2 family: coda treatment	C_2 subject to coda rules (E2a–E2d)	varies — see §4.4
7	Final-V resolution	$V_2 \in$ {e, a, ə}	strengthen ə→a

Step	Rule	Condition	Output
7	Final-V resolution	$V_2 \in \{i, o\}$	reduce to syllabic /j, w/
8	R-Assim	word contains both /ɹ/ and /ɾ/	/ɹ/ → /ɾ/ throughout

Note on step 2. Smoothing is licensed by **either** of two conditions: (a) at least one of the vowels in hiatus is /ə/ (which is absorbed into its neighbor), or (b) the two vowels are articulatorily close. When neither is met — i.e., two or more full, articulatorily distant vowels are in hiatus — the hiatus is retained and stress falls on the final vowel. This is why /eio/ in *radio* stays as three syllables. [**Settled**]

Cascade for dactyl (*CVCVCVC*)

Dactyl-shaped words enter the same cascade and resolve to CVCVC or shorter shapes via E1, E3, or coda reduction. Where elision fully fails, the word retains its three-vowel shape and stress falls on V_3 — by right-headed foot construction, not by a separate metathesis rule (this was previously labeled D1; it is now understood as a consequence of §3.2's foot construction, not an independent rule).

Five generalizations the cascade encodes

1. **Vacate the intervocalic position** where licensed — by elision (E1) or by metathesis (M1). Either creates hiatus.
2. **Smooth** vowels in hiatus when (a) one is schwa, or (b) they are articulatorily close.
3. **Promote** stranded consonants to syllabic nuclei where sonority licenses; this produces appendix material when the result is post-stress.
4. **Strengthen** final stranded schwa.
5. **Place stress** on the rightmost full vocalic position; **place pitch** on the syllable that carried GA primary stress.

Bleeding and feeding relations

- **E1 always bleeds E3 at the same locus.** If C_1 has elided, V_2 is no longer in the right environment for vowel elision.
- **M1 conditionally bleeds E3.** When M1 fires, the intervocalic position is vacated and E3 is bled. When M1 is blocked, E3 is free to fire.
- **E1 and M1 (when firing) both feed Smoothing.**
- **Smoothing bleeds Strengthening.** A schwa that has smoothed into the preceding vowel is no longer available to be strengthened to /a/.
- **E3 feeds Syllabic-C promotion**, which feeds Appendix adjunction at the prosodic-word level.
- **All vowel-creating and vowel-removing rules feed Stress placement.**
- **Pitch placement is independent of the segmental cascade** — it lands on the historical-GA-stress vowel regardless of what the segmental rules have done elsewhere.

- **R-Assim fires last.**

4.4 Sound-change inventory

Diachronic changes that produce the synchronic inventory. Listed by domain. These are descriptive of the historical processes; some are productive synchronic rules, others are residue.

4.4.1 Consonantal mergers and shifts

GA source	Conlang reflex	Notes
/s/	/h/ in most positions	Debuccalization.
/s/	/sː/ at syllable boundary preceding stress	Phonologization of GA ambisyllabic /s/. Wins over debuccalization in this environment. [**New in v2; see *beussou, rhiiysseunnou***]
/s/ (onset cluster)	/s/	Debuccalization blocked when /s/ is the first element of an onset cluster (e.g., /sp/, /sk/). Cluster-protection: /s/ surfaces. [**New in v2.4; see *spyi***]
/st/	/ts/	Takes the synchronic place of /s/ in clusters.
/k/ (onset)	/h/	Joins /s/ in the debuccalization path.
/k/ (coda)	∅	Lost outright.
coda /k/ + adjacent /w/	/kʷ/ (onset)	/k/ absorbs the labial feature of adjacent /w/; blocks coda /k/→∅; surfaces as onset /kʷ/. Ambisyllabic /kw/ → geminate /kʷː/. [**New in v2.4; see *piiquóœ, piquô, récquìs***]
/kr/	/r̥/	/k/ devoices the rhotic and merges in.
/kl/	/tl/	Stop place shifts; cluster preserved.
/kj, kw/	[kj, kw]	Surface intact; analyzed as allophonic /hj, hw/. [**Provisional**]

GA source	Conlang reflex	Notes
/d, dʒ, n, j, g, v/	/r/ (tap)	Massive merger into the tap. /n/-merger conditional on environment (can also elide with nasal coloring).
/m, p/	/b/ (in onset)	Merger into voiced labial.
/p/	/b/ before /ɛ/ and its long counterpart	More specifically: /p/ → /b/ in onset before /ɛ, ɛː/; blocked before /i, ɪ, ɑ, o/ and consonant clusters. [**New in v2; environment from *beussou***]
/pp/ ambisyllabic	/pː/	Phonologization of GA ambisyllabic /p/. [**New in v2; see *epplii***]
/f/	/θ/	Merger into the dental fricative.
/w, j/	/ɹ̩/	Then /ɹ̩/ → /r/ near another /r/.
/nd/ in coda	/nː/	Regressive assimilation: /d/ → /n/, then geminate. [**New in v2; see *rhiiysseunnou***]
/ɫ/ between high front vowels	/j/	Glide-becoming, feeds smoothing of /ɪji/ → /iː/. Attested in *Emily*, *rhiiynii*, *rhiiysseunnou*.

4.4.2 Vocalic mergers and reanalyses

GA source	Conlang reflex
/u, ʊ, ʌ/	/ɨ/ (possibly further to /ɪ/)
/ai/	/eː/ ~ /i/ (conditioning [**Open**]; /iː/ outcome ruled out May 2026)
/au, or/	/o(ː)/
/æ, er/	/eː/
/æ/ before nasal	/ɛː/ (long, via GA-tense-/æ/-with-preserved-duration pathway)
/u/ (long pathway)	/ɨː/
/ə/ (final)	/a/ when stranded in open syllable; absorbed when adjacent to vowel; elides when in cluster-feeding position

GA source	Conlang reflex
/ə/ (initial unstressed, surviving)	/ɛ/ when not absorbed or elided. [**New in v2; see *epplii***]
/ɔɪ/	/oe/

The /ai/ reflex is the most analytically open question in the vocalic system: multiple surface outputs with conditioning still undetermined, including possible free variation and lexically-specific shifts. See §5 data-gathering bucket.

The /æ/-before-nasal pathway is distinct from the smoothed-schwa pathway for long /ɛː/, but both produce the same orthographic digraph eu. The orthography unifies the two diachronic feeds under one grapheme.

4.4.3 Elision rules

Synchronically active processes deriving surface forms from etyma.

E1. Intervocalic consonant elision. /ɾ, dʒ, n, j, g, v/ delete between vowels. (/ɾ/ here is the alveolar tap — the GA intervocalic realization of /d/; the rule operates on the surface segment.) /n/ leaves behind nasalization on adjacent vowels. Fed by no rule; feeds vowel resolution. [**Settled**]

E2 family. Coda treatment. v1's generic E2 has been replaced with several focused rules. Each handles one segment or environment; they share the property of operating on word-final or syllable-final coda position.

- **E2a. Coda /t/ → /ʔ/.** Strictly coda-weakening rather than elision, but lives in this section structurally. Productive across the lexicon (*ŕeut* < *carrot*, *rhiiysseunnou* before /ʔ/-drop, etc.). [**Settled**]
- **E2b. Coda /d/ → ∅.** No compensatory lengthening on the preceding vowel. *rhiiynii* /ɻ̩iːni/ "to need" < *need* shows the stem's /i/ remaining short after /d/ deletes, contrasting with the prefix's /iː/ (which arose by a different pathway, /ɪji/-smoothing). [**Settled in v2**]
- **E2c. Coda /l/ → ∅, multi-path.** /l/ has multiple elision paths along which singleton /l/ has been lost (per the §2.1 inventory note that /l/ "occurs only in clusters"). At least one path is attested: *toutw* /ˈtoːtw̩/ < *to total to* shows coda /l/ loss in a non-cluster environment. The full set of paths and conditions is [**Open**] and deferred to a later session.
- **E2d. Coda /ʔ/ stable.** Coda /ʔ/ does not elide under the regular cascade. **Lexical exception:** in grammaticalized particles (notably the *out* of phrasal-verb-derived stems), /ʔ/ is dropped. *beussou* /ˌbɛːˈsːoː/ "to fall asleep" < *pass out* and *rhiiysseunnou* /ɻ̩iːsːɛːnːoː/ "to be different" < *really stand out* both drop the /ʔ/ from *out*; an optional careful-speech variant preserves it. [**Settled in v2; v1's "never elides" claim softened**]

E3. Schwa elision in unstressed position. Applies when not blocked by E1 or M1 having already created hiatus at that locus. Feeds cluster formation and syllabic-consonant promotion.

E4. Schwa absorption. Adjacent to another vowel, schwa is consumed by smoothing rather than elided.

E5. Schwa strengthening. Final stranded /ə/ in an open syllable strengthens to /a/. Initial unstressed /ə/ that survives to the final stage strengthens to /ɛ/ (parallel pathway, [**New in v2**]).

4.4.4 Rhotic rules

M1. Rhotic metathesis (retroflex only). Intervocalic /ɻ/ relocates to onset position. The rule is motivated by GA r-coloring: /ɻ/'s articulation already extends across adjacent vowels, making it phonologically "loose" and relocatable in a way other consonants are not.

- **Trigger:** /ɻ/ in intervocalic position.
- **Required onset environment:** the word has either an onset /h/ or no onset at all.
- **When the onset is /h/:** the rhotic lands in onset, the /h/ ceases to function as an independent segment and is reanalyzed as a devoicing feature on the rhotic. Output: /ɾ̥/.
- **When the onset is empty:** the rhotic lands in onset as plain /ɻ/.
- **When blocked** (any other onset): /ɻ/ stays in place and surfaces as /ɻ/. It does not elide and does not convert to /ɾ/.
- Coda /ɻ/ is not in M1's domain — it participates in the historical /er/ → /eː/, /or/ → /oː/ mergers (§4.4.2) instead.

Conditioning environment in detail (e.g., what counts as "intervocalic" across cluster boundaries) is [**Open**]. [**Settled in core, Open in edges**]

C-Coal. Onset coalescence of /h/ + tap. Sister rule to M1, sharing the /h/-as-devoicing-feature mechanism. When /h/ and /ɾ/ (or /ɻ/) come together in onset position by direct adjacency rather than by metathesis, the same coalescence applies: /h/ ceases to be an independent segment and reanalyzes as devoicing on the rhotic, producing /ɾ̥/. Attested in *ŕe* /ɾ̥ɛ/ "today" (< colloquial *today* with rapid-speech reduction producing /h/ + tap onset). [**New in v2; sister to M1**]

R-Assim. Alveolar-wins rhotic assimilation. Fires after M1 and C-Coal. If a word contains both an alveolar /ɾ/ and a retroflex /ɻ/, the retroflex assimilates to alveolar. This establishes the alveolar tap as the unmarked rhotic in the conlang. [**Settled**]

4.4.5 Suprasegmental rules

S1. Nasalization transfer. When /n/ elides, nasality transfers to the adjacent vowels. The transfer typically lands on V_1 (left of the elided /n/) and/or V_2 (right of it); in the orthographic system, V_2 carries the nasalization mark by default (see *Orthography Reference* §3.5 for the V_1-pitch / V_2-nasalization placement rule). [**Settled**]

S2. Breathy voice. From elided coda /h/ or weakened obstruents. [**Provisional**]

S3. Pitch placement. Pitch lands on the syllable that carried primary stress in the GA etymon, regardless of where conlang stress has migrated to. Best analyzed as the F0 residue of GA-style prominence after the loudness-and-length components have transferred to the final vocalic position under the conlang's final-stress rule, rather than as an independently assigned dimension (see §3.4). Placement is [**Settled**]; whether the placement is *contrastive* (i.e., whether minimal pairs distinguishable only by pitch placement actually exist) is [**Open**] — see §5 for the structural account of why such pairs are scarce.

4.5 Worked derivations

Each row shows: GA etymon, conlang IPA, the rules that applied, the foot/appendix structure, and notes. Pitch and stress placement follow §3.3–3.4.

GA etymon	GA IPA	Rules applied	Conlang IPA	Pitch	Stress	Structure
Jennifer	/ˈdʒɛnəfɹ̩/	E1 (n→∅, nasalize); /ɹ/→syllabic /w/; smoothing	/ˈrɛ̃ːθw̩/	/ɛ̃ː/	/ɛ̃ː/ (coincide)	(ˈH) heavy foot + appendix
Emma	/ˈɛmə/	E5 schwa strengthening	/ɛma/	/ɛ/	/a/	(L)(L) two light feet, dissociated prominences
Emily	/ˈɛməli/	E1 (l via /ɫ/→/j/→smooth); /ɪji/→/iː/	/ɛmiː/	/ɛ/	/iː/	(L)(ˈH) — pitch on left, stress on right
Betty	/ˈbɛɾi/	E1 (tap d→∅); hiatus	/bɛi/	/ɛ/	/i/	(L)(L) dissociated
sodium	/ˈsoʊdiəm/	/s/→/h/; E1 (d→∅); hiatus stays	/ˈhoiom/	/o/	open question on final	hiatus retained
countenance	/ˈkaʊntənəns/	/k/→/h/; massive E3; syllabic /n/, /ʔ/; /st/→/ts/	/ˈhoʔn̩ʔn̩ts/	/o/	/o/ (coincide)	(ˈH) heavy foot + long appendix
Rochester	/ˈrɑtʃɛstɹ̩/	/tʃ/→/ts/; E3; /ɹ/→syllabic /w/	/ˈritsstw̩/	/i/	/i/ (coincide)	(ˈH) heavy foot + appendix

GA etymon	GA IPA	Rules applied	Conlang IPA	Pitch	Stress	Structure
carrot	/ˈkæɻət/ → /ˈkæɻəʔ/	/k/→/h/; /t/→/ʔ/ (E2a); M1 (/ɻ/→onset, /h/ as devoicing); smoothing /æ+ə/; /æ/→/eː/	/r̥eːʔ/	/eː/	/eː/ (coincide)	(ˈH) heavy monosyllable
radio	/ˈɻeɪdiˌo/	E1 (d→∅); no smoothing (no /ə/, distant Vs); stress to final	/reio/	/e/	/o/	three syllables, hiatus retained
baron	/ˈbæɻən/	M1 blocked (/b/ onset); /æ/→/eː/; E3 elides schwa; /n/ syllabic	/ˈbeɻn̩/ **[Provisional]**	/eː/	/eː/ (coincide)	(ˈH) heavy foot + n-appendix
barn	/bæɻn/	coda /ɻ/ → vowel coloring (/er/→/eː/ pathway); /n/ stays	/beːn/	/eː/	/eː/ (coincide)	(ˈH) heavy monosyllable

Dictionary entries exercising the v2 rules

Headword	GA etymon	Rules applied	Conlang IPA	Notes
beussou	*pass out*	/pʰ/→/b/ before /ɛ/; /æ/→/ɛː/; /s/→/sː/ at syllable boundary preceding stress; /aʊ/→/oː/; lexical /ʔ/-drop in *out*	/ˌbɛːˈsːoː/	Geminate /sː/, /p/→/b/ environment, lexical /ʔ/-drop

Headword	GA etymon	Rules applied	Conlang IPA	Notes
rhiiysseunnou	*really stand out*	/ɫ/→/j/ between high front vowels; /ɪji/→/iː/; /æ/-before-nasal→/ɛː/ via tense-/æ/-with-duration pathway; /st/→/sː/; /nd/→/nː/ regressive assimilation; lexical /ʔ/-drop in *out*	/ɻ̩iːsːɛːnːoː/	Three geminates (/sː/, /nː/), /iː/ phoneme, /æ/-before-nasal pathway
rhiiynii	*really need*	/ɫ/→/j/; /ɪji/→/iː/; coda /d/→∅ (E2b, no comp lengthening)	/ɻ̩iːni/	Long /iː/ in prefix (etymological glide source) vs. short /i/ in stem (no comp lengthening from /d/-deletion)
epplii	*to apply*	Initial unstressed /ə/→/ɛ/ (E5); ambisyllabic /pp/→/pː/; /aɪ/→short /i/ (third reflex of /ai/)	/ˈɛpːli/	New initial-schwa-strengthening rule, geminate /pː/, third /ai/ reflex
toutw	*to total to*	E1 on intervocalic /ɾ/ (from GA /t/); coda /l/→∅ outside cluster (E2c, multi-path flagged open); /aʊ/→/oː/; smoothing; final unstressed /u/→syllabic /w̩/	/ˈtoːtw̩/	Coda /l/ elision attested; final /w̩/ in appendix position

Headword	GA etymon	Rules applied	Conlang IPA	Notes
ŕe	*today* (colloquial *t'day* /tʰɾeɪ/)	C-Coal: /h/ + tap → /ɾ̥/ in onset; irregular /t/→/h/ (lexically conditioned); irregular /eɪ/→/ɛ/ (lexically conditioned, frequency-driven)	/ˈɾ̥ɛ/	New C-Coal sister rule to M1; light-monosyllabic foot (no minimality violation)
ŕeut	*carrot*	/k/→/h/; /t/→/ʔ/ (E2a); M1; smoothing; /æ/→/eː/	/ˈɾ̥eːʔ/	Canonical M1 derivation; pitch+stress coincide on /eː/

Issues surfaced by the table

- ***sodium* → *hoiiǫ* /ˈhoiõ/. [Closed v2.3]** The rule is committed: labial /m/ colors the preceding schwa to /o/ (rather than the expected /ɛ/ from regular strengthening), then /m/ elides leaving nasalization on the vowel → /-iõ/. Proposed as productive for all *-ium* endings (*podium*, *Colosseum*, *Liam*). Formalization as a §4 rule is pending a dedicated session.
- ***Annabeth*** — output depends on a phonemic question about the source (whether GA V_2 was /ɛ/ or /ə/). The conlang's choice forces a phonological commitment about the input. [**Open**]
- **Multi-stress GA etymons** — when a GA word had primary + secondary stress, does the conlang preserve both as pitch peaks, or only the primary? [**Open, carried forward from May 3 session**]

4.6 Probes and unresolved derivations

Words chosen to stress-test rule interactions where the description is silent or where two analysts could reasonably reach different outputs. Each probe specifies what it tests and what outputs are possible. These are forcing-functions for committing to ambiguous rules; they live alongside the worked derivations because they're the same kind of content at different stages of resolution.

Probes for E3 vs. M1 competition

Probe: *pilot* /ˈpaɪlət/. - C_1 = /l/, not in E1 elision set, not a rhotic. Intervocalic position not vacated. - V_2 = /ə/, eligible for E3. - C_2 = /t/, eligible for E2a (→/ʔ/). - Predicted: E3 fires, /l/ becomes syllabic, giving /ˈbail̩(ʔ)/ (with /p/→/b/). - **Test:** does /l/ promote to syllabic, even though /l/ is described as "clusters only"? Or does the system block this? [**Decision needed**]

Probe: *salad* /ˈsæləd/. - /s/→/h/ in onset. - C_1 = /l/, not eligible for E1 or M1. - V_2 = /ə/, eligible for E3. - C_2 =

/d/, eligible for E2b (→∅). - Predicted: /ˈhæl̩/ with syllabic /l/, possibly /ˈheːl̩/ if smoothing intervenes. - **Test:** confirm /d/-deletion path; confirm /l/-syllabification. [**Decision needed**]

Probes for cascade in dactyls

Probe: *Penelope* /pəˈnɛləpi/. - Multiple loci for elision: /n/ (E1), /l/ (not E1), schwas (E3 or E4). - Stress originally on V_2; what happens after rules apply? - Predicted (one path): E1 elides /n/ → /pəˈɛ̃ləpi/ → smoothing → /ˈbɛ̃ːləpi/. Then E3 may elide the next schwa → /ˈbɛ̃ːlpi/. - **Test:** does the cascade run left-to-right, or does it apply globally and re-evaluate? [**Decision needed**]

Probe: *Daniela* /ˌdæniˈɛlə/ or /ˌdænˈjɛlə/. - Already iambic (stress on penult); right-headed foot construction should be vacuous on stress placement. - E1 applies to /n/ (→ nasalization); /l/ not in the E1 set. - Predicted: a form like /rẽˈirɛrə/-shape depending on /d/, /n/, /l/ treatments. - **Test:** working stress assignment with multiple eliding loci. [**Decision needed**]

Probes for smoothing edge cases

Probe: a CVCVC where smoothing yields a long vowel of a quality the inventory doesn't support.

- Long-vowel inventory: /iː, ɛː, oː, aː, ɨː/.
- Test word: *ladder* /ˈlæɾɹ̩/. After E1 on /ɾ/ (and possibly M1 on /ɹ̩/), what's the resulting long vowel quality? /æ/→/eː/, but the second segment is rhotic, not vowel.
- **Test:** when smoothing would produce a quality outside the long-vowel inventory, does it fail and retain hiatus, or coerce to the nearest inventory member? [**Open**]

Probe: *idea* /aɪˈdiə/. - After E1 on /d/: /aiˈiə/ → smoothing of /iə/ → /aiˈiː/? Or does /ai/ → /iː/ apply first, giving /iˈiː/ → /iː/? - **Test:** does /ai/ → /iː/ apply *before* or *after* E1 creates new hiatus? Rule ordering question. [**Open**]

Probes for nasalization persistence

Probe: *ginger* /ˈdʒɪndʒɹ̩/. - Both /n/ and /dʒ/ are in the E1 set; /ɹ̩/ becomes syllabic. - Predicted: /ˈrĩrw̩/ or /ˈrĩw̩/ depending on /ndʒ/ resolution. - **Test:** does nasalization survive into a closed syllable? Or only in open syllables? [**Open**]

Probes for syllabic /j, w/ in non-final position

Probe: *tomorrow* /təˈmɑɹo/. - /m/-onset blocks M1; /ɹ/ stays. /ɑ/→/o/, schwa absorbed. - Predicted: /toˈboɹo/ or /təˈboɹo/, with possible final /o/ → syllabic /w/. - **Test:** the syllabic-glide rule's domain — final only, or anywhere? [**Open**]

Probes for monosyllables

Probe: *cat* /kæt/, *song* /sɔŋ/, *tree* /tɹiː/. - *cat*: /k/→/h/, /æ/→/eː/, /t/→/ʔ/ → /heːʔ/. Clean derivation. - *song*: /sɔŋ/ → /hoŋ/, but /ŋ/ isn't in the inventory — possibly /n/ with vowel nasalization, giving /hõ/. - *tree*: cluster /tɹ/ in onset is unusual — does /ɹ/ undergo M1? Or is the cluster preserved? - **Test:** monosyllabic outputs and cluster behavior in onset position. [**Open**]

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5. Open questions

Carried forward from v1 and the May 3 pitch session

Data-gathering bucket — conditioning unclear, possible free variation (opened v2.4)

The following shifts are attested in dictionary entries but lack sufficient data to commit an environment. They may have conditioned reflexes, free variation, or lexically-specific (irregular) outcomes. Collect more attestations before proposing rules. Do not treat these as settled.

- **/ai/ reflex** — at least four surface outcomes attested: /eː/, /i/, /ɛ/ (short), /i/ (short, possibly the same as the second but distinct from the first). Conditioning factors guessed at: stress position, preceding/following consonant, syllable count, lexical frequency. May include free variation. [**Open — data gathering**]
- **/v/ conditioning** — proposed split: /v/ → /ɾ/ (tap merger) before front vowels; /v/ → /b/ (labial onset) before back vowels. Multiple attestations in each direction, but boundary cases unresolved. May also include free variation. [**Open — data gathering**]
- **/ɫ/ dark-l vocalization** — all /l/-initial GA words so far produce /r/-initial headwords; candidate path: /ɫ/→/ɹ/→R-Assim→/ɾ/. Relationship to the existing /ɫ/→/j/ rule (between high front vowels) unclear — possibly one rule with environment-dependent outputs. [**Open — data gathering**]
- **/ɪ/→/ɛ/ lowering** — originally flagged as conditioned by following /b/; now attested without /b/ in context. May be a general unstressed-/ɪ/→/ɛ/ rule, or conditioned on syllable position. [**Open — data gathering**]
- **/ə/→/o/ or /ɪ/→/o/ rounding after /n/** — two attestations in nasal-initial words; mechanism unclear (nasalization coloring? labial spreading?). [**Open — data gathering**]

Carried forward from v1 and the May 3 pitch session

- Conditioning of /ai/ → /eː/ vs. /i/. (/iː/ outcome ruled out May 2026; two-way conditioning still open. Expanded to full data-gathering bucket above.)
- Is /r/ syllabic?
- Treatment of /h/ in onset clusters from /s/- and /k/-debuccalization edge cases.
- M1 edge cases — what counts as "intervocalic" across cluster boundaries; behavior in trisyllabic words with multiple potential M1 sites.
- Whether the **/k/-as-allophonic-/h/-before-glides** analysis holds.
- Smoothing failures when the resulting long vowel would be outside the inventory.
- Interaction of /ai/ with new hiatus from E1.
- Persistence of nasalization across resyllabification.
- Domain of syllabic /j, w/ — final only, or anywhere?
- Treatment of monosyllables — coda /ŋ/, onset clusters with /ɹ/.

Newly opened in v2.1

- **Other /iX/ diphthongal long vowels.** Whether bimoraic diphthongal nuclei beyond /iɛ/ occur (e.g., /io/ spelled iio). Predictable by analogy from the /iɛ/ pattern but no attestations yet. See §2.2.

Newly opened in v2

- **E2c — coda /l/ elision paths.** /l/ has multiple elision paths along which singleton /l/ has been lost; the full set is undescribed and deferred to a later session.
- **Appendix licensing conditions.** Working hypothesis: a syllable is parsed as appendix when its nucleus is a syllabic consonant of low sonority and it follows the stressed full vowel. Edge cases need testing.
- **Appendix and minimum-word effects.** Does the conlang have a minimum-word constraint? If so, does appendix material count toward satisfying it? Bears on the licensing of light-monosyllabic forms like *ŕe*.
- **Diachronic trajectory of the appendix.** The current state is best read as a snapshot mid-restabilization; does this matter for any synchronic decision, or is it purely a framing claim?
- **/ts/ in *countenance*.** Is the final /ts/ a complex coda on the second /n̩/ syllable, or is it a fourth nucleus in its own right? Affects appendix-syllable count and whether /ts/ is licensed as a syllabic affricate.
- **Internal structure of the appendix.** Are the nuclei in *hoʔn̩ʔn̩ts* a flat sequence of σ adjoined to ω, or is there sub-grouping (e.g., a degenerate foot containing /ʔn̩ʔn̩/)?
- **Appendix–pitch interaction.** If pitch is contrastive (still open), does the appendix participate in the pitch contour, or is it pitch-flat?
- **Confirmation of pitch-accent contrast.** Whether minimal pairs distinguishable only by pitch placement actually exist (audio-recorded verification deferred). Under the v2.2 residue analysis (§3.4), low minimal-pair density is **structurally expected** — GA stress's segment-shaping power has absorbed most of the territory pitch could carry contrast in — and is not, on its own, evidence about contrastiveness, allophony, or vestigiality. Note on search strategy: GA stress-shift derivational pairs (*récord*/*recórd*, *présent*/*presént*, *súbject*/*subjéct*) are not clean candidates — in GA, unstressed vowels reduce to schwa, so it is vowel quality doing as much heavy lifting as stress. The conlang reflex pairs would differ in more than pitch alone. A different search strategy (targeting pairs where the GA etymons share segment quality across the stress-site) is needed.
- **Multi-stress GA etymons.** When a GA word had primary + secondary stress, does the conlang preserve both as pitch peaks, or only the primary?

Closed by v2.3

- **/ɪ~ɨ/.** One phoneme: /ɪ/. Surface /ɨ/ is an allophone. Closed May 2026.
- **/ɑ~ɔ/.** One phoneme: /ɑ/. Closed May 2026.
- **Nasalization.** Phonemic. Closed May 2026.
- **Breathy voice.** Not phonemic — allophonic VhV. Medial /h/ in fused particles (*noho*, *hiho*) has the same allophonic status; proposed VhV/VhU distinction not adopted. Closed May 2026.
- **/ai/ → /iː/ outcome.** Ruled out. The two-way /eː/ ~ /i/ conditioning question stays open. Closed May 2026.

- ***sodium* derivation.** Committed as *hoiią̄* /ˈhoiõ/ via labial-coloring-of-schwa + /m/-elision-with-nasalization. Proposed productive for all *-ium* endings; rule formalization in §4 pending. Closed as an open derivation; opened as a pending rule ticket. Closed May 2026.

Closed by v2

- **Geminates as a category.** /sː, nː, pː/ admitted as a sub-inventory; doubled-consonant orthographic convention generalized. Closed via dictionary batch.
- **/iː/ as a phoneme.** Admitted to the long-vowel inventory; spelled iiy. Closed via dictionary batch.
- **/s/ → /sː/ at syllable boundary preceding stress.** Rule added to §4.4.1. Closed.
- **/p/ → /b/ environment.** Specified: before /ɛ/ and its long counterpart, blocked elsewhere. Closed.
- **Coda /ʔ/ exceptions.** v1's "never elides" softened to admit lexical exceptions in grammaticalized particles. Closed.
- **/nd/ → /nː/.** Settled as regressive assimilation. Closed.
- **Initial unstressed /ə/ → /ɛ/.** Rule added to E5 (parallel to final-schwa-strengthening). Closed.
- **Coda /d/ → ∅, no compensatory lengthening.** Confirmed; rule added as E2b. Closed.
- **/æ/-before-nasal → /ɛː/.** Distinct pathway from smoothed-schwa, both feeding eu. Closed.
- **/h/+tap coalescence.** Settled as separate sister rule (C-Coal) to M1, sharing the devoicing mechanism. Closed.
- **Aspiration.** Confirmed as fully allophonic, not orthographically represented. Closed.
- **Degenerate-foot minimality.** v1's clause restricting degenerate feet to heavy syllables retired. Light-monosyllabic feet are licensed. Closed via *ŕe* attestation.
- **Quantitative metathesis (D1).** Confirmed as a consequence of right-headed foot construction, not a separate rule. Closed via May 3 session.
- **Pitch placement.** Settled as lexically determined by GA etymon; orthographically marked with acute on the relevant vowel. Closed via May 3 session.
- **Sesquisyllabic terminology.** Retired. *Appendix* is the correct term. Closed.

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6. Glossary

Technical vocabulary used throughout. Inline short definitions appear in earlier sections at first use; this glossary is the consolidated reference.

Appendix. Material adjoined to the prosodic word at a level above the foot. Weight-bearing (moraic) but stress-invisible (foot-external). The structural mechanism for the conlang's post-stress syllabic-consonant tails (§3.5).

Appendix nucleus. A syllabic consonant heading a syllable that is part of the appendix rather than the head foot.

Bleeding and feeding. Standard ordering relations between rules. Rule A **feeds** Rule B if A creates the input environment for B. Rule A **bleeds** Rule B if A removes (consumes) inputs that B would otherwise have applied to. The cascade in §4.2–4.3 is built on a feeding-then-bleeding sequence.

Compensatory lengthening. The lengthening of a vowel to "compensate" for the loss of a neighbouring segment. In the conlang, compensatory lengthening occurs when intervocalic /d/ elides and V_1+V_2 smooth into V_1ː. Notably it does *not* occur in coda /d/ deletion (E2b), where the preceding vowel stays short.

Concord affixes. (*Morphological term, used in language_reference.md; included here for cross-reference completeness.*) Affixes on the main verb stem that show concordance with the light verb complex. Defined in verbal-system.md §4.

Foot. A grouping of one or two syllables carrying a single primary prominence. The conlang builds **trochaic feet right-to-left**, with the **rightmost foot** receiving primary stress (right-headed prosodic word, left-headed foot — common cross-linguistically). The final foot is the last two syllables (or the last syllable, if only one survives elision).

Head (of a foot). The prominent syllable within a foot. The default head is the leftmost (trochaic).

Mora (μ). The unit of syllable weight. A short vowel = 1μ. A long vowel = 2μ. A syllabic consonant = 1μ. Coda consonants are non-moraic by default; syllabic consonants (which are moraic) can occupy coda position.

Prominence. Generic term for stress-like salience. Includes primary stress, secondary stress, and pitch-accent prominence.

Quantitative metathesis. A traditional term for the rightward shift of stress (or vowel length) across positions in a word. In the conlang, what looks like quantitative metathesis in dactyl-shaped words is now understood as a *consequence* of right-headed foot construction (§3.2), not a separate rule.

Recursive prosodic structure. Prosodic constituents (foot, prosodic word) that contain or are adjoined to other constituents of the same level. The mechanism by which appendix material attaches to the prosodic word.

Resyllabification. The redrawing of syllable boundaries after a segment is added or lost. After vowel elision, the orphaned consonant either joins the preceding syllable as a coda or becomes a syllabic nucleus of its own.

Sesquisyllable. A defined left-edge phenomenon in Mainland Southeast Asian languages: a reduced presyllable precedes a major stressed syllable, with the prosodic word iambic in shape. **The conlang's post-stress consonantal tails are NOT sesquisyllabic** (despite earlier drafts using the term). The structural details — direction (post-stress vs. pre-stress), shape (trochaic-with-tail vs. iambic), nucleus inventory, length — all diverge. Use *appendix* (above) for the conlang's pattern.

Sonority. A scalar property of segments, roughly: vowels > glides > liquids > nasals > fricatives > stops. The **Sonority Sequencing Principle** (SSP) says syllable nuclei should be drawn from the most sonorous available segments. The conlang stretches this — it allows /s, θ, ʔ/ as syllabic, which are unusually low on the scale.

Spondee. A traditional foot name for a two-syllable foot where both syllables bear stress (DUM-DUM). Earlier drafts of this document used *spondee* and *stress clash* to describe certain conlang outputs. Both are retired: what was previously analyzed as clash is now understood as pitch-stress dissociation (pitch on one syllable, stress on another), not as two stresses on adjacent syllables.

Stress clash. Two adjacent syllables both bearing primary or near-primary stress. Retired from the conlang's analysis (see *Spondee*).

Syllable weight. A function of moraic content. **Light** = 1μ (short V, open syllable). **Heavy** = 2μ (long V, or short V plus syllabic consonant in same syllable).

Trochee, iamb, dactyl. Traditional foot names for stress patterns: trochee = DUM-bah, iamb = bah-DUM, dactyl = DUM-bah-bah. The conlang's default foot is trochaic (left-headed); the prosodic word is right-headed (rightmost foot is the head foot).

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7. Versioning notes

v2.4, May 2026 — three rules committed; data-gathering bucket opened

Three rules added to §4.4 from dictionary batch work. - **§4.4.1:** /ɔɪ/→/oe/ added to the vocalic mergers table. Attested in *bœ*, *boeś*, *nœ*. - **§4.4.1:** /s/ cluster-protection added: debuccalization blocked when /s/ heads an onset cluster (e.g., /sp/, /sk/). See *spyi*. - **§4.4.1:** /k/ labialization added: coda /k/ + adjacent /w/ → onset /kʷ/; blocks coda /k/→∅; geminate /kʷː/ when ambisyllabic. See *piiquóœ*, *piquô*, *récquìs*.

Data-gathering bucket opened (§5). Five conditioning-unclear shift patterns collected from 36-entry dictionary batch: /ai/ reflex (now confirmed multi-way), /v/ conditioning, /ɫ/ dark-l vocalization, /ɪ/→/ɛ/, /ə/→/o/ after /n/. All marked [Open — data gathering]. May include free variation or lexically-specific outcomes; do not commit until more attestations and a dedicated analysis session.

§4.4.2 /ai/ prose updated to point to §5 data-gathering bucket rather than claiming three defined outputs.

v2.3, May 2026 — phoneme inventory closures; /ai/ narrowed; *sodium* committed

Phoneme inventory closures (§2.2, §2.3, §5). - /ɪ~ɨ/ consolidated to a single phoneme /ɪ/; surface /ɨ/ is allophonic. - /ɑ~ɔ/ consolidated to a single phoneme /ɑ/. - Nasalization: phonemic. [Settled]. - Breathy voice: not phonemic — allophonic VhV. Medial /h/ in fused particles (*noho*, *hiho*) carries the same allophonic status; proposed VhV/VhU phonemic distinction not adopted.

§4.4.2 /ai/ reflex narrowed. /iː/ is ruled out as an outcome of /ai/. The two-way /eː/ ~ /i/ conditioning remains open.

***sodium* derivation committed (§6.1).** Headword revised to *hoiiǫ* /ˈhoiõ/. The committed rule: labial /m/ colors the preceding schwa → /o/ (rather than expected /ɛ/), then /m/ elides leaving nasalization on the vowel → /-iõ/. Proposed productive for all *-ium* endings; formalization as a §4 rule is deferred to a dedicated phonology session.

§5 open-questions list updated. Closed items moved to "Closed by v2.3." Pitch-accent minimal-pairs note updated: GA stress-shift pairs (*récord*/*recórd*, etc.) are not clean candidates because unstressed vowels reduce to schwa in GA, making vowel quality and stress co-vary. A search strategy targeting pairs where segment quality is held constant across the stress-site is needed.

v2.2, May 2026 — pitch as residue of GA prominence

§3.4 reframed. The pitch placement rule (pitch on the syllable that carried GA primary stress) is unchanged. The analytical framing is sharpened: pitch is now treated as the **phonetic residue of GA-style prominence** after stress has migrated to the final vocalic position, rather than as an independently assigned prosodic dimension. Speakers do not target pitch as a separate articulatory dimension; loudness and length transfer to the final under final-stress, F0 stays behind. The "two prominences" pattern falls out of redistribution.

§3.4 now contains: a brief statement of the placement claim; the residue analysis; a diachronic-pathway diagram (Stage 0 GA → Stage 1 transitional → Stage 2 current); cross-linguistic parallels (Tokyo Japanese pitch-accent emergence; tone-from-accent in Bantu); the **etymologically determined / not synchronically predictable** distinction (sharpened from earlier "lexically determined and not predictable from the surface form" framing, which conflated two senses of "predictable"); a structural account of why minimal pairs are scarce (GA stress's segment-shaping power has absorbed most of pitch's potential contrastive workspace); the **GA stress-shift derivational pair** corner (*récord*/*recórd* etc.) as the candidate workspace for genuine pitch-only minimal pairs; **phonetic predictions** under the residue analysis (V_1 should retain slight length and amplitude beyond pure F0; F0 peak nucleus-aligned); and a **pedagogical note** as a teaching artifact.

§1.1 pitch-stress dissociation bullet updated to mention the redistribution-of-prominence framing and point at §3.4. Wording around "independent prosodic features" softened.

§2.3 pitch-accent suprasegmental bullet updated to make the etymological / synchronic distinction explicit, with the English lexical-stress comparison.

§4.4.5 S3 updated to characterize pitch as F0 residue of GA-style prominence after loudness and length transfer to the final, rather than as an independent placement rule. Placement claim and **[Settled]** status unchanged.

§5 contrastiveness question reframed. The contrastiveness open question now flags low minimal-pair density as **structurally expected** under the residue analysis (GA segment-shaping absorbs the workspace), not as evidence of weakness. GA stress-shift derivational pairs are flagged as the candidate corner where genuine pitch-only minimal pairs could survive. A targeted survey is added to pending work.

Orthographic conventions unchanged. Pitch is still marked, because pitch is still lexical, regardless of whether it is analyzed as a feature target or as residue.

Source. Integrated from drafts/integrated/2026-05-06-pitch-accent-diachrony.md (working note, May 2026).

v2.1, May 2026 — diphthongal long vowel; audience-fit reframings; cross-doc fixes

§2.2 — diphthongal long vowel /iɛ/ admitted. The long-vowel category is generalized into two surface types: *monophthongal long vowels* /iː, ɛː, oː, aː, ɨː/ (existing, with ː in IPA) and *diphthongal long vowels* /iɛ/ (new, no ː because the second mora supplies a distinct vowel quality rather than length). Forced by the topic-particle paradigm in language_reference.md §3.7 (the article-incorporating form of the visibility particle *hii* /hi/ is *hiie* /hiɛ/) and by the parallel admission in orthography.md v2.1 (§3.3). The §2.2 "Diphthongs (monomoraic)" header is added to clarify the contrast with bimoraic diphthongal long vowels; the ei vs. iie minimal pair is the cleanest illustration.

§5 — two new open questions. - *Genuine medial /h/ vs. breathy voice.* Whether the topic particles *noho* / *hiho* attest a phonemic /h/ distinct from breathy voice. Parallel question raised in orthography.md §6 with a candidate orthographic disambiguation; phonology owns the phonemic-status side. - *Other /iX/ diphthongal long vowels.* Whether bimoraic diphthongal nuclei beyond /iɛ/ occur (e.g., /io/ as iio).

§6 — glossary cross-reference repointed. The *Concord affixes* entry pointed to retired verb-terminology.md §1.3; repointed to verbal-system.md §4.

§1.3 reframed as background. A note at the head of §1.3 marks the typological-position discussion as analytical context, not required for using the language. Content unchanged. Targeted at the linguistically-aware-learner audience — the typological references (Tashlhiyt, Nuxalk, Salishan, etc.) are valuable but presuppose more typology than the audience needs to use the language.

§3.5 analytical citations relegated to a closing remark. The inline parenthetical "(Selkirk 1986, 1996; Itô & Mester 1992 and later)" is removed from the body and consolidated into a closing "Analytical sources" remark at the end of §3.5. Same intent as the §1.3 reframe.

v2, May 2026 — post-dictionary-batch and post-stress-appendix revision

Structural reorganization. Top-level structure changed from v1's 10-section apparatus-first layout to a 7-section top-down layout: outline → inventories → syllable/metrical structure → diachronic development → open questions → glossary → versioning. The glossary moved to the end; metrical content consolidated into §3 instead of being split between §1.2, §2, and §8; cascade and worked derivations consolidated into §4 instead of being split between §4, §5, §6, and §7.

Inventory additions. - /iː/ admitted as a phoneme (§2.2). Previously denied by orthography.md §3.2 and under-acknowledged by phonology.md §3.1. - Geminate sub-inventory (/sː, nː, pː/) admitted (§2.1). - Aspiration confirmed as allophonic, not orthographically represented (§2.1).

New rules added to §4.4. - /s/ → /sː/ at syllable boundary preceding stress. - /p/ → /b/ before /ɛ, ɛː/, blocked elsewhere. - /pp/ ambisyllabic → /pː/. - /nd/ in coda → /nː/ by regressive assimilation. - /æ/-before-nasal → /ɛː/ via tense-/æ/-with-preserved-duration pathway. - Initial unstressed /ə/ → /ɛ/ (added to E5). - E2 family replacing v1's generic E2: E2a /t/→/ʔ/, E2b /d/→∅ no comp lengthening, E2c /l/-paths flagged open, E2d /ʔ/ stable with lexical exceptions. - C-Coal: sister rule to M1 for /h/+tap coalescence in onset.

Rules softened or retired. - Coda /ʔ/'s "never elides" softened to admit lexical exceptions in grammaticalized particles. - /ai/ → /iː/ ~ /eː/ extended to three-way: /iː/ ~ /eː/ ~ /i/ (conditioning open). - v1's degenerate-foot minimality clause (§8.1) retired. Light-monosyllabic feet are licensed.

Appendix analysis. The §3.5 analysis is new in v2: post-stress syllabic-consonant material is now treated as appendix (adjoined to the prosodic word above the foot level), not as sesquisyllabic. The term *sesquisyllabic* is retired from the conlang's description and flagged in the glossary as borrowed-but-misapplied.

Worked derivations updated. Existing rows for *Jennifer*, *Rochester*, *countenance* updated to use appendix terminology. New rows added for the dictionary entries *beussou*, *rhiiysseunnou*, *rhiiynii*, *epplii*, *toutw*, *ŕe*.

Open questions reset. §5 reorganized into "carried forward," "newly opened in v2," and "closed by v2." Closures total 14 items; new opens total 9.

Predecessor: May 3 2026 pitch-accent revision. v2 builds on the May 3 revision that introduced pitch-stress dissociation (pitch on the historical-GA-stress vowel, stress on the final vocalic position), the V_1-pitch / V_2-nasalization orthographic convention, the right-headed foot construction analysis (which collapsed v1's D1 quantitative metathesis rule), and the corrected *Emily* and *Emma* derivations. All May 3 closures and additions are preserved in v2.

v1 (pre-May 3 2026)

Original document. Established the four-process pipeline framing (§1.1), the rule inventory (E1–E5, M1, R-Assim, S1–S3), the cascade tables, and the worked derivations table. Closed by v2 in places where dictionary work or the May 3 session forced commitment.

Orthography

Version: v2.4 (May 2026) **Predecessor:** v2.3 (retirement-paragraph trim); v2.2 (pedagogical-game references stripped); v2.1 (diphthongal long vowels admitted); v2 (pitch-revision integration and dictionary-batch closures); v1 (original).

This v2.3 revision trims a redundant retirement paragraph from §3.7 — the "ba-DUM vs. DUM-DUM feet" framing was already retired across the body of the document, with the canonical retirement record kept in phonology.md §6 glossary entries (*Spondee*, *Stress clash*). Specific changes are listed in §7 (Versioning Notes).

A dedicated reference for the conlang's writing system. The orthography uses Latin script with load-bearing diacritics in the manner of Vietnamese — diacritics are not decorative, and ignoring them collapses minimal pairs.

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1. Design Principles

The orthography encodes:

- Vowel **length**, via Vu digraphs whose u traces the historical smoothed schwa. The iiy digraph is a special case for /iː/ (see §3.2).

  On the IPA convention for long vowels: where the length digraph supplies a *distinct vowel quality* in its second graph (as in iie /iɛ/, see §3.3), the IPA does not carry an additional length mark — the second-quality vowel is what makes the digraph bimoraic. Where the digraph's second graph reflects historical schwa or glide that has been absorbed into pure length (Vu, iiy), the IPA carries ː. The orthographic length pattern, not a uniform IPA convention, is what identifies a digraph as bimoraic.

- Vowel **nasalization**, with the diacritic placement reflecting the segment that historically carried the nasal feature.
- Consonant **devoicing**, via acute accent on sonorants and on s.
- Consonant **gemination**, via doubled letters (ss, nn, pp).
- **Pitch accent**, via acute on a vowel.
- **Stress**, via grave on a vowel — normally unwritten because predictable, marked in formal/pedagogical text.
- **Pitch–stress coincidence**, via circumflex (formal register).
- **Breathy voice**, via VhV. The feature is allophonic, not phonemic. **[Settled]** The VhV notation is stable; the proposed VhU variant for disambiguating medial /h/ from breathy voice is not adopted.

Three structural choices invert what a GA-literate reader would expect, and are worth flagging up front:

1. **s represents /z/ in non-onset position; in onset, s represents /s/.** This is consistent with the conlang's history: GA /s/ debuccalized to /h/, and onset /s/ in the conlang derives only from GA /st/ (which gave conlang /ts/ in some environments and /s/ in others). The voiceless reading in onset is therefore predictable, and ś (the explicit-devoiced spelling) is reserved for non-onset position where the contrast with /z/ is real. See §2.2.
2. **Digraphs do real phonemic work.** rh is the only way to write /ɻ/, distinct from bare r /ɾ/. Vu digraphs (and iiy) are the only way to write long vowels — single-letter doubling does *not* mark vowel length. (Single-letter doubling on consonants *does* mark gemination — see §2.4.)
3. **Doubled vowels mark hiatus, not length.** aa is /a.a/, oo is /o.o/, ee is /e.e/. The one apparent exception is ii, which represents the gliding short /i/ inherited from the GA "long-e" /ɪi/ quality — historically a sequence, synchronically a single syllable. See §3.3.

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2. Consonants

2.1 Single-letter and digraph consonants

Grapheme	IPA	Notes
s	/s/ in onset, /z/ elsewhere	See §2.2.
ś	/s/	Used in non-onset position to mark devoicing of underlying /z/. Not used in onset (where s is already /s/).
š	/ʃ/	Caron.
r	/ɾ/	Alveolar tap — by far the more common rhotic.
rh	/ɻ/	Retroflex approximant. Digraph.
þ	/θ/	Thorn.
ð	/ð/	Eth.
y	/j/	Palatal approximant. Not a vowel.
w	/w/	Labio-velar approximant. Occurs almost exclusively in consonant clusters; most GA /w/ either merged with rh /ɻ/ or elided.

Other consonants (b, t, k, l, h, n, m, etc.) take their expected IPA values. Recall from phonology.md that k and l occur only in clusters, and h is the regular reflex of GA /s/ in most positions. Aspiration on voiceless stops is allophonic (English-style: aspirate in stressed onsets) and is not represented orthographically.

2.2 The s / ś / ss system

The interaction of the s graphemes is one of the orthography's more subtle points. Three rules govern it:

Onset s is /s/. Onset s derives only from the GA /st/ → /s/ pathway (GA /s/ having debuccalized to /h/ in onset elsewhere). There is no underlying /z/ in onset, so onset s is unambiguously /s/. The ś grapheme is therefore not used in onset position; the explicit-devoicing mark adds no information.

Non-onset s is /z/. Intervocalic and final s represents /z/ by default. To mark a voiceless /s/ in these positions, write ś.

Doubled ss is /sː/ (geminate). This applies regardless of position. The geminate is voiceless throughout. *beussou* /ˌbɛːˈsːoː/ "to fall asleep" and *rhiïysseunnou* /ɹ̥iːsːɛːnːoː/ "to be different" both show the geminate at the syllable boundary preceding stress. A formal-register variant śś is licensed but not standard; in casual writing, ss is canonical for the geminate.

2.3 The devoicing diacritic

An **acute accent on a consonant** marks devoicing. This applies productively to the sonorants and to s in non-onset position:

Grapheme	IPA
ń	/n̥/
ḿ	/m̥/
ŕ	/ɾ̥/
ś	/s/ (i.e., devoiced /z/, in non-onset position)

Voiceless sonorants generally surface as reflexes of elided coda obstruents, or from the M1 / C-Coal mechanism in onset (see phonology.md §4.4.4). Acute is the consistent way to write that devoicing wherever it occurs.

2.4 Gemination: doubled consonants

Doubled consonants represent geminates — single phonemes with double duration, sharing onset and coda position across a syllable boundary. Three are attested in the lexicon:

Grapheme	IPA
ss	/sː/
nn	/nː/
pp	/pː/

Geminates arise from two diachronic feeds (see phonology.md §2.1): phonologization of GA ambisyllabic consonants in stressed-second-syllable environments (*beussou*, *epplii*), and cluster collapse such as /nd/ → /nː/ by regressive assimilation (*rhiïysseunnou*).

The convention generalizes: any future-attested geminate /C:/ is spelled CC. This is independent of the Vu length convention for vowels, which uses an explicit second letter rather than doubling.

Labialized geminate /kʷ:/. A special case: the labialized geminate /kʷ:/ (attested in *nocquî* < *not quite*) has two candidate spellings. **cqu** treats the combination as c (first /k/) + qu (/k/ + labial /w/); **kkw** treats it as doubled kk (geminate) + w (labial). Both are valid; neither is yet canonical. [Open: standardize one spelling.]

2.5 Approximants and syllabicity

Per phonology.md §3.5, complex consonant clusters — including syllabic ones — can occur in appendix position after the stressed final vowel of a word. This means y /j/ and w /w/ can appear in syllabic position postvocalically.

Phonetically, a syllabic /j/ in such a position can be near-indistinguishable from an unstressed /i/, and a syllabic /w/ from an unstressed /o/. *Phonemically* they remain consonants: their distribution is governed by consonantal phonotactics (occurring in cluster positions, after the stressed nucleus), not by the vowel-distribution rules. The parallel is to Proto-Indo-European, whose approximants likewise had vowel-like syllabic realizations that complemented a minimal vowel inventory while remaining phonemically consonantal.

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3. Vowels

3.1 Short vowels

Grapheme	IPA	Notes
i	/ɪ/	Short lax.
ii	/i/	Short tense, with the gliding /ɪi/ quality inherited from GA "long e." Single syllable, written as a sequence. See §3.3.
e	/ɛ/	
a	/ɑ/	
o	/o/	
æ	/æ/	Residual /æ/ — did not fully collapse into /e:/.
œ	/oe/	The diphthong /oe/, monosyllabic.

Note that bare u does **not** occur as a grapheme: it appears only as the second element of a length digraph (§3.2). And y, despite the visual resemblance to an i-ish letter, is the consonant /j/ (§2.1), not a vowel.

3.2 Long vowels: Vu digraphs and iiy

Long vowels are written with explicit-second-letter digraphs, never by doubling. There are two graphemic patterns: Vu for the four long vowels whose source is smoothed-schwa (or related vocalic reanalysis), and iiy for /iː/.

The Vu digraphs

Grapheme	IPA	Source
au	/ɑː/	smoothed a + ə
eu	/ɛː/	smoothed e + ə (and: /æ/-before-nasal via tense-/æ/-with-preserved-duration; see below)
iu	/ɨː/ (phonemically /ɪː/)	GA /u/ unrounded and fronted; historical laxness reanalyzed *as length itself*, leaving the long vowel where the back vowel had been
ou	/oː/	smoothed o + ə (and: /au, or/ → /oː/)

The u traces the historical smoothed schwa from intervocalic consonant elision (see phonology.md §4.1).

The iu case is the most theoretically interesting: there is no phonemic /ɨ/ in the conlang. The lax-back-vowel quality of GA /u/ was reinterpreted as length on the lax-front /ɪ/ axis, so what surfaces phonetically as /ɨː/ patterns phonemically as /ɪː/ — i.e., the long counterpart of /ɪ/ rather than its own phoneme.

The eu digraph has **two diachronic feeds** that both surface as /ɛː/:

1. Smoothed schwa: GA /ɛ/ + adjacent /ə/ smooths into long /ɛː/.
2. /æ/-before-nasal: GA pre-nasal /æ/ raises in quality toward /ɛ/ but preserves the tense-lax distinction via greater duration. The conlang reanalyzes that durational difference as length, yielding long /ɛː/ where lax /ɛ/ would have been short. *rhiiysseunnou* /ɹ̥iːsːɛːnːoː/ (< *really stand out*) shows this pathway.

The orthographic digraph is unified across both feeds — the spelling eu doesn't distinguish them, and the surface /ɛː/ is the same.

The ou digraph also has two feeds: smoothed schwa and the /au, or/ → /oː/ merger. Same unification principle.

The iiy digraph for /iː/

/iː/ is a phoneme of the conlang, spelled iiy. It arises principally from /ɪji/-smoothing — the pathway in which /ɬ/ between high front vowels glides to /j/, and the resulting /ɪji/ sequence smooths into /iː/. *Emily* /ɛˈmiː/ (<

/ˈɛməli/) and *rhiiynii* /ɹiːni/ "to need" (< *really need*, with the bleached *really*-prefix carrying the long /iː/) both show this pathway.

The iiy shape captures the etymology orthographically: ii is the gliding short tense /i/ (from GA "long-e" quality, see §3.3), and the trailing y reflects the historical glide that produced the length. Phonemically, iiy is a unitary /iː/, not a sequence — but the spelling preserves the visible trace of how the long vowel was formed.

A working rule of thumb: **iiy for /iː/ where there is an etymologically-justified glide source.** Where /iː/ might arise by other pathways without a glide source, the spelling convention is **[Open]** — possibilities include iiy extended by analogy, or bare ii for glide-source-less /iː/. This will be locked when more derivations attest the alternatives. To date, all attested /iː/ in the lexicon come from the /ɪji/-smoothing pathway and are spelled iiy.

3.3 Doubled vowels: hiatus, plus the special case of ii

Doubled vowels mark **hiatus** (two syllables) rather than length:

Grapheme	IPA
aa	/a.a/
ee	/e.e/
oo	/o.o/

The apparent exception is ii, which is *not* a hiatus form. It represents the short tense /i/ with its gliding /ɪi/ quality — historically a vowel-glide sequence, synchronically a single syllable. The shape ii captures the gliding quality visually while the form behaves as a single nucleus.

Genuine /i.i/ hiatus is therefore written iyi, with y /j/ inserted to give the syllable boundary a real consonantal segment to live on. The y is not a vowel here — it is the regular palatal approximant doing what it normally does between vowels.

/i.a/ hiatus is written iia: the first syllable is the gliding /i/ (ii), and a follows directly. A new pattern, **iie /iɛ/**, attests a third row in the analysis: ii plus e marks neither hiatus nor a short diphthong, but a *bimoraic long diphthong* — a length pattern parallel to Vu and iiy, in which the second graph (e) supplies a distinct vowel quality rather than smoothing into pure length. The full contrast:

Grapheme	IPA	Type	Morae
ia	/ia/	diphthong, monosyllabic	1
iia	/i.a/	hiatus, disyllabic	2 (separate syllables)
iie	/iɛ/	long diphthong, monosyllabic	2 (single nucleus)
ea	/e.a/	hiatus, disyllabic	2 (separate syllables)

The iie pattern is the first attestation of a **diphthongal long vowel** — a single bimoraic nucleus whose two morae carry different vowel qualities. Diachronically it parallels the Vu digraphs: a base vowel (here /i/) absorbs a following schwa as length, except that fronting under the influence of the preceding /i/ raises the schwa to /ɛ/ rather than smoothing it into pure length. The orthography records the etymology in the second graph.

This forces a small generalization of the long-vowel system: long vowels in the conlang are **bimoraic nuclei**, of which there are now two surface types — *monophthongal long vowels* (Vu, iiy, with a length mark in IPA) and *diphthongal long vowels* (iie, where the second graph's vowel quality marks the second mora and no IPA length mark is used).

The contrast with the existing ei /ei/ diphthong (§3.4) is preserved and now classifiable: ei is a **monomoraic** diphthong (with /j/ as a consonantal glide), while iie is a **bimoraic** diphthong (with /ɛ/ as a vocalic second mora). The conlang has two diphthong classes distinguished by mora count.

By analogy, additional diphthongal long-vowel digraphs are predictable but currently unattested — iio /io/ would be the parallel form for an /i/-initial bimoraic nucleus with /o/-quality second mora. Whether such forms occur is [**Open**], but the convention generalizes if they do.

The form ea reflects a sound rule rather than just an orthographic convention: historical /ɪ.a/ does not occur, having lowered to /e.a/. The orthography records the surface form. A consequence: the spelling ia is unambiguously the diphthong, never a hiatus form.

3.4 The ei diphthong

The diphthong /ei/ is written ei. Phonemically /ey/ (with y /j/ as the glide), it is a single syllable.

This grapheme is distinct from the length digraph eu /ɛː/ (§3.2): e followed by i is the diphthong, e followed by u is length. The contrast is real and the spelling distinguishes them cleanly.

3.5 The interpunct as optional disambiguator

In pedagogical or formal-register text, an interpunct may be inserted to make hiatus explicit:

- a·a for /a.a/
- o·o for /o.o/
- ii·a for /i.a/

The interpunct is a register marker rather than a phonological one. Casual writing omits it; learning materials, dictionaries, and formal documents include it where ambiguity might otherwise arise.

3.6 Nasalization

Nasalization is marked, but the diacritic differs by segment — historical accident of which marks were in use when which forms were first transcribed.

Tilde is used on the close-front segments and on the approximants:

Grapheme	IPA	Notes
ĩ	/ĩ/	Nasalized short tense /i/.

Grapheme	IPA	Notes
ỹ	/j̃/	Nasalized palatal approximant. Phonotactically capable of syllabic realization (see §2.5); occurrences are expected to be rare.
w̃	/w̃/	Nasalized labio-velar approximant. Even rarer than ỹ.

A note on the absence of į: the lax /ɪ/ does not nasalize, so no ogonek-on-i form occurs.

Ogonek is used on the open and mid vowels:

Grapheme	IPA
ą	/ɑ̃/
ę	/ɛ̃/
ǫ	/õ/

For long vowels (Vu digraphs), the ogonek lands on the u, which is etymologically apt — the u is the smoothed schwa, and historical nasalization rode on schwa-adjacent elided consonants:

Grapheme	IPA
aų	/ɑ̃ː/
eų	/ɛ̃ː/
ių	/ĩː/ (phonemically /ɪ̃ː/)
oų	/õː/

Placement principle: V_1 pitch / V_2 nasalization

Nasalization in the conlang nearly always arises from a historical **V_1nV_2** sequence: /n/ elides and the nasal feature transfers to the surrounding vowels (see phonology.md §4.4.5 S1). In the typical case, V_1 is also the historical-GA-stress syllable (the one carrying pitch under §3.7), and V_2 is the post-elision residue — they're already different vowels. The orthographic convention exploits this:

- **Pitch acute on V_1** (the historical-stress vowel).
- **Nasalization on V_2** (the rightward partner of the original /VnV/ pair).

For long vowels written Vu, V_2 *is* the u, so the existing ogonek-on-u convention falls out as a natural consequence. No diacritic stacking is required in the typical case.

The clash case

A genuine clash arises only when a **short vowel** carries both pitch and nasalization, with no V_2 to host the nasal mark. This is rare and may not actually arise in attested forms. The fallback:

- Pitch acute is always written.
- Nasalization is either left **implicit** (recoverable from etymology and context) or marked etymologically with Vn — writing the historical /n/ as if it had not elided, letting the consonant serve as orthographic carrier for the nasal feature.

So a hypothetical clash form gets either é (implicit nasalization) or én (explicit etymological-spelling nasalization), never ę́. The choice between the two is a register question, parallel to the interpunct.

Stacked diacritics are not the working policy. They might still arise as Unicode renderings of certain combinations, but they are not part of the everyday orthography.

Predictable nasalization left unmarked

When glide nasalization is fully predictable from an adjacent nasalized vowel (e.g., a nasalized vowel immediately preceding or following /j/ or /w/), the glide's nasalization is left orthographically unmarked. The diacritically simpler form (bare y or w) is canonical; the nasalized form (ỹ, w̃) is licensed in hyperprecise transcription but is not standard. Example: *ęy* /ẽj̃/ is written ęy, not ęỹ — the nasalization of /j̃/ is recoverable from the nasalized ę.

3.7 Pitch and stress

Pitch and stress are independent prosodic features (see phonology.md §3.3–3.4) and are marked separately on the orthography. **Three diacritics on vowels** handle them:

- **Acute (´) on a vowel** — pitch accent. Always written, in casual and formal register alike, because pitch is lexically determined and not predictable from the surface form.
- **Grave (`) on a vowel** — stress. Normally unwritten because stress is predictable (always final). Marked only in formal or pedagogical text.
- **Circumflex (^) on a vowel** — pitch + stress coincidence. Combines acute and grave when they would land on the same syllable. Formal register only.

The acute-on-*consonant* devoicing convention (§2.3) is unaffected — pitch and devoicing live on different segment types and don't collide.

The ii-digraph diacritic rule

When a stress or pitch diacritic lands on one element of the ii digraph, the *other* element is written without its dot as **ı** (dotless i). This reduces visual clutter and makes clear which element bears the mark. The convention applies to any diacritic on ii: grave for stress, acute for pitch, or circumflex for coincidence.

Examples: in *béntsıìy*, the stress grave lands on the second i of iiy → written ì; the first i becomes ı. In a form where pitch lands on the first i, the acute makes it í and the second i becomes ı.

Placement on digraphs and syllabic consonants

- **Vu length digraph:** grave (stress) lands on the u, parallel to ogonek-on-u for long nasals. Acute (pitch) lands on the V if pitch is on this syllable.
- **iiy for /iː/:** grave lands on the second i of ii (making the first i dotless ı per the rule above). The trailing y is never marked — it is a semivowel recording the lengthened realization, not a vowel. Acute on the first i if pitch is on this syllable.
- **Syllabic consonants in stressed position:** grave borne by the consonant in pedagogical text (e.g., ẁ for stressed syllabic /w̩/).

Worked examples

GA etymon	Conlang IPA	Casual orthography	Formal orthography	Pitch	Stress
Emma	/ɛma/	éma	émà	/ɛ/	/a/
Emily	/ɛmiː/	émiiy	émıìy	/ɛ/	/iː/
Betty	/bɛi/	béi	béì	/ɛ/	/i/
Jennifer	/rɛ̃ːθw̩/	réųþw	réųþẁ	/ɛ̃ː/	syllabic /w̩/
carrot	/r̥eːʔ/	ŕéuʔ	ŕêuʔ	/eː/	/eː/ (coincide)
barn	/beːn/	béun	bêun	/eː/	/eː/ (coincide)

Monosyllables have pitch and stress on the only available vowel — circumflex in formal register, plain acute in casual.

Multisyllables typically dissociate, with pitch on the historical-GA-stress syllable and stress on the new final position.

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4. Quick Reference Table

Diacritic / device	On consonants	On vowels
Acute (´)	Devoicing: ń ḿ ŕ ś	Pitch: any vowel
Grave (`)	—	Stress: any vowel (formal/pedagogical only; predictable so usually unwritten)
Circumflex (^)	—	Pitch + stress coincidence (formal only)
Caron (ˇ)	š /ʃ/	—
Tilde (˜)	ỹ w̃ (nasalized approximants, rare)	Nasalization on close-front: ĩ

Diacritic / device	On consonants	On vowels
Ogonek (˛)	—	Nasalization on open/mid: ą ę ǫ; on u of length digraphs for long nasals: aų eų ių oų
Doubling	Gemination: ss nn pp	Hiatus: aa ee oo (and special: ii for gliding /i/)
Vu digraph	—	Length: au eu iu ou
iiy digraph	—	Length: /iː/ from /ɪji/-smoothing
ei digraph	—	Diphthong /ei/
h between vowels	—	Breathy voice: VhV
Interpunct (·)	—	Optional hiatus disambiguator (formal register)
Digraph	rh /ɻ/	—
Special letters	þ ð	æ œ

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5. Pedagogical Implication

Because diacritics and digraphs are load-bearing, learning materials must drill minimal pairs distinguished only by these marks. A learner who treats diacritics as ornamental will collapse pairs the language treats as fully distinct.

The richest minimal-pair territories are:

- s vs. ś (/z/ vs. /s/) in non-onset position
- s (single) vs. ss (geminate) — singleton vs. geminate
- r vs. rh (/ɾ/ vs. /ɻ/)
- i vs. ĩ, a vs. ą, etc. (oral vs. nasal)
- a vs. au (short vs. long), and the cross-cutting aa (hiatus) vs. au (length) contrast
- ia vs. iia vs. ea (diphthong vs. /i/-initial hiatus vs. lowered /ɪ/-initial hiatus)
- ei vs. eu (diphthong /ei/ vs. length /ɛː/)
- ii vs. iiy (short tense /i/ vs. long /iː/)
- Pitch-placement contrasts on otherwise homographic forms (acute on V_1 vs. acute on V_2, etc.)

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6. Open Questions

- **Spelling convention for /iː/ outside the etymological-glide environment.** Working rule is iiy where there's a glide source; the convention for /iː/ from other pathways (if any are attested) is undecided. Bare ii for non-glide-source /iː/, or extension of iiy by analogy?

- **Standardization of /kʷː/ spelling.** Both cqu and kkw are valid (see §2.4). Which becomes canonical is open.
- **Whether the interpunct will eventually become obligatory** in any context, or remain a register feature.
- **Treatment of æ in environments where it borders on /eː/** — whether the orthography preserves the etymological æ or follows the surface form.
- **Whether genuine clash cases** (short vowel carrying both pitch and nasalization, with no V_2 to host the nasal mark) actually occur in the lexicon. If so, whether the implicit (é) or Vn (én) route should become the default.

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7. Versioning Notes

v2.4, May 2026 — inventory closures propagated; dotless ı and iiy stress placement settled; predictable nasalization rule added; /kʷː/ spelling noted

Breathy voice closed as allophonic (§1). The design-principles entry for breathy voice now records the settled status: allophonic, not phonemic. The VhU disambiguation variant is not adopted.

Short vowel a (§3.1). Simplified from /ɑ/ ~ /ɔ/ (range, under analysis) to /ɑ/. The /ɑ~ɔ/ variation is allophonic. Parallel to the /ɪ~ɨ/ closure in phonology.md v2.3.

Labialized geminate /kʷː/ (§2.4). Two candidate spellings noted: cqu and kkw. Both valid; neither canonical yet. Open question added to §6.

Predictable nasalization left unmarked (§3.6). When glide nasalization is fully predictable from an adjacent nasalized vowel, the glide is written bare. Canonical example: *ę̃y* ęy (not ę̃ỹ).

ii-digraph diacritic rule and iiy stress placement settled (§3.7). When a diacritic lands on one element of the ii digraph, the other element is written as dotless ı. For iiy /iː/: the stress grave lands on the second i of ii (not on y), because y is a semivowel recording the lengthened realization, not a vowel. The formal orthography for *Emily* is émıìy (not émiiỳ). This resolves the conflict with the earlier dictionary-internal convention.

§6 open questions. Medial /h/ vs. breathy-voice question removed (closed in phonology.md v2.3). /kʷː/ spelling question added.

v2.3, May 2026 — retirement-paragraph trim

§3.7 closing paragraph removed. The paragraph beginning "The earlier framing of pitch in terms of 'ba-DUM vs. DUM-DUM feet' is retired…" is dropped. It was the only retirement-marker in body text rather than a glossary entry, and its content is canonically held in phonology.md §6 glossary entries for *Spondee* and *Stress clash*. The phenomenon is described correctly in current text (§3.7 main body, phonology.md §3.4) as pitch-stress dissociation.

v2.2, May 2026 — pedagogical-game references stripped

§5 lead paragraph reworded. The lead paragraph's references to "the earliest mini-games — the phonology game and the ice cream shop" are removed; the paragraph now motivates the diacritic-as-load-bearing claim on its own terms (drilling minimal pairs in learning materials generally). Parallel to the broader cleanup in language_reference.md v2.3.

v2.1, May 2026 — diphthongal long vowels admitted

Diphthongal long vowels (§3.3). The iie digraph is admitted as a bimoraic long diphthong /iɛ/, parallel to Vu and iiy as a length-encoding digraph but with a vocalic second mora rather than a smoothed-schwa or glide-source second graph. This generalizes the long-vowel system: long vowels are bimoraic nuclei of two surface types (monophthongal and diphthongal). Forced by the topic-particle paradigm in language_reference.md §3.7 (the article-bearing form of the visibility particle *hii* /hi/ "see" is *hiie* /hiɛ/). The IPA convention is clarified in §1: the colon is dropped for diphthongal long vowels because the second graph's vowel quality supplies the length-marking work.

New open question on phonemic medial /h/ (§6). The fossilized topic particles noho /noho/ and hiho /hiho/ (see language_reference.md §3.7) attest genuine medial /h/ between vowels. Whether this is phonemically distinct from breathy voice (currently the sole reading of VhV) is undecided; a candidate disambiguation (VhV for consonantal /h/, VhU for breathy voice) is sketched without commitment. Contextual disambiguation suffices for now.

v2, May 2026 — pitch-revision integration and dictionary-batch closures

Pitch-stress system (May 3 integration). The acute/grave/circumflex three-diacritic system on vowels (§3.7) is integrated into the orthography document. v1 had used "ba-DUM vs. DUM-DUM" foot framing and proposed stacked diacritics for pitch+nasalization clash; both are retired. The current system reflects the May 3 pitch-stress dissociation analysis: pitch lands on the historical-GA-stress vowel, stress on the final vocalic position; the orthography marks them with separate diacritics (acute, grave) plus circumflex for coincidence.

V_1/V_2 placement principle. §3.6 (Nasalization) now includes the V_1-pitch / V_2-nasalization placement rule. Stacked-diacritic policy retired; clash-case fallback specified (é implicit or én explicit-etymological).

s / ś / ss system (§2.2). The s grapheme is now position-dependent: /s/ in onset (where there is no underlying /z/), /z/ elsewhere. ś is reserved for non-onset position where the contrast with /z/ is real. ss is the geminate /sː/ (with formal variant śś). v1's framing of s as uniformly /z/ has been refined.

Geminate-doubling generalization (§2.4). New section establishing that doubled consonants represent geminates: ss /sː/, nn /nː/, pp /pː/, with the convention generalizing to any future-attested /Cː/. v1 had no such rule; the dictionary entries *beussou*, *rhiiysseunnou*, and *epplii* forced its formulation.

/iː/ as a phoneme; iiy as its spelling (§3.2). v1 stated explicitly that "/iː/ does not occur in the conlang." This claim is retired. /iː/ is a phoneme, arising from /ɪji/-smoothing (the /ɫ/-glide-becoming pathway), and is spelled iiy. The spelling captures the etymological glide source. *Emily*, *rhiiynii*, and *rhiiysseunnou* all attest. The convention for /iː/ from non-glide-source pathways (if any) remains open.

eu and ou digraphs unified across two feeds (§3.2). The eu digraph now covers both the smoothed-schwa pathway (v1's only feed) and the /æ/-before-nasal pathway (via tense-/æ/-with-preserved-duration, attested in *rhiiysseunnou*). Similarly ou covers smoothed-schwa and the /au, or/ → /oː/ merger. The orthography unifies these without distinguishing the diachronic source.

ei diphthong clarified (§3.4). New section explicit about the contrast between ei (diphthong /ei/, single syllable) and eu (length /ɛː/). The clarification originated as a dictionary-internal note and is now propagated to the main orthography.

v1 (pre-May 3 2026)

Original document. Established the load-bearing-diacritics philosophy, the consonant inventory and devoicing convention, the Vu length system, the doubled-vowel-as-hiatus rule with ii as exception, the tilde/ogonek nasalization split, breathy voice as VhV. Closed by v2 in places where the pitch revision and dictionary work forced commitment.

The Verbal System

Version: v2.1 (June 2026) **Status:** Sibling reference document, parallel to phonology.md and orthography.md. The language reference's §3.4 is a high-level summary that points here. Supersession history: §16.

Abstract. The verbal system grammaticalizes the subject's relationship to the event: every framed verb commits to either the volitional go-ahead frame (the subject deliberately undertook the event) or the non-volitional get-oneself frame (the subject's relationship to the event is qualified in some other way). The go-ahead side is deliberately compact; the get-oneself side is richer, hosting four readings — happenstance, effortful self-benefit, threshold, and backdrop — selected jointly by frame aspect, concord shape, and the verb's own event structure. The frames do not stand alone: they combine with a pronominal system in which pronouns are aspect carriers, while the language's only tense lives in a small class of matrix particles that scaffold whole clauses with modal meaning. A possession construction derives having, getting, choosing, and giving from frame-plus-nominal combination, with the recognitional-iterative nominal as its deverbal special case; three stative-domain strategies carry the meanings the morphology cannot host. This document is the canonical reference for all of these systems; the verb-lexicon-building methodology lives in its Appendix A.

This document describes the verbal system as it currently stands. Where a question is open, it is flagged; the document does not commit to interpretations the data has not yet supported.

Status tags — [**Settled**] committed; [**Provisional**] current best analysis, expected to hold; [**Open**] explicitly undecided — and the reading conventions for examples and glosses are explained in language_reference.md, "How to read this document set." Terminology follows terminology-registry.md.

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1. Overview

The verbal system grammaticalizes the subject's relationship to the event. Every framed verb commits to one of two sides:

- The **volitional go-ahead** (shorthand: *go-ahead*) — the subject deliberately undertook the event. From GA *go ahead and-*.
- The **non-volitional get-oneself** (shorthand: *get-oneself*) — the subject's relationship to the event is qualified in some way other than straightforward agency. From GA *get oneself-*.

The contrast cuts the action space differently from GA. The attested verb *beussou* (< GA *pass out*) shows it at full power: in the go-ahead frame it means going to bed — a deliberate act — while in the get-oneself frame, on its happenstance reading, it means falling asleep — something that befell the subject. GA needs two different expressions for these; the conlang needs one verb and a choice of frame.

The two sides are asymmetric, and the asymmetry is principled rather than accidental. Deliberateness is a single semantic value, so the go-ahead side does one thing and has a compact paradigm: three frame aspect cells, one concord shape. Non-straightforward agency fans out into several distinct values, so the get-oneself side has a richer paradigm — four frame aspect cells crossed with two concord shapes, hosting four **readings**: **happenstance** (it simply befell the subject), **effortful self-benefit** (the subject brought it about on their own behalf, with effort), **threshold** (the subject is on the approach to a tipping point), and **backdrop** (the activity is the ongoing scene against which something else happens). A useful way to hold the whole system: the go-ahead is the unmarked default — "the subject just did it" — and the get-oneself paradigm carries everything else the language wants to say about how an event and its subject relate.

Three further resources extend the system beyond the paradigm proper. When the meaning to be expressed is a state rather than an event, speakers reach for one of three **stative-domain strategies** (§6). The frames combine directly with nominals in the **possession construction** (§12), which covers having, getting, choosing, and giving; its deverbal special case is the **recognitional-iterative nominal** (§7), marking shared-knowledge type reference and iteration. And above the clause sits a small class of **matrix particles** (§11) — the only tense-bearing elements in the language — which scaffold the clause with modal meaning: that it merely ended up so, that the speaker knows it, needs it, or that it appears so.

> *Analytical note.* The paradigm-side names, the reading names, and their full naming history (including the retired terms *volitive*, *involitive*, *modulated*, *non-volitive*, and the abbreviations PH/AB/INC/PS) are maintained in terminology-registry.md. Prose here uses the registry's canonical terms; interlinear glosses use its compact gloss tags.

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2. The volitional go-ahead frame

The go-ahead frame presents the subject as deliberately undertaking the event. Its paradigm is compact:

- Three frame aspect cells: habitual, progressive, past.
- A single main-verb concord shape.
- No perfect cell (structurally absent — §2.2).

2.1 Origin: the source frame

The go-ahead frame grammaticalized from the GA *go ahead and-* construction: *I went ahead and V-ed* underlies the past cell, *I'm going ahead and V-ing* the progressive, *I go ahead and V* the habitual. The periphrasis has phonologically fused into the frame forms in §2.4; for the frame as a morphological object, see §4.

2.2 The perfect gap

The go-ahead paradigm has no perfect cell. This is a principled absence, not a gap waiting to be filled: the source construction has launching-frame semantics — it points at the moment of undertaking the action — and these clash with the perfect's result-relevance semantics, which orient the action toward its consequences. Any morphologically fused form would also be phonetically clunky. The combination is structurally blocked. **[Settled]**

2.3 Verb classes

The go-ahead frame is incompatible with stative verbs: *go ahead and rhiìynii* ("be in a state of needing") is ungrammatical across all three cells. States are reached through the restricted get-oneself paradigm (§3.6) or through the stative-domain strategies (§6). **[Settled]**

The frame is fully productive with activity, accomplishment, and achievement verbs. Achievements may carry a marked flavor depending on how plausibly the achievement can be construed as deliberate — *find* in the go-ahead frame asserts a deliberate finding, as in a search. This is verb-by-verb pragmatics, not a structural restriction.

2.4 GO-AHEAD paradigm forms

The GO-AHEAD frame agrees for animacy at the habitual cell only; all other cells are invariant across persons and numbers.

Frame aspect	Animacy restriction	GA source	Conlang form
Habitual	Animate (all persons/numbers)	*go ahead and*	*oheun*
Habitual	Inanimate (3SG.INANIM only)	*goes ahead and*	*osoheun*
Imperfect/progressive	—	(*I'm*) *going ahead and*	*ounoheun*
Past	—	*went ahead and*	*beu̯heun*

[Open: animate habitual form — the table's *oheun* parallels *osoheun* exactly (the *goes* sibilant infixed), but a 2026-06-10 correction note reads *ouhen*; confirm one spelling before the next paradigm sweep]

The habitual cell covers both habitual and timeless/general statements. The imperfect form *ounoheun* is the bare gerund shape of the frame; in this construction the pronoun carries the +be fusion (§5.2). The past cell is the preterite *went ahead and*, not a grammatical perfect (which is structurally absent — §2.2).

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3. The non-volitional get-oneself frame

The get-oneself side carries the system's expressive richness. Its paradigm:

- Four frame aspect cells: habitual, progressive, past, perfect.
- Two main-verb concord shapes: infinitive-shaped and progressive-shaped.
- Two of the eight resulting cells are structurally blocked (§3.4), leaving six productive cells.
- Each productive cell hosts one of the four readings.

3.1 Origin: the source frame

The get-oneself frame grammaticalized from the GA *get oneself-* construction: *I got myself V-ing* and *I got myself to V* underlie the two past cells (with progressive-shaped and infinitive-shaped concord respectively); *I had myself V-ing* underlies the perfect; and so on. The fused source produces the GET-ONESELF frame forms in §3.7.

3.2 The cell × reading grid

Frame aspect	+ infinitive-shaped concord	+ progressive-shaped concord
HABITUAL	self-benefit (marked)	happenstance (default)
PROGRESSIVE	threshold (default)	(*blocked: vacuous redundancy*)
PAST	self-benefit	happenstance
PERFECT	(*blocked: result-state requires stative target*)	backdrop

3.3 The four readings

The four readings are working labels; whether they form a unified semantic class — and if so, what the unifying property is — is **[Open]** and translation data are expected to inform it (§9.1). Gloss tags in parentheses.

- **Happenstance** (HAP). The subject finds themselves doing the verb without agency or effort — the event simply befell them. The default reading of the get-oneself frame, hosted by HABITUAL + progressive-shaped and PAST + progressive-shaped concord.
- **Effortful self-benefit** (SELF.BEN). The subject brought the event about on their own behalf, with effort. The reflexive *myself* in the source phrase retains its dative-of-interest force, so the reading carries effortful and evaluative coloring: it took work, and it served the subject. Hosted by HABITUAL + infinitive-shaped concord (marked) and PAST + infinitive-shaped concord.
- **Threshold** (THRESH). The subject is in the process of becoming such that the verb will happen — on the approach to a tipping point. The progressive frame supplies the becoming; the infinitive-shaped concord keeps the verb prospective. Hosted by PROGRESSIVE + infinitive-shaped concord.
- **Backdrop** (BACK). The verb's ongoing activity is the discourse-relevant scene — the *I-was-V-ing-when-X* framing, with experiential or narrative coloring. Hosted by PERFECT + progressive-shaped concord.

3.4 The two blocked cells

Perfect + infinitive-shaped concord (e.g., *had myself to V*) is blocked. The perfect's result-state semantics requires a stative-shaped target; the *to-V* infinitive is too prospective to combine. A clean grammatical gap. **[Settled]**

Progressive + progressive-shaped concord (e.g., *getting myself V-ing*) is blocked. The get-oneself frame already supplies a durative envelope; progressive concord on the main verb adds nothing. The form is vacuously redundant rather than ungrammatical, but it is consistently rejected in well-formedness judgments. **[Settled]**

3.5 Soft preferences within productive cells

- HABITUAL defaults to progressive-shaped concord (happenstance); the infinitive-shaped variant is available but marked, carrying the self-benefit reading.
- PAST permits both shapes productively; the choice is semantically loaded (self-benefit on infinitive-shaped, happenstance on progressive-shaped), not stylistic.

3.6 Readings and verb class

The readings interact with lexical aspect. Stative verbs access happenstance, threshold, and backdrop within the get-oneself paradigm but are blocked from the self-benefit reading, since it requires an action the subject can undertake on their own behalf. The restriction follows directly from what the readings denote. **[Settled]**

How the self-benefit reading selects on counter-benefactive verbs (*catch a cold*, *fall*), whether the threshold reading extends to states or is restricted to action-hosts, and whether HABITUAL + infinitive-shaped concord consistently carries self-benefit or sometimes a weaker effortful flavor, are live questions documented in verb-paradigm-verdict.md §1.5. **[Open]**

3.7 GET-ONESELF paradigm forms

The GET-ONESELF frame agrees for full person and number across all cells. Three frame aspect cells are attested; the fourth (perfect, from GA *had myself V-ing*) is a candidate pending confirmation.

Person	Habitual	Imperfect/progressive	Past
1SG	*remase*	*remmase*	*rimase*
2SG	*rešise*	*renyose*	*rišise*
3SG.ANIM	*retmśe*	*retmmśe*	*ritmśe*
3SG.INANIM	*reutse*	*retnntse*	*riutse*
1PL	*reaśeus*	*retnaśeus*	*riaśeus*
2PL	*rešiseus*	*renyoseus*	*rišiseus*
3PL.ANIM	*retmśeus*	*retmmśeus*	*ritmśeus*

GA sources: habitual from *get* [*oneself*]-, imperfect/progressive from *getting* [*oneself*]-, past from *got* [*oneself*]-. The morphology is discussed further in §5.2, alongside the pronominal paradigm with which GET-ONESELF combines. Inanimate 3SG (the *reutse* series) is restricted to inanimate subjects. Animate 3SG and 3PL share a GA source (*get/got themselves*) and are distinguished by the *-eus* plural suffix. **[Settled]**

4. The frame and main-verb concord

4.1 The frame

The grammaticalized unit that carries volition, frame aspect, and (defective) person/number agreement is the **frame** — the go-ahead frame and the get-oneself frame of §2–3. The frame metaphor captures its function: the same lexical event gets *placed in* an attitudinal context. In morphology-internal discussion the frame is called the **light verb complex (LVC)**, and composite gloss tags use LVC (e.g., LVC.VOL.HAB).

The frame is not a bleached helper. It carries the bulk of the grammatical work and is the heart of the predicate. It is also the locus of the polarity dimension (§10) and of stacking phenomena like nested negation.

Open questions about the frame's grammar:

- **Morphological status** — clitic, affix, separate word, compound element. The term is neutral on this; orthography and syntax decisions will force the question. [**Open**]
- **Agreement features** — what exactly is agreed with: subject, event, both? "Defective person/number agreement" — agreement that is real but does not distinguish every person/number combination — is the working description; the locus needs analysis. [**Open**]
- **Argument structure** — can the frame take nominal complements directly, or always mediated by a preposition? See §12 (The possession construction) for the *with*-mediation facts. [**Open**]

4.2 Concord

The main verb carries the lexical content and takes a **concord affix** — an ending showing concordance with the frame. Two shapes exist: **infinitive-shaped** and **progressive-shaped**. In the get-oneself paradigm the choice of shape selects the reading (§3.2); this is the most semantically loaded work concord does in the system.

The surface forms of the concord endings have not yet been tabulated; the progressive-shaped concord is exemplified by the *-in* of placeholder forms like *relaxin*, but a committed inventory is pending. [**Open: concord-affix surface inventory — what features does concord actually mark beyond the shape contrast (volition, frame aspect, person/number redundantly with the frame)?**]

> *Analytical note.* The term *concord affix* commits only to the agreement function — the most stable of the three effects originally observed (agreement with the frame, interaction with the verb's event structure, pragmatic-salience effects). If the latter two prove to do independent grammatical work, the term may be revisited; candidate replacements and the noncommittal fallback *stem extensions* are held in terminology-registry.md.

A third shape is attested: the **passive-shaped concord**, patterned on the GA passive participle.

> *Rimmase spli·oþw.* /—/ [Placeholder: IPA pending phonology pass] 1SG.LVC.NVOL.PST split-CONCORD "I drifted off / I got split off (from the group)."

The passive shape fills a gap the other two cannot: it delivers a completed event under the get-oneself frame without the threshold coloring of the infinitive shape and without the imperfect aspect of the progressive shape. The same stem across all three shapes:

- *Rimmase spli·oþw* — passive-shaped: completed, happenstance. The natural rendering of "I drifted off."
- *Rimmase splitnoþw* — progressive-shaped: imperfect; wrong aspect for a completed departure.
- *Rimmaseto splitoþw* — infinitive-shaped: right aspect, but threshold-colored — the splitting off took effort.

  Analytical note. In the discovery example the passive shape is conflated with the separative satellite *oþw* (§12 Interactions; terminology-registry.md), because GA *split* has a zero-marked participle — all the visible material belongs to the satellite. Disambiguating the shape from the satellite needs a verb with overt participle morphology (a *got myself taken-* class form). [**Open: passive-shaped concord — confirm with an overt-participle stem**]

Readings are compositional. Translation data show that the reading a clause receives is not a property of a paradigm cell alone: it is the joint product of **frame aspect** × **concord shape** × **the stem's own event structure**, with the matrix particles (§11) available as a further scaffolding layer when the bare frame under-delivers. Three regularities recur:

1. The threshold reading tracks **prospectivity**, surfacing wherever the infinitive shape meets an effortful stem — including past cells (*Rimmaseto splitoþw* above).
2. Beginning-readings ("first noticing," onsets) are intrinsically **imperfect**: available only where the frame aspect supplies ongoing time, never from a perfective cell.
3. Stems whose GA source is lexically volitional resist the happenstance reading bare, and take the get-oneself frame only with scaffolding — a satellite supplying a befall-able event shape, or a matrix particle supplying the happenstance from above (*Enniip remmaseto split* "I ended up leaving").

This is direct evidence on the concord term's standing question: the stem's event structure does grammatical work alongside the shape contrast. The term remains [**Provisional**] on exactly this point. [**Open: concord-affix surface inventory — unchanged; the compositional findings sharpen what the inventory must capture**]

4.2.1 Irregular concord

A small set of verbs preserves GA irregular (strong-verb) morphology in the concord slot where the regular derivation predicts the *-t*(*t*)- infix: *meirtt* (from GA *made it*) where regular *meiktt* plus the infix is expected. Same stem, unexpected exponent — inherited irregularity, not suppletion (terminology-registry.md). [Lexicon: meiktt / concord meirtt not yet entered] [**Open: irregular-concord inventory — collect members as the dictionary grows**]

4.2.2 Concord under suffixation

Concord and incorporated material interact morphophonologically: the *-t*(*t*)- infix surfaces inside particle-incorporating stems (*pikborrô* ~ *piknib·orrô* across frames), and coda material can resurface intervocalically under vowel-initial concord (*bemmorret* ~ *bemmorreųt*). The alternations are attested but not yet standardized. [**Open: concord-suffixation morphophonology**] [New rule needed: coda-rhotic resurfacing under vowel-initial suffixation]

4.3 Worked example

e oheun relaxin — [Placeholder: main-verb surface form pending dictionary derivation]

1SG go.ahead.LVC.VOL.HAB relax-CONCORD "I deliberately relax (as a habit)"

The frame *oheun* carries the volition and the frame aspect (habitual); the main verb carries the progressive-shaped concord. The pronoun and frame forms are attested (§2.4, §5.2); the main verb is a placeholder. For fuller assembled clauses, see §14 (A clause, assembled).

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5. The Pronominal System

The conlang's pronominal system is not a list of stand-alone word-forms. Pronouns are **aspect carriers** — they fuse with aspect, modal, and polarity markers to form the grammatically complex units that clause structure depends on. A clause does not have a subject pronoun and a separate aspect marker; it has a pronominal-aspect complex that does both jobs in one phonological unit.

The practical consequence: the frame paradigms in §2 and §3 do not stand alone. They combine with pronouns, and the combination is what appears in speech. This section describes the combinatorial system.

5.1 Overview and asymmetry

GO-AHEAD and GET-ONESELF pattern differently with respect to what they agree with:

- **GO-AHEAD** (go-ahead frame) agrees for **animacy only**, and only at the habitual cell (§2.4). All other cells are invariant; the pronoun supplies person/number.
- **GET-ONESELF** (get-oneself frame) agrees for **full person and number** across all cells (§3.7). Both the pronominal and frame forms are person-anchored, doubly anchoring the predicate to its subject.

This asymmetry follows from the GA sources: *go ahead and-* did not encode person/number robustly, while *get oneself-* contains the reflexive, which is person-anchored by definition.

5.2 Weak (clitic) pronouns

Weak pronouns are the default subject expression. They are phonologically reduced and carry the grammatical fusions: aspect, prospective/conditional, ability modal, and negation. **A noun subject cannot carry these fusions directly**; it requires a resumptive weak pronoun (§5.4). The full paradigm CSV is at paradigms/pronoun-weak.csv.

Bare (habitual):

Person	Animate	Inanimate
1SG	*e*	—
2SG	*rhi*	—

Person	Animate	Inanimate
3SG	*ey*	*e*
1PL	*rhii*	—
2PL	*rhiau*	—
3PL	*eiau*	—

1SG *e* is syncretic with inanimate 3SG *e* in the bare series — the same 1SG/3SG.INANIM syncretism the prospective and ability series already show (*ew*, *ekw*). The 1SG form is irregular for its GA source (weak pronouns are always unstressed). **[Settled]**

Imperfect/progressive (+be fusion):

Person	Animate	Inanimate
1SG	*em*	—
2SG	*rhia*	—
3SG	*eiia*	*eś*
1PL	*rhiia*	—
2PL	*rhiauœ*	—
3PL	*eiiauœ*	—

In the imperfect construction, the pronoun takes the +be fusion and the frame appears in its bare gerund shape (*ounoheun* for GO-AHEAD; the person-marked GET-ONESELF form for the get-oneself frame).

Prospective/conditional (would):

Person	Animate	Inanimate
1SG	*ew*	—
2SG	*rhiw*	—
3SG	*eyt*	*ew*
1PL	*rhiit*	—
2PL	*rhiw*	syncretic 2SG
3PL	*eyt*	syncretic 3SG.ANIM

Ability modal (could):

Person	Animate	Inanimate
1SG	*ekw*	—
2SG	*rhikw*	—

Person	Animate	Inanimate
3SG	*eykw*	*ekw*
1PL	*rhiikw*	—
2PL	*rhikw*	syncretic 2SG
3PL	*eykw*	syncretic 3SG.ANIM

The modal fusions (would, could) are **restricted to pronouns** — they cannot be expressed analytically on the frame directly. Modal constructions therefore require a pronominal subject; there is no nominal-subject modal construction without a resumptive pronoun.

5.2.1 Negation — the not-quite fusions

The negative fusions grammaticalize GA *don't/doesn't quite* (negative habitual) and *didn't quite* (negative perfective). The conlang forms fuse the pronoun, the *do/did* auxiliary, and the not-quite particle (*nocquî*).

Negative habitual:

Person	Animate	Inanimate
1SG	*eonquii*	—
2SG	*rhionquii*	—
3SG	*eonquii*	*reusnquii*
1PL	*rhiionquii*	—
2PL	*rhionquii*	syncretic 2SG
3PL	*eonquii*	syncretic 3SG.ANIM

Negative perfective:

Person	Animate	Inanimate
1SG	*reunnquii*	—
2SG	*riennquii*	—
3SG	*reunnquii*	*reunnquii*
1PL	*rhiiennquii*	—
2PL	*riennquii*	syncretic 2SG
3PL	*reunnquii*	syncretic 3SG.ANIM

The *do/did* within the fusion carries aspect: *do* = habitual, *did* = perfective. 1SG, 3SG.ANIM, and 3PL share the same negative habitual form (*eonquii*) and the same negative perfective form (*reunnquii*). 3SG.INANIM has its own negative habitual (*reusnquii*) but merges with animate forms in the negative perfective. The negative fusions interact with the polarity dimension — see §10.

5.2.2 Defectiveness and syncretism

The weak paradigm is **defective** at several modal cells: 2PL and 3PL are syncretic with their singular counterparts for the prospective/conditional, ability, and both negative fusions. Distinct forms are preserved only at the bare and imperfect cells.

> *Analytical note.* The modal syncretism is historically motivated: the modal fusions derive from high-frequency colloquial GA sources that leveled person/number agreement early, while the bare and imperfect forms, from more transparently person-anchored sources (*you're* vs. *I'm*), preserved the distinctions longer. [**Provisional**]

5.3 Strong (tonic) pronouns

Strong pronouns are the emphatic counterpart to the weak clitic paradigm. They derive from GA *on* [*POSS*] *end* and carry three functional readings. The full paradigm is at paradigms/pronoun-strong.csv.

Person	GA source	Conlang form
1SG	*on my end*	*bayen*
2SG	*on your end*	*yoen*
3SG.ANIM	*on their end* (sg)	*þeren*
3SG.INANIM	*on its end*	*nitsen*
1PL	*on our end*	*nauen*
2PL	*on y'all's end*	*yoen* — syncretic 2SG
3PL	*on their end* (pl)	*þeren* — syncretic 3SG.ANIM

The GA source phrase had three pragmatic uses that survive as the strong pronoun's three readings:

1. **Emphatic** — contrastive or focus emphasis on the subject. *bayen* = it's *me*.
2. **Possessive** — free-standing possessive. *bayen* = mine.
3. **Topic/frame** — discourse topic-frame. *bayen* = as far as I'm concerned; on my part.

The three readings are not homonymy: context selects the reading. Strong pronouns do not carry aspect fusions; they set a discourse frame that the clause's weak pronoun and frame fill in. 2PL and 3PL are syncretic with their singular counterparts, the plural reading supplied by context or an overt plural NP. [**Provisional — GA source for 2PL is variable (*y'all's end* vs. *your all's end*); confirm**]

A fourth use is **antitopic tagging**: a strong pronoun tags a topic postposed after the clause (right dislocation — §5.4), and the same strong-pronoun phrases serve as boundary markers between layers in stacked matrix-particle constructions (§11). [**Provisional**]

5.4 Left dislocation and resumptive pronouns

Full NPs **cannot** directly take the aspect, modal, or negation fusions that weak pronouns carry. When a full NP is the discourse subject, the construction uses **left dislocation with a resumptive weak pronoun** — the NP sits outside the clause as a topic, and a weak pronoun inside the clause refers back to it and carries the fusion:

> *the coffee — e oheun drinkin* — [Placeholder: NP and main-verb surface forms pending]
>
> coffee.TOP 1SG go.ahead.LVC.VOL.HAB drink-CONCORD "the coffee — I go ahead and drink (it)"

The NP topic is the discourse locus for reference; the resumptive pronoun is the grammatical locus for the fusion. This is the core mechanism by which full nominals access the pronominal-aspect system.

A consequence for clause architecture: the pronominal paradigm is not peripheral marking — it is structural. Argument NPs are expressed through dislocation, not through NP-agreement on the verb. [**Settled**]

Whether the weak pronoun can be omitted when its referent is inferrable is [**Open**] — see §5.6.

Right dislocation. A topic can also be postposed after the clause, with definite coloring retained — but the two peripheries are asymmetrically marked. A left-dislocated topic carries a visibility particle; a right-dislocated topic strips it and is tagged instead with the strong-pronoun *on-X-end* phrase (§5.3). The visibility contrast is a left-periphery-only phenomenon. [**Provisional — wants worked conlang examples**] [Placeholder: right-dislocation example pending — GA pattern: "they went ahead and split, Mark, on their end"] The full information-structure description is the language reference's responsibility (language_reference.md, nominal and discourse sections).

5.5 Interrogative: intonation and *ea* [Provisional]

Interrogative constructions use the **same pronominal form as the indicative**, distinguished by intonation. **There is no do-inversion.**

Yes/no questions add the particle *ea* (from GA *at all*) at the end of the clause:

> *e oheun... ea?* 1SG go.ahead.LVC.VOL.HAB ... Q "Am I going ahead and...?"

Ea marks the proposition as presented for binary verification — *is it the case at all that X?* The "at all" source semantics are preserved: genuine yes/no verification, not rhetorical or presupposing framing.

Ea also marks **conditionals** — "if ... at all" — placing a clause under hypothetical rather than interrogative verification. [Placeholder: conditional example pending] It applies to matrix-scaffolded clauses as to any other (§11). [**Provisional**]

Content questions (who, what, where, when, why) are formed differently and are not yet systematized. [**Open**]

5.6 Pro-drop [Open]

Whether the weak pronoun can be dropped when the subject is referentially recoverable from context is an explicit open question. The conditions for pro-drop — if available at all — require systematic judgment data. Relevant literature on GA-derived or contact-variety pro-drop has been flagged for consultation.

5.7 Irrealis [Open]

A WERE-based irrealis particle is hypothesized on the basis of GA *if I were, as if I were, I wish I were* sources. The form has fused past the point of transparent pronominal structure and is treated as an **analytical irrealis**

particle — it operates above the pronominal layer rather than fusing with the weak pronoun paradigm. Its form, distribution, and aspect-interaction are not yet committed.

6. Stative-domain strategies

When the meaning to be expressed is a state — feelings, attitudes, internal conditions — the go-ahead frame is unavailable, and the get-oneself frame is available only in restricted form (§3.6). Speakers reach for one of three constructional strategies. They are described here as a unified set of resources, without yet committing to whether they are part of the same broader system as the morphological paradigm (§9.2).

All examples in this section are GA-calque placeholders; conlang surface forms await lexicon derivation. [Placeholder: all §6 example sentences]

6.1 Activity-coercion

A lexical strategy. The speaker selects an activity verb that correlates with the desired stative meaning, then frames the activity verb.

> *they are going ahead and smiling for the photo* — used where GA might say *they are happy*.

The strategy reconstructs the stative meaning from the activity's typical correlate. The result is biased toward externalized, observable predicates: the conlang ends up describing displayed happiness rather than internal happiness. **This is a productive feature of the language, not a limitation.**

Activity-coercion requires no new grammatical machinery; it is a lexicon-level choice the frames happen to facilitate.

6.2 Stimulus-promotion

A constructional strategy. The argument structure is rearranged so that the stimulus becomes the grammatical subject and the experiencer becomes the object; the go-ahead frame is then applied to the stimulus.

> *Emma, they going ahead and charming me* — used where GA might say *I like Emma* or *Emma is charming*. *it goes ahead and calls me, a nice warm bath* — non-human stimulus with personification flavor.

This is not a passive in the typological sense — there is no demoting morphology, no by-phrase, no detransitivization. It is subject/object reversal, with the experiencer reanalyzed as a topic-comment object. The strategy is most natural with attitudinal experiencer verbs (*charm*, *captivate*, *soothe*) where the stimulus can plausibly be construed as an actor, and extends naturally to non-human stimuli with affective or poetic flavor.

A pragmatic question the construction has to handle: whether the promoted stimulus is read as deliberately acting or merely as the cause. The reading is context-dependent and disambiguated by the lexical content of the verb (some verbs are natively two-faced, some lean one way).

6.3 Causative

A periphrastic strategy. The get-oneself paradigm's *get X to V* shape is reused with a third-party causer in the *get*-slot.

> *the math professor, they get me to pass out all the time* — the auto-causative *I get myself to pass out* with an external subject. *Emma, they get me to smile all the time* — used where GA might say *I like Emma*.

The causative externalizes the trigger as an agent acting on the experiencer, where stimulus-promotion (§6.2) externalizes the trigger as a quality of the stimulus. The two strategies are not synonymous even when targeting the same GA gloss; they package the relationship differently.

The causative requires an action-host main verb, since *get X to V* selects for an action. It is therefore parasitic on activity-coercion at the verb-choice level: the speaker still has to pick an externalizable activity correlate of the internal state. The two strategies are often deployed together.

6.4 Idiom-level frame blocking

At least one idiom blocks the volitional axis as a unit even though its parts do not. The negated-possession idiom *oo riuś* "out of juice" (≈ tired, depleted) accepts the get-oneself frame (*Rimmase oo riuś* "I got worn out"), the become-verb (*Beń oo riuś*), bare predication (*Au oo riuś a bauyen* "all out of juice, on my end"), and the imperfect (*Em oun oo riuś* "I'm running out of juice") — but not the go-ahead frame. Ordinary "on the X side" adjectival predication, by contrast, combines with both axes. Blocking at the idiom level rather than the verb level is a phenomenon class of its own. **[Open: collect further idiom-level blocks before generalizing]** [Lexicon: riuś, oo not yet entered]

6.5 Open structural questions about the strategies

- **Frequency.** How often each strategy surfaces in everyday discourse, and whether they collectively represent core grammar or peripheral resources. **[Open]**
- **Inheritance of readings by the causative.** Whether the causative inherits the get-oneself paradigm's reading distinctions (e.g., *Emma gets me falling* vs. *Emma gets me to fall*) or collapses the cells. **[Open]**
- **Stacking.** Whether the strategies can compose — e.g., stimulus-promotion of a causative — or are mutually exclusive. **[Open]**

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7. The recognitional-iterative nominal construction

A grammaticalized construction operating on **deverbal nominals** — a verb's action treated as a noun, the territory GA covers with the gerund (*the running*, *the eating*). It is one of the conlang's flagship grammatical innovations and is analyzed as the **deverbal special case of the possession construction** (§12): the frames engage the nominal exactly as they engage any noun, and what is special here is the nominal's own morphology and one piece of supporting syntax.

7.1 The two morphemes

The construction stacks the **recognitional marker** (REC, *þ* ~ *y*, from GA *the*: shared-knowledge type reference) and optionally the **iterative marker** (ITER, *-ś*, from plural *-s*: repeated instances) on a deverbal nominal; attested together in *þ rishś* "the dishes (you know the chore)." Glossing pattern: REC-stem-ITER. The canonical morphological description — forms, stacking, and the morphology-scoped open questions — is language_reference.md §3.2.1; this document holds what the construction does with the frames.

7.2 The frame meets the recognitional nominal

> *Rimmase ię þ rishś, a bayen, een een.* /—/ [Placeholder: IPA pending phonology pass] 1SG.LVC.NVOL.PST do.CONCORD REC dish-ITER on 1SG.end again again "I got (myself) doing the dishes, on my end, again and again."

The frame combinatorics — which frame, which frame aspect, what the combination means — are the possession construction's (§12), and the habitual reading is compositional: recognitional type + iteration + frame engagement. Two features distinguish the deverbal case from a plain noun in the same construction:

1. **The recognitional exponent.** The deverbal nominal takes *þ* ~ *y* where a plain noun takes the merged article *o*.
2. **Helper-verb support.** On the get-oneself side the deverbal nominal requires a helper verb (*ię* above, from GA *doing*); on the go-ahead side, the grammaticalized *with*. A plain noun combines bare on the get-oneself side. The helper-verb system is deliberately open — see §12.

> *Analytical note.* This construction was previously analyzed as free-standing, with the *with*-mediation treated as its own complement pattern. The possession data reanalyzed it as a special case: the same frame-plus-nominal machinery covers plain nouns ("got myself a drink") and deverbal nominals ("got myself doing the dishes"), with the residue listed above blocking full reduction. The reasoning record lives in phase4-triage-2026-06.md §2.1 and the registry entry.

7.3 Not a definite article

Glossing the *the*-morpheme as DEF would be etymologically accurate but functionally misleading: the morpheme does not pick out a definite referent. It presupposes addressee familiarity with the *type*, not uniqueness of reference. **[Settled]**

A consequence for the noun system: GA's definite article has not survived as a definite article. Definite reference, where needed, is conveyed through other means (the visibility particles, possessives, context); that system is the responsibility of the language reference's nominal sections (language_reference.md §3.2, §3.7), not this document.

> *Origin.* The grammaticalization path *definite article → recognitional marker* is well-attested cross-linguistically; the term *recognitional* is sourced from the determiner-typology literature (Himmelmann and others) for exactly this "you-know-the-one" function. GA *the* is in fact an **etymological doublet** in the conlang: its referential use weakened and merged with *a* into the article *o*, while

its recognitional use fused onto the nominal and kept its segmental integrity as *þ ~ y* — divergent reduction paths from one etymon, on the pattern of Latin *ille* yielding both the Romance articles and the third-person pronouns. Like the volition contrast, the construction grammaticalized from a high-frequency GA function word and restructures semantic territory GA does not grammaticalize.

7.4 Open questions

The morphology-scoped questions (bare REC; ITER without REC; scope relative to other nominal morphology) live with the morphemes at language_reference.md §3.2.1. Construction-scoped questions are the possession construction's (§12.5).

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8. Verbs and the verbal system

This section is the descriptive home for the lexicon-side facts that bear on which verbs participate richly in the verbal system. The procedural counterpart — the methodology for fleshing out the verb lexicon — lives in Appendix A and points back here.

8.1 Three relationships between verbs and the volition contrast

Verbs sit in one of three relationships to the volition system, a property of the verb's inherent semantics interacting with the go-ahead/get-oneself contrast.

Polysemy-resolving. GA already lexicalized two semantically related events under one form, and the conlang's frame choice disambiguates. *beussou* (< *pass out*): go to bed (go-ahead) vs. fall asleep (get-oneself, happenstance). This category is small and found, not constructed — the verbs are inherited from GA's polysemy. Likely candidates: *fall, catch, drop, lose, take, get*.

Aspectual-shift. The two frames do not name different events; the get-oneself reading shifts the aspectual profile of the same event. The go-ahead cell tends to be punctual, agentive, bounded; the get-oneself cell processual, stative-like, unbounded. *remember*: deliberate retrieval (go-ahead) vs. involuntary slide into a state of remembering (get-oneself, happenstance). Cognitive and perceptual verbs (*notice, realize, see, understand, learn, recognize*) are typical here.

Attitudinal. The frame choice does evaluative work: same action, different framing of how the subject came to be doing it. *chit-chat*: a deliberately maintained Sunday routine (go-ahead) vs. getting roped into one at the store (get-oneself, happenstance). Most of the verb stock lives here.

The proportions matter: polysemy-resolving is small and closed; attitudinal is the workhorse open category.

8.2 Stative verbs

Stative verbs (*know, want, have, be*) need a principled handling decision before entering the system — they do not sit in the go-ahead frame at all, and the get-oneself frame gives them only restricted access (happenstance, threshold, backdrop, but not self-benefit; §3.6).

The three stative-domain strategies (§6) handle most of the territory the morphological paradigm cannot host. Many stative meanings will end up expressed via the strategies rather than by direct stative entries; the bare lexical stative (the *rhiiynii* class, "need/want") is reserved for the irreducibly internal cases. How statives that resist all three strategies are handled — suppletion, simply not framing, or some other mechanism — is [**Open**].

8.3 The deverbal nominal layer

The recognitional-iterative construction (§7) reaches into GA's gerund/nominalization territory and is therefore richer for some verbs than for others. A useful diagnostic: does the GA source have a salient deverbal nominal use? *The walk, our walks* — yes. *The eating* — partial. *The being* — essentially no. Verbs with strong deverbal use participate richly in the recognitional-iterative register; verbs without are action-bound and show their personality primarily through the frames. Verbs with **both** rich deverbal nominalization and clear frame contrasts are the highest-value targets for fleshing out.

8.4 How GA history shapes the verb lexicon

The conlang does not inherit GA verbs; it inherits **GA verb uses** — specific constructions that survived three diachronic processes.

Selection. A GA verb participates in dozens of constructions; only some survive. Selection is biased by frequency (high-frequency uses survive), colloquial grammaticalization (uses already drifting toward grammatical function in colloquial GA are favored), and fit with conlang grammar (uses that slot into the frames, the recognitional-iterative system, or the stative strategies are favored).

Reanalysis. Surviving uses are re-fit into the conlang's grammar: GA *take a walk* (light verb + deverbal noun) → recognitional-iterative nominal; GA's volition-bearing adverbials (*on purpose*, *accidentally*) → the grammaticalized frames; GA's shared-knowledge uses of *the* → the recognitional marker; colloquial GA *get oneself V-ing / to V* → the get-oneself paradigm with concord shape selecting the reading.

Loss with replacement. Where the conlang's phonology collapses two GA verbs: one may win and the other die; both may survive but specialize (one taking the go-ahead cell, the other the get-oneself); a periphrasis may fill the gap. **Homophonous merger from sound change is a productive lexical source** — two semantically adjacent stems collapsing into one form gives the conlang verbs whose polysemy is created by its own diachrony, with the frames or the reading grid doing the disambiguating work GA did segmentally.

Three semantic shift patterns recur across these processes: **narrowing** (a broad GA verb survives in one use: *countenance* → just "face"), **specialization driven by grammar** (when the system forces speakers to commit to a reading, the more frequent cell shifts the verb's perceived core meaning), and **accretion of grammatical material** (high-frequency verbs absorb bits of the frame sources into their stems, producing suppletion and verbs that "feel" inherently go-ahead or get-oneself).

9. Open questions about the system as a whole

Several questions about the system's structure are explicitly held open. They are not gaps to be filled by guessing; they are questions waiting on data.

9.1 Are the four readings a unified semantic class?

Happenstance, self-benefit, threshold, and backdrop share a frame (the get-oneself paradigm) and a selection mechanism (frame aspect × concord shape). Whether they share a *semantic dimension* is unclear.

Three of them can be ordered roughly along a scale of how the subject's agency is qualified — agency removed (happenstance), agency on a trajectory (threshold), agency turned inward and effortful (self-benefit). Backdrop is harder to place: it is about discourse status rather than agency per se, though one reading is that "agency backgrounded" is just discourse-framing seen from the agency side.

Two views are live:

- **Unified umbrella.** All four are forms of agency-modulation, with backdrop as the discourse-end of the dimension. This view supports a unifying term for the inventory.
- **Co-grammaticalized.** Three are agency-modulation; backdrop is a discourse-framing function that shares morphology with the others by co-grammaticalization, as is typologically common. This view treats the inventory as a structural set, not a semantic class.

Translation-task data are expected to bear on this — particularly whether backdrop surfaces in discourse contexts similar to the others or in distinctly narrative ones. [**Open**]

9.2 Are the stative-domain strategies part of the same broader system?

The strategies (§6) are functionally continuous with the morphological paradigm: they handle subject-event relationships the morphology cannot host. Whether they belong in the same chapter as the frames, or in a sibling chapter cross-referenced with it, depends on how integral they prove. If they surface constantly in everyday speech (plausible, given how much speech is about internal states), they are core grammar; if reached for occasionally, sibling treatment is appropriate. [**Open**]

9.3 Is the self-benefit reading on equal billing?

The self-benefit reading is distinctive — the only reading that adds evaluative coloring rather than reducing or qualifying agency — and may also be the rarest. Whether to treat it as a full reading on equal billing or as a marked emphatic with a more specialized term depends on its frequency and contexts of use. [**Open**]

9.4 Are there readings the current inventory is missing?

The four readings were identified through systematic exploration of the frame-aspect × concord-shape grid. Translation tasks may surface meanings the inventory cannot host gracefully — candidates noted include avertive (*almost V-ed*), evidential (*must have V-ed*), and try-but-fail. Whether any warrants a new reading, a new strategy, or simply lexical handling is [**Open**].

9.5 Terminology status

The terminology in this document is tracked in terminology-registry.md, which records each term's status, shorthand, gloss tag, and full history of alternatives. Terms expected to be revisited when §9.1–9.4 settle: the class term *reading* (if §9.1 settles for the unified-umbrella view, a unifying name for the dimension may be warranted), *stative-domain strategies* (if §9.2 settles for integral-system inclusion), and the system's overall name (currently the generic *verbal system*). [**Open**]

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10. Polarity and negation

Status: [Provisional — the polarity dimension predates the §2–3 paradigm structure and awaits reconciliation with it; see the analytical note below.]

The system has a **polarity** dimension (positive vs. negative) alongside volition. The two negative values grammaticalized from distinct GA source phrases, each pairing with one paradigm side:

	Positive	Negative
Go-ahead	VOL.POS — deliberately doing	VOL.NEG — deliberately not doing; declining. From GA *pass on-*.
Get-oneself	NVOL.POS — happening to do	NVOL.NEG — failing to; falling short. From GA *not quite-*.

The negative meanings are not symmetrical: the go-ahead negative is a refusal (the subject declined), while the get-oneself negative is a shortfall (the subject didn't quite get there). On the pronominal side, the not-quite negative surfaces as the fused pronoun forms of §5.2.1.

10.1 Nested negation

A productive stacking phenomenon: a get-oneself negative applied over an already-negative go-ahead form yields obligation.

> [NVOL.NEG] [VOL.NEG] (do) → "cannot fail to do" → "must do"

The compositional logic: VOL.NEG marks deliberate refusal; NVOL.NEG marks failure-to. "Failing to deliberately decline" is the inability to choose otherwise — obligation. This is one of the few productive stacking phenomena in the frame.

Open questions:

- Which of the four polarity-bearing markers can productively nest, and in what orders? [**Open**]
- Whether the resulting forms are fully compositional or have idiomatic readings. [**Open**]
- Whether some compositions are blocked or replaced by suppletive forms. [**Open**]

- **Glossing convention for nested constructions.** Candidates: stacked tags LVC.NVOL.NEG=LVC.VOL.NEG, or a dedicated obligation gloss OBLIG once the construction is treated as conventionalized. [**Open**]

10.2 The reconciliation problem

Analytical note. The polarity framework above was developed before the §2–3 paradigm structure (three go-ahead cells; six productive get-oneself cells with readings) and has not yet been integrated with it. Specific tensions: (1) the four-cell grid uses a binary contrast — how does polarity distribute over the richer paradigms; does each productive cell have a negative counterpart, or is polarity more selective? (2) *pass on-* and *not quite-* are GA periphrases on the same model as the frame sources — are they frames in their own right, with their own aspect grids, or polarity markers within the existing frames? [**Open**] (3) How does each reading negate — does happenstance negate as "didn't happen to V," as "happened to not-V," or both? (4) How do the stative-domain strategies interact with negation? [**Open**] The polarity dimension is one of the conlang's distinctive features and is not being deprecated; it needs re-fitting to the more articulated paradigm structure.

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11. The matrix particles

A small class of particles places a whole clause inside a modal frame — that something merely *ended up* so, that the speaker *knows* it, *needs* it, or that it *appears* so. These are the **matrix particles** (informally, *scaffold particles*): each descends from a GA matrix clause, and each colors everything that follows it.

Enniip ounoheun splitn. /—/ [Placeholder: IPA pending phonology pass] MP.ENDUP.PST LVC.VOL.IPFV split-CONCORD "It ended up that (they) went ahead and left."

Two facts make the class architecturally important. The matrix particles are the only place in the language where **tense** survives: the verbal system runs on aspect, carried by the weak pronouns (§5.2), while the matrix particles carry a past/non-past contrast inherited from their source clauses. And they are unmarked for **person** — *enniip* reports an outcome without saying whose.

11.1 Forms

Member	Non-past	Past	GA source	Meaning
end-up particle	*enp*	*enniip*	(*it*) *end*(*ed*) *up* …	happenstance outcome
know-that particle	*no*	*nii*	(*I*) *know/knew* (*that*) …	knowledge, awareness
really-need particle	*rhi·iiniies*	*rhi·iiniir·ros*	*what I need*(*ed*) *is* …	desire; weak obligation

Member	Non-past	Past	GA source	Meaning
appears particle	*piies*	**[Open: past form unattested]**	(*it*) *appears* (*that*) …	appearance, seeming

The really-need particle has a reduplicated intensive, *rhi·ii·rhii·niies*, from GA *what I **really** need is ….* [Lexicon: all four members pending dictionary entries]

11.2 Function

The tense contrast is **privative**: the non-past member is unmarked and combines freely with habitual and future time adverbs, while the past member asserts a realized state of affairs. [Placeholder: adverb-combination examples pending — ”always end up …”, ”tomorrow, probably end up …” attested as judgments only]

The really-need particle codes want and, more weakly, must:

> *Rhi·iiniies ounahen splitn.* /—/ [Placeholder: IPA pending phonology pass; frame form spelling pending the §2.4 paradigm question] MP.NEED LVC.VOL.HAB split-CONCORD "What I need is to leave."

11.3 Distribution

- **Position.** The matrix particle precedes the clause it scaffolds; a topic precedes the matrix particle: **topic particle** > **matrix particle** > **clause**.
- **Aspect government.** Each particle lexically specifies whether the scaffolded clause keeps its own aspect. The end-up particle forces the imperfect — the clause surrenders its aspect (*Beų̨heun split* "went ahead and left," but *Enniip **ounoheun** splitn*, with the imperfect frame). The know-that particle imposes nothing: *No ei beų̨heun split* "I know that they went ahead and left." **[Open: government class per particle — survey pending]**
- **Person.** Unmarked throughout. Ambiguity is resolved, when needed, by a strong-pronoun *on-X-end* phrase (§5.3), with flexible placement.
- **Stacking.** Matrix particles stack over each other and under topics, but parseability demands strong-pronoun buffering between the layers; speakers avoid depth beyond two. **[Provisional]**
- **Questions.** The polarity-question particle *ea* applies to a scaffolded clause as to any other (§5.5). [Placeholder: example pending]
- **Negation.** Interaction with the negators of §10 undecided. **[Open]**

11.4 Interactions

- **With the visibility particles.** The know-that particle is homophonous with the know-particle but syntactically distinct: matrix *no* takes a noun phrase or a full clause and yields a complete sentence; the topic particle's clausal form *noho* instead raises a topic the listener expects elaborated. The two can co-occur (*No Báuyà, no Báuyà* — topic, then assertion).

- **With the frames.** The end-up particle supplies happenstance from above when the bare get-oneself frame under-delivers it (§4.2): *Enniip remmaseto split* "I ended up leaving."
- **With the evidential division of labor.** Under the appears particle, the choice of visibility particle distinguishes perceptible from non-perceptible evidence: *Hiie ossii, piies aų nibii hii* "Look at the outside — it looks nippy" versus *Nou ossii, piies aų nibii hii* "You know the outside — it seems nippy."
- **With mood.** The really-need particle carries the desiderative territory §13 anticipates; the appears and know-that particles carry evidential territory.

11.5 Origin

Each member fuses a GA matrix clause — finite verb included — into a particle; the membership criterion for the class is precisely that the etymon contains a finite verb, which is why the members can bear tense while etyma without one (*maybe*, *in my eyes*) yield plain adverbs instead. The path is well-attested cross-linguistically: Latin American Spanish *dizque* (from *dice que* "says that") is a matrix verb fused with its complementizer into a hearsay particle — the exact mirror of the know-that particle in the knowledge domain. The person syncretism follows from phonetic erosion at the pronominal slot: in *what I need is*, the GA pronouns */i, jɪ, ɛj, ɻi/* merge acoustically after /ɻ/ and before /iː/. The end-up particle's aspect government recalls the conjunct order of Algonquian languages such as Ojibwe, where subordinating elements select a dedicated dependent verb form.

11.6 Glossing

Composite tags: MP.ENDUP, MP.KNOW, MP.NEED, MP.APPEAR, with .PST on the past member (MP.ENDUP.PST = *enniip*).

11.7 Open questions

- *Piies* past form; membership confirmed if found. [**Open**]
- Government class per particle. [**Open**]
- Negation interaction. [**Open**]
- Stacking depth and ordering constraints. [**Open**]
- A predicted reportative member — a *they say / I heard* descendant. [**Open**]

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12. The possession construction

The language has no everyday verb *have*. Possession, acquisition, choosing, and giving are carried by the frames combining directly with a nominal — the **possession construction**. What GA spreads across *have*, *get*, *pick*, and *give*, the conlang derives from frame choice and frame aspect over a bare noun.

> *Rimmaseu beikw.* /—/ [Placeholder: IPA pending phonology pass] 1SG.LVC.NVOL.PST=ART vehicle "I have a vehicle." (lit. "got myself a vehicle")

The final lengthened vowel of *rimmaseu* is the fused etymological article. [Placeholder: gloss segmentation of the article fusion pending]

12.1 Forms and function

- **get-oneself** + **nominal, perfect frame aspect** → possession ("have"): *Rimmaseu beikw*.
- **get-oneself** + **nominal, imperfect frame aspect** → acquisition in progress ("getting"). [Placeholder: example pending]
- **go-ahead (+ *with*)** + **nominal** → deliberate selection ("picking and choosing"). [Placeholder: plain-noun example pending; the deverbal case is attested at §7.2]
- The frame choice carries the usual coloring: *Rimmaseu rhink* "got myself a drink" reads self-benefit; *Rimmaseu þlii* "got the flu" reads affliction — the same construction, with the nominal's semantics selecting the flavor.
- **Lexical alternatives** modulate intentionality: *rib* "give" for explicit volition in transfer; *ϙıĩ* "own" for neutral mere-having. [Lexicon: rib, ϙıĩ not yet entered]

12.2 The transfer extension

With a recipient in the *get*-slot, the construction causativizes into giving, volition-neutral by default:

> *Ritm o rhémstwè.* /—/ [Placeholder: IPA pending phonology pass] get.3PL ART book "(I/they) gave them the book." (lit. "got them the book")

The extension resists a topic-marked definite object; explicit-volition *rib* with the go-ahead frame is used instead. [**Open: transfer-extension object restrictions**]

12.3 The deverbal special case and the helper-verb question

A deverbal nominal in the construction is the recognitional-iterative nominal of §7, distinguished by the recognitional exponent (*þ ~ y* for merged *o*) and by **helper-verb support** on the get-oneself side (*Rimmase ię þ rishś* — §7.2).

The helper-verb question is deliberately open. *Do* is the default helper, but GA's own collocations vary by lexical item (*do* the dishes, but *take out* the trash, *pull* the trigger, *push* the issue), and importing that variety wholesale would both drift toward relexification and nest light verbs inside the already-grammaticalized frames. The working disposition, [**Open**] in all four parts:

1. A **small licensed set** of helper-verb pairings, admitted only where the lexical item earns it.
2. **Default avoidance**: most such meanings are phrased another way — Latinate verbs in particular tend to supply frame-free lexical routes (*preb* "cook" rather than a do-the-cooking construction).
3. A **tentative additional helper** under consideration (candidate source GA *bop*), unconfirmed.
4. Some deverbal nominals may simply be **incompatible** with the get-oneself frame — a gap, not a workaround.

Analytical note. A related lexical decision is recorded here because it bears on the helper's eventual citation shape: GA *do* is assigned an **irregular** sound-change path, yielding *o* rather than the regular reflex in ⟨ii⟩ — merging with the descendant of GA *go*, which already covers "become" and is expected to extend to motion and speech senses. The default helper, the become-verb, and the merged article would then share the surface form *o*; the collision load on *o* is flagged for review, and the attested concord form *ię* (from GA *doing*) must be reconciled with the merger. [New rule needed: irregular reflex of GA *do* → o (designed exception)] [Lexicon: o (do/go merger) pending — senses: do-helper, become, go]

12.4 Interactions

- **With the recognitional-iterative nominal** (§7): the deverbal special case, above.
- **With the frame's argument structure** (§4.1): the *with*-mediation facts live here; §4.1's open question is fed, not closed.
- **With the separative satellite** *ǫþw* (§4.2): unrelated mechanisms — the satellite shapes the verb's event structure; the helper supports a nominal.

12.5 Open questions

- Helper-verb ecology — the four-part disposition of §12.3. [**Open**]
- Transfer-extension object restrictions. [**Open**]
- The *bop* helper candidate. [**Open**]
- The imperfect-aspect acquisition reading — confirm with attested examples. [**Open**]

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13. Mood

Beyond the go-ahead/get-oneself contrast (which arguably is mood), the system likely includes:

- **Imperative** — formation and inventory not yet committed. [**Open**]
- **Optative / desiderative** — the desiderative territory is carried by the really-need particle (§11); whether a separate *want to*-derived optative also exists is [**Open**].
- **Evidential distinctions** — partly carried at the matrix layer (the appears and know-that particles, with the visibility particles dividing perceptible from non-perceptible evidence — §11.4); whether further evidential machinery exists is [**Open**].

These are placeholders for sections that will be developed as design proceeds.

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14. A clause, assembled

The pieces described above combine as: (optional dislocated NP topic) + weak pronoun (carrying any fusion) + frame + main verb with concord. This section assembles them. Frame and pronoun forms below are attested

(§2.4, §3.7, §5.2); **all main-verb and NP surface forms are placeholders** pending dictionary derivation, and pitch diacritics are omitted because the pitch of the frame forms has not yet been recorded. [Open: pitch marking on frame and pronoun forms]

Go-ahead, habitual:

> *e oheun drinkin* — [Placeholder: drinkin] 1SG go.ahead.LVC.VOL.HAB drink-CONCORD "I go ahead and drink (it)" — habitual, deliberate

Go-ahead, imperfect (pronoun carries the +be fusion; frame in bare gerund shape):

> *em ounoheun drinkin* — [Placeholder: drinkin] 1SG.be go.ahead.LVC.VOL.IPFV drink-CONCORD "I'm going ahead and drinking (it)" — ongoing, deliberate

Get-oneself, past, happenstance (progressive-shaped concord):

> *e rimase beussourin* — [Placeholder: concord shape on beussou unverified] 1SG get.oneself.LVC.NVOL.PST.1SG fall.asleep-CONCORD "I got myself falling asleep" = "I fell asleep" — it befell me

With a dislocated NP topic and resumptive pronoun (§5.4):

> *the coffee — e oheun drinkin* — [Placeholder: NP and main verb] coffee.TOP 1SG go.ahead.LVC.VOL.HAB drink-CONCORD "the coffee — I go ahead and drink (it)"

Negated clauses replace the bare pronoun with a not-quite fusion (§5.2.1); the shape of the main verb under negation is [**Open**] pending the §10 reconciliation.

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15. Cross-references

- terminology-registry.md — canonical terminology, gloss tags, and naming history.
- verb-paradigm-verdict.md — full cell-by-cell predictions, the three live questions on self-benefit selectivity / threshold-for-statives / habitual-plus-infinitive reading, and the analytical history behind this consolidation.
- translation-frequency-task.md — the translation-task instrument designed to gather the usage-weighted data §9 calls for.
- language_reference.md §3.4 — the high-level summary that points at this document.
- phonology.md — phonological details of the frame and verb-stem forms.
- Appendix A (below) — the verb-lexicon-building methodology.

Appendix A: Verb-Lexicon-Building Methodology

A working procedure for fleshing out the conlang's verb lexicon in a way that showcases the grammar's divergence from GA, rather than producing one-to-one translations of GA verbs. Methodology, not descriptive grammar — kept as an appendix so the recipe sits adjacent to the verbal-system reference it draws on. Descriptive facts the recipe relies on live in §3, §6, §7, and §8; the appendix points there rather than restating them.

A.1 Goal

Build a verb stock that:

- Foregrounds the **verbal system as a whole** — the frames, the four readings, the stative-domain strategies, and the recognitional-iterative nominal — as the language's distinctive expressive tools.
- Does **not** map cleanly onto GA verbs. The conlang's verb territory should be carved differently — sometimes finer, sometimes coarser, sometimes shifted laterally.
- Lets the conlang's grammar do real expressive work that GA does clunkily or not at all.
- Provides a small set of **showcase verbs** for pedagogical illustration, alongside a much larger set of **workhorse verbs** for everyday use.
- Loads the lexicon with verbs that light up the get-oneself paradigm across multiple readings, not just verbs that produce one shining cell and four muted ones.

A.2 The two selection axes

Each candidate verb sits on two independent dimensions; both inform whether to recruit it and how to flesh it out.

A.2.1 Axis A — verb-volition category

Where the verb sits with respect to the go-ahead/get-oneself contrast at the *outer* level. The three categories — **polysemy-resolving**, **aspectual-shift**, **attitudinal** — are described in §8.1. Recipe-relevant additions:

- Polysemy-resolving is **closed and found, not constructed** — don't manufacture polysemy GA didn't supply. Expected size: 15–40 verbs. Role: showcase verbs for pedagogical materials.
- Aspectual-shift: secondary showcase — demonstrates the system doing meaningful work even where GA supplies no ready-made polysemy.
- Attitudinal: the everyday expressive tool — claiming credit, deflecting responsibility, signaling agency or its absence. Most of the verb stock.

A.2.2 Axis B — get-oneself paradigm coverage

How richly the verb populates the four readings. This is the *inner* level of selection and is independent of Axis A. Coverage is described as **rich**, **medium**, or **thin** based on how many of the four readings yield productive, non-coerced uses. What each reading wants from a verb:

A.2.2.1 Happenstance Hosted by HABITUAL and PAST with progressive-shaped concord. Wants verbs where the event can plausibly happen to the subject without their agency. Broadest of the four — almost any verb hosts happenstance if the event can be construed as befalling the subject. Achievements (*fall, find, notice,* *realize, catch*) host it richly because the moment of the event is naturally non-agentive. Activities (*think, wander, hum, doodle*) host it richly when they can drift into existence without intention. Verbs that *only* make sense as deliberate (*sign a contract, vote, file taxes*) host it poorly.

A.2.2.2 Effortful self-benefit Hosted by HABITUAL (marked) and PAST with infinitive-shaped concord. The most selective reading. Wants (a) action-host semantics so the subject can do the thing, (b) plausible benefit to the subject, and (c) effort or self-direction in the doing. *get up, get going, get clean, get organized, get fed, get to bed, get out of the rain* host it extremely well. Verbs that benefit others (*give, help, comfort*) host it poorly. Verbs that are bad for the subject (*catch a cold, get lost, fall*) host it only under coerced negative-evaluation readings — a live question (§9.3, verb-paradigm-verdict.md §1.5).

A.2.2.3 Threshold Hosted by PROGRESSIVE + infinitive-shaped concord. Wants verbs with a natural onset — events with a "becoming-such-that" build-up phase. Threshold-event verbs (*fall asleep, doze off, walk out, leave, give up, break down, melt down, cave*) host it paradigmatically. Graded approaches to a state (*warm up, calm down, tire out, perk up, sober up*) also work. Punctual achievements without build-up (*find, notice, realize*) host it poorly.

A.2.2.4 Backdrop Hosted by PERFECT + progressive-shaped concord. Wants verbs producing a durative event whose ongoing-ness is discourse-relevant. Activity verbs work well (*read, walk, cook, watch, listen, talk, write, drive*). Cognitive activities (*think, wonder, worry, dream, daydream*) are paradigmatic. Achievements host it poorly; telic accomplishments work only mid-event.

A.2.3 The two axes in combination

Each verb gets a two-coordinate label: an Axis A category and an Axis B coverage profile (rich / medium / thin, optionally with reading detail like *rich on happenstance and backdrop, thin on self-benefit and threshold*). The combined profile drives recruitment priority (§A.8). The two axes are orthogonal: Axis A is a typology of what the outer frame contrast does for a verb; Axis B is a typology of inner-paradigm richness. Any Axis A category can carry any Axis B profile.

A.3 The stative domain

Statives (*be happy, like, want, need, hurt*) sit outside the frames proper (§3.6, §8.2). The three strategies of §6 are, from the recipe's standpoint, three different ways of recruiting a GA stative meaning into the lexicon.

A.3.1 Activity-coercion

Recruit an activity verb whose typical correlate of the GA stative meaning carries the load: GA *be happy* → conlang *smile, laugh, grin*; GA *be sad* → *frown, sigh*. When a GA stative meaning is on the recruitment list, look for the GA activity verbs that correlate with it and prioritize *those*. The stative itself may need no conlang entry at all.

A.3.2 Stimulus-promotion

Recruit a verb that frames the stimulus as the grammatical subject acting on the experiencer (§6.2). GA experiencer-object verbs (*charm, captivate, soothe, bore, annoy, fascinate*) are the natural targets: their conlang counterparts host the go-ahead frame productively because the stimulus can be construed as an actor.

A.3.3 Causative

Recruit the *get X to V* shape with a third-party causer (§6.3). The causative needs an action-host main verb, so it composes with activity-coercion: the speaker still picks an externalizable activity correlate of the internal state. The two strategies are deployed together for many GA stative meanings.

A.3.4 What this means for stative-domain recruitment

For each GA stative meaning the conlang needs to express:

1. Identify the activity verbs that correlate with it (for activity-coercion).
2. Identify the stimulus-frame verbs that can host it (for stimulus-promotion).
3. Decide whether the bare stative — the *rhiiynii*-class lexical stative, accessed through happenstance/threshold/backdrop — also needs an entry, or whether the strategies cover the territory.

For most GA statives the answer to (3) will be that the strategies cover it. A small number warrant bare entries for the irreducibly internal cases (*rhiiynii* "need/want" being the paradigm example).

A.4 Semantic territories to prioritize

High Axis B coverage clusters in specific semantic regions of GA. These are the highest-yield recruitment targets for a richly colored verbal system.

A.4.1 Tier 1 — verbs that should light up across all four readings

The gold of the lexicon; recruit aggressively.

- **Self-care and bodily-state activities.** *fall asleep, wake up, doze, rest, settle in, settle down, calm down, perk up, sober up, get up, get going, ease into, lean back, sink down, sit up, get dressed, shower, eat, drink, settle.* Hits self-benefit (self-directed effortful action), happenstance (can happen without intention), threshold (natural onsets), backdrop (durative and experientially salient).
- **Cognitive activities.** *think, wonder, worry, dream, daydream, brood, ruminate, reflect, ponder, mull.* Hits backdrop paradigmatically (the I-was-thinking-about-it-when-X reading), happenstance richly (thoughts arrive uninvited), threshold for the ones with onset, self-benefit by coercion ("I got myself to think about it").
- **Threshold-transition verbs.** *walk out, drift off, slip away, give up, break down, cave, melt down, slip into, ease into, sink down, lean back.* Hits threshold paradigmatically, happenstance richly, backdrop for the durative ones, self-benefit for deliberate-self-positioning uses.

A.4.2 Tier 2 — verbs that light up three of the four richly

Strong targets; expect one reading to be thin.

- **Daily-life social-texture activities.** *chit-chat, wander, hang out, putter, tinker, fuss, dawdle, browse, mosey, lounge.* Strong on happenstance and backdrop. Self-benefit coerced but available. Threshold weak — no natural onsets.
- **State-onset cognitive/perceptual verbs.** *realize, notice, recognize, remember, learn, understand, see, hear, feel.* Strong on happenstance (the moment of noticing is non-agentive), threshold (becoming-aware), and backdrop (the durative state of remembering). Self-benefit weak unless the verb has a deliberate effortful use. These double as Axis A aspectual-shift verbs, layering inner and outer richness.

A.4.3 Tier 3 — strong happenstance/backdrop pairings, less elsewhere

Useful for filling out the lexicon, but not anchors of the paradigm.

- **Durative perceptual/experiential activities.** *watch, listen, read, watch over, look out, keep an eye on, follow along, observe.* Strong on happenstance and backdrop; threshold and self-benefit weak.
- **Mid-process accomplishments.** *cook, write, work on, sort through, get through, build, repair, clean up.* Backdrop strong mid-event; happenstance possible; self-benefit and threshold mostly weak or coerced.

A.4.4 What to deprioritize

Thin-paradigm verbs are still worth recruiting eventually, but not first if richness is the goal.

- **Pure-deliberate action verbs** (*sign, vote, build, pay, file, ratify, declare*). Belong in the go-ahead frame; mostly coerced or marked on the get-oneself side.
- **Other-directed verbs** (*give, help, teach, comfort, serve, deliver*). Self-benefit and threshold weak; happenstance and backdrop coerced.
- **Pure achievements without onset** (*win, lose, hit, arrive, die* — though *die* has cultural weight that may justify exception). Host only happenstance cleanly.
- **Punctual transitive achievements** (*catch, find, notice* — the polysemy-resolving class). Dramatic Axis A contrasts, but the get-oneself cells themselves are thin.

A.4.5 A design-strategy note

The Tier 1 convergence zone clusters heavily in the **self-state / cognitive / threshold-transition** territory. This is not accidental: it is exactly where a system grammaticalizing non-straightforward agency *should* be richest, because that is where straightforward agency is most often qualified.

A consequence: a lexicon loaded preferentially with these verbs gives the conlang a distinctive *texture* — speech will lean toward introspective, processual, transition-aware framings. Whether that fits the conlang's cultural and aesthetic profile is a deliberate design question; the current default assumption is yes, but the assumption is flagged rather than naturalized.

A.5 How GA history drives the lexicon

The selection / reanalysis / loss-with-replacement processes and the three semantic shift patterns are described in §8.4. The recipe consequence: when working a candidate verb, list its GA construction inventory, predict which uses survive selection, and watch for the merger phenomena §8.4 describes — they are recruitment opportunities, not noise.

A.6 The deverbal nominal layer

The recognitional-iterative construction and its per-verb diagnostic are described in §7 and §8.3. Recipe consequence: test *the V-ing* and *the V-ings* for every candidate. Verbs with both rich deverbal nominalization and rich frame contrasts and reading coverage are the highest-value targets — flesh these out first. This layer is orthogonal to both axes and adds a third dimension to the verb's expressive profile.

A.7 The diagnostic questions

For any candidate verb, work through these five questions in order. Verbs that yield satisfying answers across all five are the ones to build out first; thin answers signal candidates to defer.

1. **Which GA constructions did it participate in, and which survived?** List the GA uses; mark which are high-frequency, colloquial, formal. Predict which survive selection (§8.4).
2. **Where does it sit on Axis A?** Polysemy-resolving, aspectual-shift, or attitudinal (§8.1)?
3. **Where does it sit on Axis B?** Test the four readings. Which cells are productive, coerced, blocked? Record a coverage profile (rich / medium / thin), optionally with reading detail.
4. **Does it have a salient deverbal nominal, and what is the recognitional-iterative reading?** Test *the V-ing* and *the V-ings*. Is the shared-knowledge reading natural? The iterative reading? Is the verb register-flexible or register-bound?
5. **Are there cognates or competitors in GA that the conlang's phonology has merged or distinguished?** Check for near-homophones the sound changes will collapse, semantic neighbors the conlang may force into specialization, and GA polysemy the conlang may split across multiple verbs.

Questions 2 and 3 give the two-axis profile; 1, 4, and 5 give the diachronic and morphological context.

A.8 Two-axis building order

Recruitment priority combines the Axis A and Axis B profiles. A verb that is rich on Axis B and poly-resolving or aspectual-shift on Axis A is the highest-priority target — it lights up both the outer contrast and the inner reading grid.

A.8.1 Priority 1 — flagship verbs

High on both axes (poly-resolving or aspectual-shift; rich coverage). The showcase: the frame contrast does dramatic work *and* the paradigm fills out across all four readings. Examples: *fall asleep* (poly-resolving via GA *pass out*, Tier 1 self-care/threshold), *remember* (aspectual-shift, Tier 1 cognitive), *walk out* (poly-resolving or attitudinal, Tier 1 threshold-transition). First batch.

A.8.2 Priority 2 — workhorse verbs

High on Axis B, plain on Axis A (attitudinal; rich or medium-rich coverage). The everyday vocabulary that gives the get-oneself paradigm its expressive weight in normal speech: most cognitive activities, self-care verbs, daily-life social-texture activities. *think, wonder, chit-chat, wander, putter, doze*.

A.8.3 Priority 3 — secondary showcase

High on Axis A, plain on Axis B (poly-resolving or aspectual-shift; medium or thin coverage). Dramatic outer contrasts, thin inner paradigms. Useful pedagogically because the contrast is sharp and easy to teach. *catch, find, notice*.

A.8.4 Priority 4 — long-tail vocabulary

Plain on both axes. The bulk of the lexicon; recruit as needed for breadth.

A.8.5 Priority 5 — stative-domain recruitment

Run alongside Priorities 1–4: for each GA stative meaning the conlang needs, identify activity-coercion, stimulus-promotion, and causative recruitments per §A.3.4. Bare stative entries (*rhiiynii*-class) only for the irreducibly internal cases.

A.9 Avoiding GA-mapped lexicon

Specific tactics for keeping the conlang's verb territory genuinely divergent:

- **Don't ask "what's the conlang word for X."** Ask "what's the conlang's whole vocabulary for the territory X covers in GA," and expect the answer to involve multiple verbs splitting GA's range differently, plus possibly a stative-domain strategy.
- **Look for GA polysemy to split.** *Run* covers physical running, machines operating, organizations being directed, water flowing, candidates campaigning. The conlang's *run*-cognate may take only one, with the others recruited to different verbs entirely.
- **Look for GA distinctions to merge.** Where GA distinguishes two verbs the phonology collapses, the merged form may be enriched by frame disambiguation, or one sense may take over.
- **Identify GA volitional twins.** Pairs like *fall/drop*, *forget/put-out-of-mind*, *sleep/go-to-bed*, *learn/find-out* — does the conlang preserve both, merge them, or recruit them to different paradigm sides of a single verb?
- **Watch for sound-change-driven mergers.** When working derivations, flag cases where two semantically related GA stems will produce identical conlang forms. These are dictionary entries with multiple GA etyma — record both, with notes on which senses came from which source.
- **Check the deverbal nominal slot.** A verb without a recognitional-iterative paradigm is missing one dimension of its expressive range. Either find a GA construction that supplies one, or note that the verb lives in the frame dimensions only.

- **Look for GA stative meanings the strategies can recruit.** Before adding a stative entry, ask which activity-coercion, stimulus-promotion, or causative recruitments cover the territory. Often the entry isn't needed.
- **Default to the Tier 1 convergence zone** (self-care, cognitive activity, threshold-transition) when uncertain where to recruit next — these pay back recruitment effort with the highest expressive dividend.

A.10 Polarity — held aside

The get-oneself paradigm and reading inventory have been worked out for positive polarity. Negative polarity is held in §10 pending reconciliation. For diagnostic question 3 (Axis B coverage), apply only to the positive-polarity grid for now, recording negative-polarity behavior as observations rather than systematizing it. When the §10 reconciliation is done, §A.2.2 will be updated. This is a known incompleteness, not a hidden assumption.

A.11 What to record per verb

Beyond the dictionary's standard schema, verb entries should include:

- **Two-axis profile.** Axis A category and Axis B coverage (rich/medium/thin, with reading detail if useful).
- **GA construction inventory** — which GA uses survived, died, were reanalyzed.
- **Get-oneself paradigm coverage** — for each of the six productive cells, is it productive, coerced, or blocked? Which reading does the productive cell host? Example sentences for productive cells.
- **Go-ahead paradigm coverage** — for the three cells, productive, marked, or blocked?
- **Recognitional-iterative paradigm** — whether *the V-ing* and *the V-ings* are licensed, and the readings.
- **Stative-domain recruitment** (if applicable) — which activity-coercion / stimulus-promotion / causative recruitments share territory with this verb.
- **Mergers and competitors** — other GA verbs whose territory this verb has absorbed or shares.
- **Register notes** — intimate/formal, frequent/rare, marked uses.

This is more apparatus than current dictionary entries carry, and most of it can be deferred to a Notes section. But the two-axis profile and the two paradigm-coverage records should be in the entry from the start: they justify the verb's place in the lexicon and define how it interacts with the rest of the grammar.

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16. Versioning notes

v2.2, June 2026 — §7 migration executed (Session L)

§7.1 and §7.4 reduced to pointers: REC/ITER morphological description and its open questions migrated to language_reference.md §3.2.1 (langref v3.2), completing the relocation the v2.1 note anticipated. §7 now holds the special-case statement, the worked example, and the Origin material (REC ≠ DEF; the *þ/o* etymological doublet), per the one-home rule.

v2.1, June 2026 — translation-exercise integration (Session V)

New sections. §11 The matrix particles (class, four members, privative tense, aspect government, person syncretism, stacking, evidential division of labor; the language's split TAM stated: aspect on the weak pronouns, tense on the matrix particles). §12 The possession construction (have/get/choose from frame + nominal; the transfer extension; the deverbal special case; the helper-verb question left open by user decision — four-part disposition recorded with the relexification/nesting rationale; the designed *do* → *o* irregular merger flagged for phonology and lexicon). Former §11–§14 renumbered §13–§16; live cross-references updated in-document and in language_reference.md; historical versioning notes left as written.

§4.2. Passive-shaped concord added with the *spli·opw* paradigm and the satellite-conflation caveat; compositional-readings statement (frame aspect × concord shape × stem event structure, plus matrix scaffolding); new §4.2.1 irregular concord (*meirtt*); new §4.2.2 concord under suffixation (stub).

Paradigm corrections (user, 2026-06-10/11). 1SG weak pronoun *e* (bare) and *em* (+be), replacing *eu*/*eum* — creating a 1SG/3SG.INANIM syncretism in the bare series parallel to the existing prospective and ability syncretisms; inanimate habitual go-ahead *osoheun*, replacing *ośeun*; progressive *ounoheun* confirmed canonical (*ounahen*, *ounohen* are errors). Animate habitual flagged [**Open**]: table *oheun* vs. a 2026-06-10 note reading *ouhen*; the *osoheun* parallel favors *oheun*. Examples swept in §4.3, §5.4, §5.5, §14.

§5. §5.3: antitopic tagging added as a fourth strong-pronoun use. §5.4: right-dislocation asymmetry added (visibility contrast is left-periphery-only) [**Provisional**]. §5.5: *ea* conditional use added.

§6. New §6.4 idiom-level frame blocking (*oo riuś*); former §6.4 renumbered §6.5.

§7. Surface forms closed (REC *þ* ~ *y*, ITER *-ś*; attested *þ rishś*), removing the v2 [Open] flag. Rewritten as the deverbal special case of the possession construction (demotion decision, 2026-06-11), with the prior freestanding analysis and reasoning quarantined; the *þ/o* etymological-doublet origin added to §7.3. §7.4 questions marked as migrating to the language reference's nominal sections.

Abstract restored and revised in the front matter: the v2 Abstract survived only as the copy in language_reference.md §3.4's stub (the source document had lost it — drift incident); the restored text merges the v2 claims with the new architecture, and the §3.4 stub was regenerated from it. Source decisions: 2026-06-10 translation exercise; phase4-triage-2026-06.md; registry Batch II (accepted 2026-06-11, with *need particle* renamed *really-need particle* by user decision).

v2, June 2026 — conformance pass: terminology registry adopted; structure and voice revised

Terminology. All prose normalized to terminology-registry.md (June 2026 batch): *volitional go-ahead* / *non-volitional get-oneself* replace *volitive* / *non-volitive*; *frame* promoted to prose-primary over *light verb complex* (LVC retained for morphology-internal prose and gloss tags); *frame aspect* replaces *LVC.TAM*; the four readings renamed *happenstance* (HAP), *effortful self-benefit* (SELF.BEN), *threshold* (THRESH), *backdrop* (BACK), retiring the prose abbreviations PH/AB/INC/PS; *iterative marker* (ITER) replaces the nominal *habitual marker* (HAB), resolving the collision with the habitual frame aspect cell; §7 retitled *recognitional-iterative nominal construction*; concord shapes reworded *infinitive-/progressive-shaped* (synchronic) from *-derived* (diachronic);

gnomic/habitual single-named *habitual*. §10 legacy *INVOL* tags normalized to *NVOL* (terminology only; the analytical reconciliation remains open).

Structure. §1 absorbs the asymmetry argument previously restated in §12; §12 repurposed as "A clause, assembled" (worked clause assembly from attested frame and pronoun forms, placeholders flagged). §8 gains §8.4 (GA history: selection/reanalysis/loss and shift patterns), now the canonical home for material previously duplicated across §8, A.5, and language_reference.md §5.2–5.3; A.5, A.6, and A.2.1 reduced to pointers plus procedural additions. §9.5 reduced to a status pointer at the registry. §10 restructured synchronic-first ("Polarity and negation"): the description leads, the reconciliation problem moves to an analytical note. Section numbering otherwise preserved to protect cross-references from out-of-tree documents.

Voice and examples. Project-history narration moved into analytical-note blocks or the registry (§1 reading note, §4.2 term hedge, §5.2.2 syncretism motivation, §7.3 origin, §10.2). Source-frame subsections retitled "Origin." GA-calque examples flagged [Placeholder] throughout (§4.3, §5.4, §6, §7.2, §12). New explicit [Open] flags: concord-affix surface inventory (§4.2), REC/ITER surface forms (§7.1), pitch marking on frame/pronoun forms (§12).

v1.3, May 2026 — pronominal system added as §5; LVC paradigm tables added

New §5: The Pronominal System. Pronouns treated as aspect carriers rather than standalone word forms. §5.1 describes the animacy (GO-AHEAD) vs. person/number (GET-ONESELF) agreement asymmetry. §5.2 documents the weak (clitic) pronoun paradigm across bare, imperfect, prospective/conditional (would), ability (could), and n't.quite negative cells, with syncretism noted for 2PL and 3PL modal/negative forms. §5.3 documents the strong (tonic) pronoun paradigm from GA *on* [*POSS*] *end*, with three functional readings (emphatic, possessive, topic/frame). §5.4 establishes left dislocation with resumptive pronouns as the mechanism for full-NP subjects. §5.5 describes interrogative via intonation + *ea* (from GA *at all*) with no do-inversion [Provisional]. §5.6 (pro-drop) and §5.7 (WERE irrealis particle) are held [Open]. The modal fusions (would, could) are restricted to pronouns — no nominal-subject modal construction without a resumptive pronoun. **[Settled]**

New §2.4 and §3.7: LVC paradigm tables. GO-AHEAD paradigm given for animacy distinction at gnomic/habitual aspect (*oheun* animate, *ośeun* inanimate 3SG), invariant imperfect (*ounoheun*), and past (*beųheun*). GET-ONESELF paradigm given for full person/number grid across three aspects (gnomic/habitual, imperfect/progressive, past).

Renumbering. Former §5–§13 shifted to §6–§14 to accommodate new §5. All internal cross-references updated.

Paradigm CSVs. Full paradigm data held in paradigms/pronoun-weak.csv, paradigms/pronoun-strong.csv, paradigms/lvc-paradigm.csv.

Open questions added. §5.6 (pro-drop conditions), §5.7 (WERE irrealis form and distribution).

v1.2, May 2026 — verb-lexicon-building methodology folded in as Appendix A

Appendix A added. The verb-recipe.md sibling working note (specifically its v2 draft, dated May 2026) is folded in as Appendix A: Verb-Lexicon-Building Methodology. The procedure was restructured into eleven sub-sections (A.1–A.11) covering goal, two-axis selection (Axis A verb-volition category × Axis B non-volitive paradigm coverage), stative-domain recruitment via the three strategies, semantic-territory tier list, GA-history-driven lexicon shaping, recognitional-habitual diagnostic, five diagnostic questions, two-axis building order (Priorities 1–5), tactics for avoiding GA-mapped lexicon, polarity-deferred note, and per-verb recording schema. The original draft is archived at drafts/integrated/2026-05-05-verb-recipe-v2.md.

Terminology normalized during integration. The draft used the older *modulated* term throughout (the May 2026 verbal-system-description session terminology). Replaced with *non-volitive* to match the §1–9 main body and v1's terminology decision. The legacy four-cell INVOL terminology in §10 is unchanged here; that section's terminology drift is a separate reconciliation task.

Cross-doc propagation. §7 lead and §8 lead updated to point at Appendix A rather than the retired sibling. §13 cross-references list updated. Parallel updates: language_reference.md v2.5 (§5.1, §8 doc set list, §3.7.5, §3.7.7); CLAUDE.md "Document hierarchy" out-of-tree list.

v1.1, May 2026 — pedagogical-game references stripped

Three open-question entries previously motivated their open status by reference to the in-development game's mini-game build sequence:

- §7.4 "Scope of REC and HAB relative to other nominal morphology" dropped its "to be forced by the market and lost-and-found mini-games" tag.
- §11 "Imperative" dropped its "used in the kitchen and delivery mini-games" tag; rewritten to flag formation and inventory as open.
- §11 closing line rewritten from "developed when the relevant mini-games force commitment" to "developed as design proceeds."

The questions themselves are unchanged. Parallel cleanup applied across language_reference.md (v2.3), orthography.md (v2.2), dictionary.md, and CLAUDE.md.

v1, May 2026 — initial consolidation

This document supersedes verb-terminology.md (now retired) and consolidates the verbal-system analysis from the May 2026 verbal-system-description session. It draws on the verb-terminology session (volitive, LVC, concord affixes, recognitional-habitual), the verbal-system-description session (the volitive-vs-non-volitive paradigm structure, four sub-modalities, stative-domain strategies, principled gaps), and the verb-recipe session (verb-volition typology, deverbal nominal layer).

Relationship to predecessors. - verb-terminology.md (May 2026, retired) — content superseded by this document. The terminology committed there (volitive, LVC, concord affixes, REC/HAB) is preserved here; the *involitive* term is replaced by *non-volitive*. - verb-recipe.md (May 2026, sibling working note) — methodology for verb lexicon-building. Descriptive-grammar claims it depended on are folded into §8 of this document; the recipe procedure itself remains a sibling reference. - verb-paradigm-verdict.md (May 2026, sibling) — cell-by-cell analytical predictions and history. Stays as a separate document; this consolidation references it for analytical detail.

Terminology shift: involitive → modulated → non-volitive. - *Involitive* was used in early verb-terminology work; rejected as privatively naming the side of the paradigm where the structured inventory of sub-modalities lives. - *Modulated* was the working term in the May 2026 verbal-system-description session, chosen positively to capture that the side modulates rather than negates volition. - *Non-volitive* is the term used in this document, chosen for readability. It accepts the privative form on the understanding that the principled-asymmetry argument (§8) is preserved in the prose framing rather than in the term itself.

Polarity carry-forward. The polarity dimension and nested-negation phenomenon (§10) are preserved as flagged-for-reconciliation. They predate the §2–3 paradigm structure and need re-fitting to it.

Dictionary

A working lexicon for the conlang. Entries are sorted in conlang collation order (see §2). Each entry uses a template-style schema: fields may be omitted when not yet committed. Fields marked [Open] depend on phonological or grammatical questions still under analysis in phonology.md or language_reference.md.

This file is a living specification. As sound rules settle and grammar commits, entries should be revisited and updated.

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1. Schema

Each entry is a level-3 heading (### headword). Below the heading:

- #### **Etymology** — A section opener. The proto-form in italics with asterisk, a dash, then a gloss. Semantic drift, register notes, and source-construction context are folded in as prose. Example: *pass out* — colloquial "fall asleep" primary; "lose consciousness" secondary (salience inverted from GA).
- **Form line:** Labeled fields on one line: **Part of speech:** abbreviation **IPA:** /.../ **Foot:** (...). Example: **Part of speech:** v. **IPA:** /ˌbɛːˈsːoː/ **Foot:** (ˌH)(ˈH).

Then, if committed, a **Phonological development** line: a compact semicolon-separated list of applied rules with brief labels. This is a derivation record, not a discussion.

Then **Cross-refs** if any: a single parenthetical or line linking related entries.

Then prose sections as needed:

- #### Definition — numbered glosses.
- Examples appear inline within the definition they illustrate, separated from the definition text by an em dash. Conlang form in italics, followed by the English translation in double quotes. No separate #### Examples heading.
- #### Morphology — inflected/derived forms when committed.
- #### Notes — observations genuinely specific to this form: irregular surface properties, optional realizations, notable phonotactic patterns. Not for propagation tickets, pending rule discussions, or paradigm-candidate flags — those go in the session changelog or target document.

Any section may be omitted. When a committed field depends on an unresolved question elsewhere, mark [Open: see phonology §X].

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2. Collation Order

The conlang alphabet, in sort order:

> a, ą, b, ð, e, ę, æ, h, i, ii, k, l, m, ḿ, n, ń, o, ǫ, œ, p, r, rh, ŕ, s, ś, š, t, þ, w, w̃, y, ỹ

Rules:

1. Within a base letter's region, undiacriticked sequences sort first by Latin order on subsequent characters, then diacriticked forms follow.
   - Example a-region: a < aa < au < aų < ą
   - Example e-region: e < ee < eu < eų < ę
   - Example i-region: i < ia < iu < ių < iyi < ĩ
   - Example o-region: o < oo < ou < oų < ǫ
2. ii and rh are distinct phonemes, not digraph extensions of i and r, and have their own slots in the alphabet:
   - i-region (all i-initial sequences and ĩ) < ii-region (ii, iia, etc.)
   - r < rh < ŕ — the devoiced tap ŕ sorts last because devoiced r and devoiced rh collapse to a single phoneme, placed at the end of the rhotic series.
3. æ and œ are independent letters slotted into the bare-letter sequence (after the a-region and after the o-region respectively), not treated as diacritic forms.
4. Consonant diacritic forms (ḿ, ń, ŕ, ś, š, w̃, ỹ) follow their bare letter immediately, since consonants do not form length digraphs.
5. ð takes the slot where d would be (after b); þ takes its own slot (after t).

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3. Orthographic Notes

A few conventions clarified during early entry-writing, supplementing orthography.md:

- The diphthong /ei/ (phonemically /ey/, with y /j/ as the glide) is written ei. This is distinct from the length digraph eu /ɛː/ — e followed by i is the diphthong, e followed by u is length.
- **Geminate ss** represents /sː/ (voiceless long). This works in concert with the rule that s is /z/ intervocalically and finally but /s/ in onset (where it derives from GA /st/, GA /s/ having debuccalized to /h/). The doubled ss is therefore the standard spelling for a voiceless geminate; the formal/pedagogical variant śś is also licensed. Note: this convention is dictionary-internal pending propagation to orthography.md.
- **Dotless ı** appears when one element of the ii digraph takes a diacritic: the marked element retains its dot, and the unmarked partner is written as ı to reduce visual clutter. Example: in *béntsıỳ*, the stress grave lands on the second i of the iiy digraph (written ì), and the first i becomes ı. Now propagated to orthography.md §3.7.

- **Circumflex in headwords**: when pitch and stress coincide on the same vowel, the dictionary headword uses the circumflex (formal-register form) rather than the bare acute. Example: *nobêt* (pitch and stress both on /ɛ/). Earlier entries with coinciding pitch and stress (*ŕeut*, *hoʔnʔnts*, etc.) predate this convention and have not been retrofitted. Now propagated to orthography.md §3.7.

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4. Entries

barnkw

Etymology

barnacle — extended semantically from the marine crustacean's adhesive behavior to any form of persistent clinging or attachment, physical or emotional.

Part of speech: v.; also n. **IPA:** /ˈbɑɾnkw̩/ **Foot:** (ˈH) with syllabic /w̩/ appendix.

Phonological development: /b/ onset unchanged; /ɑːɹ/ with pre-consonantal /ɹ/ → /ɑɾ/ (tap; no vowel lengthening — the /eː/ lengthening pathway applies to coda /ɹ/, not pre-consonantal) [Open: pre-consonantal /ɹ/→/ɾ/ rule not stated explicitly in §4.4]; /n/ unchanged (onset of unstressed syllable, not subject to E1); /ɪ/ → ∅ (E3: unstressed vowel elision); cluster-internal /k/ stays [Open: cluster-internal /k/ shielded from onset debuccalization? §4.4.1 lists onset /k/→/h/ without cluster conditioning]; /əl/: /ə/ → ∅ (E3), /l/ → /w̩/ (syllabic glide in post-stress appendix position).

Definition

Verb senses:

1. to hug tightly; to snuggle into.
2. to be stuck on; to be physically attached or adhered.
3. to cling; to be emotionally clingy or possessive.
4. to insist; to be unable to let go or move on.

Noun senses:

1. someone who barnacles; a clingy person.
2. a pimple; a zit.
3. nipple.

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bárkennò

Etymology

parking lot — the full compound, lexicalized as a single noun.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** [Open] **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: /p/ → /b/ onset [Open: before /ɑ/, the §4.4.1 refinement nominally blocks /p/→/b/; onset /p/→/b/ before /ɑ/ would extend the rule — new environment]; /ɑːɹk/ with pre-consonantal /ɹ/: /ɹ/→/ɾ/, /ɑ/ stays short (pre-consonantal, not coda) → /ɑɾ/ → ar; cluster-internal /k/ stays [Open: see *barnkw*]; /ɪ/ → ∅ or /ɛ/ [Open: unstressed /ɪ/ treatment]; /ŋl/ → /nː/ [Open: the §4.4.1 /nd/→/nː/ rule is regressive assimilation; /ŋl/→/nː/ would require a separate rule or a generalization — /ŋ/→/n/ by place assimilation to following lateral, then /nl/→/nː/ geminate]; *lot* /lɑt/: /l/ onset → [Open: onset /l/ treatment]; /ɑ/ → /o/ [Open: /ɑ/→/o/ not in §4.4.2]; /t/ → /ʔ/ (E2a) → appears to drop in the headword.

Definition

1. parking lot; car park.

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bawiiquoh?

Etymology

what-we-call-home — a descriptive circumlocution as etymon, suggesting this is a grammaticalized compound rather than a phonological borrowing of a GA simple word. The ? in the headword may represent a phonemicized question or evidential particle built into the compound form.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** [Open — compound form] **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: [Open — morphological compound; phonology of component parts pending analysis in a dedicated session].

Definition

1. home; one's domestic residence; what we call home.

Notes

The etymon "what-we-call-home" and the ? character in the headword both suggest this is not a simple phonological derivation but a lexicalized periphrastic compound, likely involving morphological elements not yet analyzed. Cross-reference *beušiioskô*, *bewii·iit*, *bewiipessô* (parallel descriptive-circumlocution compounds).

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bayarę

Etymology

violin — borrowed via phonological adaptation.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /bɑˈjɑɾɛ̃/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈL) [Open: final syllable may be heavy if /ɛ̃/ is long].

Phonological development: /v/ → /b/ onset [Open: /v/→/b/ environment; see *béntsıỳ*, *boeś*]; /aɪ/ → /ɑ/ + glide /j/ retained as a separate segment [Open: expected reflexes of /aɪ/ are /eː/ or short /i/ per §4.4.2; /ɑ/+/j/ outcome is unattested — new conditioning environment or new rule]; /ə/ → ∅ (absorbed, E4); /l/ → /ɾ/ [Open: /l/→/ɾ/ not in §4.4.1; onset /l/ has no stated merger to tap; flag for phonology session]; /ɪn/: /n/ elides intervocalically (E1), nasalization transfers to /ɪ/ (S1) → /ɛ̃/ (lowering of /ɪ/ in this position [Open: /ɪ/→/ɛ/ under nasalization? not stated in §4.4.2]) → ę.

Definition

1. violin.

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bąêų

Etymology

banana — the fruit; no semantic shift.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /bɑ̃ˈɛ̃ː/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈH).

Phonological development: /bəˈnænə/ — both intervocalic /n/ elide (E1), each transferring nasalization to adjacent vowels (S1); initial /ə/ → /ɑ/ (E5 strengthening) + nasalized by left-flanking residue of first /n/ → /ɑ̃/ → ą; /æ/ (V_2) + nasalization from both flanking /n/ elisions → /ɛ̃/ via /æ/-before-nasal pathway (§4.4.2) with duration preserved; final /ə/ (V_3) absorbed into /ɛ̃/ as length suffix → /ɛ̃ː/ → êų (circumflex on ê: pitch + stress coincide; ogonek on ų: nasal long vowel).

Definition

1. banana.

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béntsıỳ

Etymology

eventually — from colloquial GA /vɛnʧ.li/; the GA reluctant-deferral connotation is not inherited.

Part of speech: adv. **IPA:** /bɛntsˈiː/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈH).

Phonological development: /v/ → /b/ in onset [Open: §4.4.1 gives general /v/ → /r/ via the tap merger; onset /v/ → /b/ is a new environment not yet in §4.4]; /ʧ/ spreads palatalization to adjacent /ɫ/ → /j/; /ʧ/ then depalatalizes to /ts/ (§4.4.1); /ji/ → /iː/ smoothing [Open: §4.4.1 conditions /ɫ/ → /j/ on both flanks being high front vowels; left flank here is palatal consonant /ʧ/ — extended environment or separate rule]; /n/ not intervocalic in /nt/ cluster, so E1 does not fire and /ɛ/ is not nasalized.

Cross-refs: *nobêt* (deictic counterpart).

Definition

1. (*adv.*) later; at a subsequent time.

Notes

Anaphoric — anchors to the contextually available reference time, not necessarily speech time. Compatible with both prospective and retrospective/narrative use. Contrast *nobêt*: deictic, proximal, prospective-only.

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benıîæ

Etymology

vanilla — the flavor/plant; no semantic shift.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /bɛˈniæ/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈH) [Open: whether final /æ/ is a separate light syllable or part of a diphthongal heavy nucleus with /i/].

Phonological development: /v/ → /b/ onset [Open: /v/→/b/ environment; see *béntsuỳ*, *boeś*]; initial unstressed /ə/ → /ɛ/ (E5) → e; /n/ does not elide [Open: E1 targets intervocalic /n/; in *vanilla* the /n/ is onset of the stressed syllable between two vowels — possible blocking of E1 in stressed-onset position; needs rule statement]; stressed /ɪ/ + /j/ glide (from /ɫ/→/j/ between flanking high front vowels /ɪ/ and /ə/) → /iː/ → ıî (circumflex = pitch + stress coincide) [Open: left flank is /ɪ/, right flank /ə/ — §4.4.1 conditions /ɫ/→/j/ on *high front vowel* flanks; /ə/ is not high front]; final /ə/ strengthens to /æ/ [Open: /ə/→/æ/ in word-final position rather than expected /a/ from E5; new conditioning].

Definition

1. vanilla (the flavor and the plant).

---

benskyi

Etymology

minuscule — the adjective; no semantic shift.

Part of speech: adj. **IPA:** /bɛnˈski/ **Foot:** (H)(ˈL).

Phonological development: /m/ → /b/ (§4.4.1 /m,p/→/b/ in onset); /ɪ/ (V_1) → /ɛ/ [Open: /ɪ/→/ɛ/ rule; see *nobêt*]; /n/ does not elide [Open: same stressed-onset blocking question as *benıîæ*]; /ɪ/ (V_2) → ∅ (E3: unstressed vowel, cluster-feeding position); /sk/ cluster-internal → both segments stay [Open: onset /s/ debuccalizes to /h/ normally; cluster position may shield it — not stated in §4.4.1]; /j/ (from /kj/) → /j/ → y; /uːl/: /uː/ → /ɪ/ (§4.4.2 back-vowel fronting, short reflex), /l/ → ∅ (E2c coda-singleton elision) → /ɪ/ → i.

Definition

1. small; tiny; minuscule.

---

beńt

Etymology

mint — the herb, flavor, and candy type; no semantic shift.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /bɛn̥t/ **Foot:** (ˈH) heavy monosyllable.

Phonological development: /m/ → /b/ (§4.4.1); /ɪ/ → /ɛ/ [Open: /ɪ/→/ɛ/ rule]; coda /nt/ cluster: /t/ devoices /n/ → /n̥/ → ń; /t/ remains word-final [Open: E2a predicts coda /t/→/ʔ/; retention of surface /t/ here is unexpected — possible blocking in coda-cluster position, or the devoiced /n̥/ feeds a different coda treatment].

Definition

1. mint (the herb).
2. mint flavor; anything mint-flavored.

---

béo·ò

Etymology

bit ago — the temporal phrase "a little bit before (now)"; narrowed to the short interval just preceding speech time.

Part of speech: adv. **IPA:** /bɛˈoo/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈL)(L) [Open: foot structure of the /oo/ hiatus sequence].

Phonological development: *bit* /bɪt/: /b/→/b/; /ɪ/→/ɛ/ [Open: /ɪ/→/ɛ/ rule]; /t/→/ʔ/ (E2a) → lexical drop [Open: /ʔ/-drop here is not in a grammaticalized particle; if the /ʔ/ is simply silent, or if it merges with the following vowel onset, needs rule statement]; initial /ə/ of *ago* → /o/ [Open: /ə/→/o/ not fully stated in §4.4.2; see *nobêt* for a parallel]; /g/ elides (E1: intervocalic tap-merger consonant) → hiatus; /oʊ/ → /o/; resulting /o.o/ hiatus retained → o·ò (interpunct marks hiatus; grave on final ò = stress in formal register). Pitch on /bɛ/ (GA primary stress on *bit*); stress on final /o/.

Definition

1. (*adv.*) a little bit before (this moment); just a short time ago.

Cross-refs: *rúrọ* (general "approximately; around"); *récquìs* (also; likewise — different temporal reference direction).

---

bessts

Etymology

message — the verb "to send a message to someone"; digital/text communication primary.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /ˈbɛsːts/ **Foot:** (ˈH) heavy monosyllable.

Phonological development: /m/ → /b/ (§4.4.1); /æ/ → /ɛ/ (short reflex); /s/: gemination [Open: the /s/→/sː/ gemination rule applies at the syllable boundary preceding stress; in *message* the stressed syllable is the first (/ˈmæs/), so the /s/ is not preceding stress but within the stressed syllable — rule environment unclear for this case]; /ɪ/ → ∅ (E3); /dʒ/ → /ts/ [Open: /dʒ/ is in E1's intervocalic set; in word-final coda position with no following vowel, coda /dʒ/ treatment is unspecified — /dʒ/→/ts/ by partial devoicing is a plausible path but not a stated rule].

Definition

1. to send a message to (someone); to text; to DM.

---

béuksoè

Etymology

backstory — from the colloquial GA compound *back* + *story*; all three senses are extensions of "the narrative behind something."

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /ˈbɛːk.soɛ/ **Foot:** (ˈH)(L) [Open].

Phonological development: *back* /bæk/: /b/→/b/; /æ/→/ɛː/ (§4.4.2 /æ/→/eː/ pathway) → éu; coda /k/ → [Open: coda /k/→∅ per §4.4.1, but headword retains /k/ — possible cluster-shielding if /k/ is reanalyzed as onset of second syllable, but then onset /k/→/h/; /k/ surface retention unexplained]; *story* /ˈstɔːɹi/: /st/→ stays? [Open: /st/→/ts/ applies in onset; here /s/ is onset of the second component → /s/ onset stays as /s/]; /ɔːɹ/ coda → /o/ (§4.4.2 /or/→/oː/ pathway, shortened); final /i/ → [Open: /i/ in final position → syllabic /j/ or stays? headword shows bare è = stressed /ɛ/].

Definition

1. reason; explanation; excuse.
2. childhood; personal history; the backstory of a person's development.
3. history (general); the narrative record of how something came to be.

---

beušiioskô

Etymology

where-she-goes-to-school — a descriptive circumlocution as etymon; a grammaticalized compound form designating the institution.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** [Open — compound form] **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: [Open — morphological compound; phonology of component parts pending analysis in a dedicated session. See *bawiiquoh?*, *bewii·iit*, *bewiipessô* for parallel constructions.]

Definition

1. school; educational institution.

Notes

Like *bawiiquoh?* and the *bewii-* compounds, the etymon is a periphrastic description rather than a GA simple word. The beušiioskô form likely encodes morphological elements (locative, subject agreement, or directional) — full analysis deferred to a dedicated morphology session.

---

beusp

Etymology

massive — the adjective; narrowed to physical size (not intensity or scale).

Part of speech: adj. **IPA:** /bɛːsp/ **Foot:** (ˈH) heavy monosyllable.

Phonological development: /m/ → /b/ (§4.4.1); /æ/ → /ɛː/ (§4.4.2 /æ/→/eː/) → eu; /s/: non-onset /s/ before further consonants [Open: coda /s/ treatment — expected /z/ by non-onset default, but surface /s/ here; devoicing by adjacent voiceless context?]; /ɪ/ → ∅ (E3: unstressed, cluster-feeding); /v/ → /b/? → /p/ [Open: coda /v/ treatment not in §4.4.1; /v/ → /b/ in onset is the flagged-open rule; coda /v/ might devoice to /f/→/θ/ via /f/→/θ/ rule, or → /p/ by labial stop]; the resulting coda cluster sp is the final form.

Definition

1. large; big; massive.

Cross-refs: *benskyi* (antonym: small, tiny).

---

beussou

Etymology

pass out — colloquial "fall asleep from fatigue" primary; "lose consciousness" secondary (salience inverted from GA).

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /ˌbɛːˈsːoː/ **Foot:** (ˌH)(ˈH).

Phonological development: /pʰ/ → /b/ [Open: environment to be finalized — see phonology §4.1]; /æ/ → /ɛː/; /s/ geminates to /sː/ at stressed-syllable boundary rather than debuccalizing; /aʊ/ → /oː/; coda /ʔ/ dropped (lexically conditioned in grammaticalized particles; careful-speech variant /ˌbɛːˈsːoːʔ/ exists).

Definition

1. to fall asleep from fatigue; to sleep heavily.
2. to lose consciousness; to faint.

---

beųtw

Etymology

bento — the Japanese-origin word for a portioned lunch box, now used generally for any packed meal brought to work or school.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /bɛ̃ːtw̩/ **Foot:** (ˈH) with syllabic /w̩/ tail.

Phonological development: /b/→/b/; /ɛn/: /n/ elides (E1: treated as intervocalic between the stressed /ɛ/ and following coda cluster) [Open: E1 canonically targets intervocalic consonants between full vowels; here /n/ is in coda before /t/ — whether E1 fires in this environment is unresolved]; nasalization on /ɛ/ (S1) → /ɛ̃/; length of /ɛ̃ː/ [Open: source of length unclear — possible compensatory lengthening after /n/-elision (not a stated rule), or analogical extension of eu-digraph for long vowels]; /t/ stays [Open: E2a predicts /t/→/ʔ/; cluster-position blocking?]; /oʊ/ → /oː/ → syllabic /w̩/ in appendix position (§4.3 step 7).

Definition

1. lunch; any portioned meal packed for consumption away from home, especially for school or work.

---

bewii·iit

Etymology

where-we-eat — descriptive circumlocution; grammaticalized compound.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** [Open — compound form] **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: [Open — morphological compound; pending analysis. See *bawiiquoh?*, *beušiioskô*, *bewiipessô* for parallel constructions.]

Definition

1. dining table; the place where meals are eaten together.

---

bewiipessô

Etymology

where-we-pass-out — descriptive circumlocution based on *beussou* (to fall asleep from fatigue); grammaticalized compound.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** [Open — compound form] **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: [Open — morphological compound; the bewii- element likely encodes a locative or directional morpheme; -pessô contains *beussou*-stem material. Pending dedicated morphology session.]

Cross-refs: *beussou* (to fall asleep; stem of the -pessô component); *bewii·iit*, *bawiiquoh?*, *beušiioskô* (parallel compounds).

Definition

1. bed.

---

beykw

Etymology

vehicle — broadened from private car to any motor vehicle.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /ˈbɛjkw̩/ **Foot:** (ˈH) with syllabic /w̩/ tail.

Phonological development: /v/ → /b/ onset [Open: /v/→/b/ environment; see *béntsuỳ*]; /iː/ → /ɛ/ [Open: /iː/→/ɛ/ not in §4.4.2; expected reflex of GA /iː/ is /iː/ or possibly /i/; short /ɛ/ outcome would require a new rule]; /ɪ/ → /j/ (glide formation in hiatus with preceding /ɛ/) → y [Open: /ɪ/→/j/ conditioned by hiatus; not the same environment as the /ɫ/→/j/ rule in §4.4.1]; /k/ cluster-internal stays [Open: see *barnkw*]; /l/ → /w̩/ (syllabic glide, E2c + final position) → w.

Definition

1. car; automobile.
2. any motor vehicle, including buses and trucks.

---

bę̨iink

Etymology

panic — the verb, with semantic extension to worry and apprehension.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /bɛ̃ˈink/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈH) [Open: whether the /ɛ̃/ syllable is light or heavy].

Phonological development: /p/ → /b/ (§4.4.1); /æ/ + following /n/ → /ɛ̃/ (/æ/-before-nasal pathway §4.4.2, short reflex) [Open: §4.4.2 predicts /ɛː/ long; short /ɛ̃/ here suggests the length component is blocked when /n/ stays as onset rather than eliding]; /n/ stays as onset of second syllable (E1 blocked — /n/ is onset of unstressed syllable adjacent to a stressed vowel, same blocking environment as *benı́œ* and *benskyi*); /ɪ/ → /i/ (tense short) [Open: /ɪ/→/i/ tense promotion not in §4.4.2]; /k/ in coda stays [Open: coda /k/→∅ expected per §4.4.1; retention unexplained].

Definition

1. to be scared; to be frightened.
2. to worry; to feel anxious about.
3. to deem unfortunate; to dread (a situation or outcome).

---

boeś

Etymology

voice — the noun; semantic range matches GA closely.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /boes/ **Foot:** (ˈH) heavy monosyllable (diphthong nucleus).

Phonological development: /v/ → /b/ onset [Open: /v/→/b/ environment; same flag as *béntsıỳ*; contrast *reų́ś*, *rékwı̀* where /v/ → /r/ — possible conditioning by following vowel quality]; /ɔɪ/ → /oe/ (diphthong; same pathway as *bœ* ← *boy*) [Open: orthographic note — established grapheme for /oe/ is the ligature œ; boeś written without ligature may represent hiatus /bo.ɛs/ rather than the diphthong /boes/ — user confirmation needed]; final /s/ → /s/ (devoiced, written ś: GA /s/ was voiceless; non-onset default is /z/, so devoicing mark required to preserve voicelessness).

Definition

1. voice (the acoustic signal produced by the vocal tract).

Cross-refs: *bœ* (same /ɔɪ/→/oe/ derivation from *boy*).

---

bœ

Etymology

boy — the noun; no semantic shift.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /boe/ **Foot:** (ˈH) heavy monosyllable (diphthong nucleus).

Phonological development: /b/→/b/; /ɔɪ/→/oe/ (diphthong → œ) [Open: /ɔɪ/→/oe/ not explicitly stated in §4.4.2, which lists /ai/→/eː/~/i/ but not /ɔɪ/; this is a likely new rule or sub-case needed]; no coda consonant.

Definition

1. boy; male child or young man.

Cross-refs: *boeś* (same /ɔɪ/→/oe/ derivation from *voice*).

---

e

Etymology

egg — the food item; no semantic shift.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /ɛ/ **Foot:** (ˈL) light monosyllable.

Phonological development: /ɛ/ → /ɛ/ (unchanged); coda /g/ → ∅ [Open: §4.4.1 specifies coda /k/→∅; coda /g/ (voiced counterpart) is not listed — analogous loss assumed; or /g/ elides via E1 if treated as being between a vowel and silence, but that environment is non-standard]. Pitch and stress coincide on the only vowel; casual orthography = bare e; formal = ê.

Definition

1. egg (especially a bird or chicken egg as food).

---

emmáwwè

Etymology

in what way — the interrogative phrase, lexicalized as a single adverb.

Part of speech: adv. (interrogative). **IPA:** /ɛmːˈɑwːɛ/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: [Open — the reduction of a three-word phrase /ɪn.wʌt.weɪ/ to a single phonological word involves several steps not individually attested: initial /ɪn/ + adjacent /w/ of *what* → /m/ (possible labial assimilation of /n/ before /w/) → /mː/ (gemination of boundary /m/); /wʌt/: /ʌ/→/ɑ/ (§4.4.2 /u,ʊ,ʌ/→/ɨ/ pathway; short /ɑ/ reflex), /t/→/ʔ/→drops; /weɪ/: /w/→/wː/ (gemination at boundary?) → /wː/ → ww; /eɪ/→/ɛ/

→ è. Most steps are unattested; this entry records the headword as given with the full derivation flagged for a dedicated session.]

Definition

1. how; in what way; by what means.

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epplii

Etymology

to apply — with ambisyllabic /p/ in GA (/əp.ˈpłaɪ/) phonologized as a true geminate.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /ˈɛpːli/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: initial unstressed /ə/ → /ɛ/ [Open: new rule needed — see phonology §4.2]; /p.p/ ambisyllabic → geminate /pː/; /aɪ/ → short /i/ [Open: third reflex for §4.2's conditioning-open question].

Cross-refs: *beussou* (parallel geminate from ambisyllabic stop); *rhiiy* (morpheme entry for the rhiiy- prefix); *rhiiysseunnou*, *rhiiynii* (parallel rhiiy- prefix in alternative form *rhiiyepplii*).

Definition

1. to put, place, or spread something on something else (paint, ointment, a label).
2. to put effort into a task; to try with real effort. Sense 2 admits the alternative form *rhiiyepplii* (with the rhiiy- intensifier prefix, still transparent here — unlike its fully-bleached form in *rhiiysseunnou* and *rhiiynii*).
3. to apply for (a job, position, program).

éuskrıì

Etymology

icecream — the compound noun; no semantic shift.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /ɛːˈskɾi/ **Foot:** (H)(ˈL).

Phonological development: *ice* /aɪs/: /aɪ/ → /ɛː/ (§4.4.2 /ai/→/eː/ pathway) → éu; pitch stays on this syllable (GA primary stress on *ice*). At the *ice-cream* juncture, the /s/ of *ice* meets the /kr/ onset of *cream* → resulting cluster /skɾ/ [Open: onset /k/ normally debuccalizes to /h/; in the cluster /sk/, the /k/ is shielded — or /kr/→/r̥/ (§4.4.1) collapses the cluster differently; exact path unclear]. *cream* /kriːm/: /r/ → /ɾ/ (tap); /iː/ → /i/ short (secondary stress, final vocalic position in conlang) → ıì (dotless ı = first element of ii with following diacritic; grave ì = stress); /m/ in coda → ∅ [Open: coda /m/ treatment not in §4.4].

Definition

1. ice cream.

ęy

Etymology

any — NPI determiner/pronoun "any whatsoever," GA /eni/. Inherited as a strict negative-polarity item, narrowed to the concord reinforcer of the volitive-negative marker *skwkw*.

Part of speech: aux. (VOL.NEG concord reinforcer; doubly restricted NPI). **IPA:** /ẽj̃/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: intervocalic /n/ elides, leaving nasalization on the flanking vowels (E1, S1); smooths to a single nasalized /ej/ diphthong [Open: smoothing conditioned by function-word status — a lexical word such as *penny* would remain disyllabic; conditioning rule not yet in §4]. Glide nasalization predictable from the nasalized vowel; left unmarked (headword *ęy*, not *ęỹ*).

Cross-refs: *skwkw* (sole licensor); *rhiiy* (parallel reinforcer, in the *nocquî* paradigm).

Definition

1. (*aux., VOL.NEG concord reinforcer*) emphatic floor-of-the-scale particle, sitting with the action or object quantified over; licensed only by *skwkw* within the LVC. Reinforces categorical refusal: "any instance whatsoever." — *I'm skwkw passing out ęy.* "I'm refusing to fall asleep at all."

Notes

Doubly restricted: licensed only in negative contexts (NPI behavior) and, within those, only by verbal *skwkw*. Does not survive the adverbial/substitutional uses of *skwkw* (*on my way to the bar skwkw ęy gym* is unnatural). The concord is paradigm-internal, not a property of *skwkw* wherever it appears.

In nested negation, *ęy* sits locally with the lexical verb (post-*skwkw*), while the outer marker's reinforcer (*rhiiy*, for *nocquî*) sits clause-finally — the two reinforcers occupy different structural positions and do not compete. — *nocquî go ahead and skwkw ęy V rhiiy.*

[Open: *ęy* may have other NPI distributions (questions, conditionals, comparatives) not yet described.]

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hohô

Etymology

how so — a rhetorical question reduced to a fixed interrogative particle. The GA rhetorical "how so?" (requesting explanation or justification) has lexicalized as a general why-question word.

Part of speech: interrogative particle. **IPA:** /hoˈho/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈL).

Phonological development: *how* /haʊ/: onset /h/→/h/; /aʊ/→/o/ (§4.4.2); *so* /soʊ/: onset /s/→/h/ (debuccalization); /oʊ/→/o/; circumflex on final ô = pitch + stress coincide (GA stress and conlang final stress both on the second syllable). The internal h (written between the two o vowels) marks the boundary; if read as a hiatus-delimiter it is silent; if phonologically active it marks breathy voice on the adjacent vowel (see orthography.md §4).

Definition

1. why; how so; for what reason.

---

hoiiǫ

Etymology

sodium — narrowed from the chemical element to the everyday substance.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /ˈhoiõ/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: /s/ → /h/ (debuccalization); intervocalic /d/ elided (E1); /oʊ/ → /o/; final /-iəm/: labial /m/ colors the schwa, deviating from the expected /ɛ/ outcome → /o/ rather than /iɛm/ or /iɛ̃b/; /m/ then elides, leaving nasalization on the vowel → /-iõ/ (written *iiǫ*). [Open: labial-coloring-of-schwa + /m/-elision-with-nasalization proposed as a productive rule for all *-ium* endings — attested or predictable in *podium*, *Colosseum*, *Liam*; to be formalized in phonology.md in a dedicated session.]

Definition

1. salt (the seasoning; the mineral).

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hoʔnʔnts

Etymology

countenance — narrowed to the concrete body-part term; facial expression, demeanor, and composure senses not inherited.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /ˈhoʔn̩ʔn̩ts/ **Foot:** (ˈH) with multiple syllabic-C nuclei.

Phonological development: onset /k/ → /h/; /aʊ/ → /o/; E3 schwa elision in unstressed positions; /n/ → syllabic /n̩/; /st/ → /ts/; coda /ʔ/ preserved.

Definition

1. face (the part of the body).

Notes

A showcase for syllabic-consonant phonology: three nuclei follow the stressed vowel, two of them /n̩/ and one a complex coda /ts/. Stress remains on the initial /o/ — the syllabic consonants are moraic but not full vocalic positions for stress placement.

---

hóhonìt

Etymology

coconut — the fruit; no semantic shift.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /ˈhohoˌnɪt/ **Foot:** (ˈH)(L)(L) [Open: foot structure of three-syllable output].

Phonological development: onset /k/→/h/ twice (§4.4.1, both syllables); /oʊ/→/o/ (§4.4.2) for both /koʊ/ syllables; medial /ə/ → /o/ [Open: E3 predicts /ə/→∅, which would give cluster /hn/; the surface /o/ between the second /h/ and /n/ requires /ə/→/o/ rather than elision — same open rule as *nobêt* but without the /n/-conditioning; possibly a more general /ə/→/o/ rule in unstressed open-syllable position before a nasal]; /n/ stays (onset of the secondary-stressed syllable, same stress-onset blocking environment as *benúœ* etc.); /ʌ/→/ɪ/ (§4.4.2); /t/ stays [Open: E2a predicts /t/→/ʔ/].

Definition

1. coconut (the fruit, and coconut as a flavor).

---

hœ hoś

Etymology

soy sauce — the condiment; no semantic shift.

Part of speech: n. (two-word headword). **IPA:** /hoe ˈhos/ **Foot:** (ˈH)(ˈH) [two phonological words].

Phonological development: *soy* /sɔɪ/: onset /s/→/h/ (debuccalization); /ɔɪ/→/oe/ (diphthong; same pathway as *bœ* ← *boy*) → hœ; *sauce* /sɔːs/: onset /s/→/h/ (debuccalization); /ɔː/→/o/ (§4.4.2 /au,or/→/o/); coda /s/: GA source was voiceless /s/ → non-onset default is /z/, so devoiced mark required → ś; circumflex on ô… actually the headword is hoś (no circumflex): the formal-register circumflex is absent in the casual form; stress falls on the second phonological word (hoś).

Definition

1. soy sauce.

---

nobêt

Etymology

(*i*)*n a bit* — from colloquial GA /nəbɪt/ (initial /ɪ/ of "in" already elided in GA liaison).

Part of speech: adv. **IPA:** /noˈbɛʔ/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈL) [Open: depends on whether coda /ʔ/ contributes weight].

Phonological development: /ɪ/ of "in" elided at GA stage (colloquial liaison; not a conlang rule); /ə/ of "a" → /o/ in nasal environment [Open: /ə/ → /o/ rounding after /n/ not in §4.4.2; new rule needed]; /ɪ/ of "bit" → /ɛ/ after /b/ [Open: this lowering not in §4.4.2; new rule needed]; /t/ → /ʔ/ (E2a).

Cross-refs: *béntsuỳ* (anaphoric counterpart).

Definition

1. (*adv.*) soon; in a short while.

Notes

Deictic — anchored to speech time (t_0); prospective, denoting a short interval following the moment of utterance. Carries a commitment implicature in promissory contexts. Use in third-person narrative is restricted to informal deictic-shift contexts, parallel to GA "in a bit". Contrast *béntsuỳ*: anaphoric, duration-neutral, narrative-compatible.

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nocquiî

Etymology

not quite — adverbial phrase "approximately; falling short of," colloquial GA /nɑʔ kwaɪʔ/ (from /nɑt kwaɪt/ with coda glottalization). Lexicalized as a single unit before grammaticalizing as the non-volitive-negative marker. The approximative-from-below semantics is inherited and underlies both the high-scope frustrative reading and the low-scope attenuative reading. Also productive as a derivational element forming "a small lack" compounds (see Morphology).

Part of speech: aux. (LVC.NONVOL.NEG); also adv. (temporal proximative, substitutional apologetic); also deriv. prefix. **IPA:** /noˈkʷːi/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: /ɑ/ → /o/ (raising-and-rounding, word-initially and after /n/) [Open: new rule, not in §4]; /aɪ/ → /i/; /ʔk/ → geminate /kʷː/ (coda glottal of *not* assimilates to and geminates the following /k/, which labializes from the /w/ of *quite*) [Open: /ʔk/-gemination rule not in §4]; final coda /ʔ/ (from *quite*'s /t/) drops [Open: coda /ʔ/ drop condition at compound junctions]; the final /i/ from /aɪ/ carries stress and pitch (circumflex in headword). Spelling: cqu for /kʷː/ dictionary-internal pending propagation to orthography.md.

Cross-refs: *skwkw* (paradigmatic opposite on the polarity axis, volitive side); *rhiiy* (concord reinforcer in the LVC, and the general negator); *ęy* (parallel reinforcer in the *skwkw* paradigm).

Definition

1. (*aux., LVC.NONVOL.NEG*) the non-volitive-negative cell of the light verb complex; marks falling-short, typically with a frustrative reading (a trajectory toward V, often involuntary, that fails to reach V, with the not-reaching foregrounded and often regretful). — *I do nocquiî get myself tuning them out.* "I couldn't manage to tune them out and ended up watching anyway."
2. (*low-scope attenuative*) under a volitive LVC, modifies the lexical verb: "only partway; only a little." — *I go ahead and nocquiî tune them out.* "I deliberately tune them out only a little bit."
3. (*adv., temporal proximative*) before; not yet at. — *on my way to the gym when it's nocquiî Thursday* "…before Thursday."
4. (*adv., substitutional apologetic*) rather than; instead of — softened, with an unintentional or mildly apologetic flavor (contrast the deliberate substitutional *skwkw* sense 2). — *on my way to the bar nocquiî the gym* "…the bar, rather than the gym."

Morphology

Derivational prefix *nocquii-*, forming compounds that denote "a small lack" — a quantitative or qualitative falling-short of the base noun. Productive. The combining form is *nocquii-*; the junction behaves per the phonology:

- Before an obstruent, the dropped coda /ʔ/ geminates the following consonant. When the geminating consonant is /k/, gemination **bleeds debuccalization** (a geminate /kː/ does not debuccalize to /h/ the way a singleton onset /k/ does), yielding /h/ ~ /kː/ alternations between free and bound forms.
- Before a vowel or rhotic, a linker *-e-* appears.

[Open: combining-form rules inferred from attested compounds; ratify. Open: stress/pitch placement in compounds undetermined.]

Notes

Pairs with the reinforcer *rhiiy* (sense 1): an optional emphatic concord particle sitting clause-finally, licensed only by *nocquiî* within the LVC and not surviving the adverbial uses (senses 3–4). — *I'm not quite getting myself to pass out rhiiy.*

The frustrative reading (sense 1) is compositional — falling-short semantics + the non-volitive frame + the action's natural endpoint — not separately encoded.

Has both high scope (sense 1) and low scope (sense 2), in contrast to *skwkw* (high-scope only). The split follows from the degree-of-approximation core, which can target a whole event or the realization-level within an event.

[Open: glossing convention for nested negation. Open: distribution across the four non-volitive submodalities (PH, AB, INC, PS) — whether even, or favoring some; and whether AB admits *nocquiî* at all. For verbal-system.md §9.]

---

nocquiiayo

Etymology

nocquii- "a small lack" + *ayo* "joe; coffee" (base not yet an entry; GA slang *joe* → derivation [Open]). Decaffeinated coffee — coffee falling short of full coffee.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** [Open]. **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: *nocquii-* + vowel-initial base. [Open: the *nocquıı̂* Morphology section specifies a linker *-e-* before vowel- or rhotic-initial bases, predicting *nocquiieayo*; headword *nocquiiayo* has no linker — reconcile combining-form rule.]

Cross-refs: *nocquıı̂* (deriving prefix); *ayo* "joe; coffee" (base, not yet an entry); *nocquiie-ŕóųzǫ*, *nocquiissprıı̃* (parallel *nocquii-* compounds).

Definition

1. (*n.*) decaffeinated coffee; decaf.

---

nocquiie-ŕóųzǫ

Etymology

nocquii- "a small lack" + *ŕóųzǫ* "chromosome" (base not yet an entry; GA source and derivation [Open]). Named for the chromosomal difference characteristic of the condition.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** [Open]. **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: *nocquii-* + rhotic-initial base takes the linker *-e-* (see *nocquıı̂* Morphology). Base derivation [Open].

Cross-refs: *nocquıı̂* (deriving prefix); *nocquiiayo*, *nocquiissprıı̃* (parallel *nocquii-* compounds).

Definition

1. (*n.*) Down syndrome.

---

nocquiissprıı̃

Etymology

nocquii- "a small lack" + *sprıı̃* "spring" (base not yet an entry; GA *spring* → derivation [Open]; nasalized vowel from /ŋ/). The period after February that is nominally spring but still feels like winter.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** [Open]. **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: at the *nocquii-* + *spr-* junction, the dropped coda /ʔ/ geminates the following /s/ → /sː/ (spelled *ss*); final nasalization from *spring*'s /ŋ/ transferred to vowel. Base derivation [Open].

Cross-refs: *nocquıî* (deriving prefix); *nocquiiayo*, *nocquiie-ŕóųzǫ* (parallel *nocquii-* compounds).

Definition

1. (*n.*) the cold, gray period after February when it is nominally spring but the weather is still wintry; roughly March.

---

noê

Etymology

in a way — GA /ɪn ə ˈweɪ/, pragmatic hedge phrase grammaticalized as a clause-final modal adverb.

Part of speech: adv. **IPA:** /noˈɛ/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈL).

Phonological development: /ɪ/→/o/ [Open: /ɪ/→/o/ after initial /n/ — rule not in §4; flagged in pending phonology session]; coda /n/→∅ (E1) + S1 nasalizes — nasalization lost or absorbed [Open]; /ə/→∅ (E4); /w/→/ɻ/ (§4.4.1); intervocalic /ɻ/ + no prior /h/ → M1 plain onset → R-Assim → /ɾ/ → E1 elides; /eɪ/→/ɛ/ [Open: /eɪ/→/ɛ/ shortening path].

Definition

1. (*adv.*) in a way; sort of; somewhat. Clause-final position.

---

nóeıìe

Etymology

no idea — GA /noʊ aɪˈdiə/, colloquial response particle reduced to a single phonological word.

Part of speech: interj. **IPA:** /noɛˈiɛ/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: /n/→/n/; /oʊ/→/o/; /aɪ/→/ɛ/ [Open: /aɪ/→/ɛ/ short reflex — distinct from established /eː/ and /i/ pathways; conditioning unresolved]; /d/→/ɾ/ (tap merger, §4.4.1) → intervocalic → E1 elides; /ɪ/→/i/ [Open: tense promotion]; /ə/→/ɛ/ [Open: E5 normally gives /a/; /ɛ/ here possibly front-vowel assimilation].

Definition

1. (*interj.*) no idea; I don't know; beats me.

---

nœ

Etymology

annoy — GA /əˈnɔɪ/.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /noe/ **Foot:** (ˈH) [Open: diphthong weight].

Phonological development: initial /ə/→∅ (E3); /n/→/n/; /ɔɪ/→/oe/ [Open: /ɔɪ/→/oe/ pathway not in §4.4.2 — parallel to *bœ*, *boeś*].

Cross-refs: *bœ* (parallel /ɔɪ/→/oe/).

Definition

1. to annoy; to irritate; to bother.

---

ohô

Etymology

oh I see — GA /oʊ aɪ siː/, colloquial acknowledgment phrase. Grammaticalized as a realization interjection.

Part of speech: interj. **IPA:** /oˈho/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈL).

Phonological development: /oʊ/→/o/; /aɪ/→∅ [Open: absorbed]; /s/→/h/ (§4.4.1 debuccalization); /iː/→/o/ [Open: /iː/→/o/ pathway not in §4.4.2]. Circumflex on ô = pitch+stress coincide.

Definition

1. (*interj.*) oh I see; aha; I understand now. — recognition, realization.

óhò

Etymology

oh hey / *hey* — GA /heɪ/ or /oʊ ˈheɪ/, attention-getting interjection.

Part of speech: interj. **IPA:** /ˈoho/ **Foot:** (ˈL)(L).

Phonological development: [Open: full derivation unclear — /h/ retention in onset; /oʊ/→/o/; /eɪ/→/o/ [Open: /eɪ/→/o/ not in §4.4.2]].

Definition

1. (*interj.*) hey!; hi!; (attention-getter, greeting).

---

ouś

Etymology

August — GA /ˈɔːɡəst/, proper noun.

Part of speech: proper n. **IPA:** /ˈoːs/ **Foot:** (ˈH).

Phonological development: /ɔː/→/oː/ (back long vowel; written ou); /ɡ/→/ɾ/ (tap merger, §4.4.1) → intervocalic → E1 elides; /ə/→∅ (E3); coda /st/→/ts/ (§4.4.1) → /t/→/ʔ/ (E2a) → drops [Open: /ʔ/-drop condition here]; /s/ in coda position → non-onset → /z/ → devoiced → ś.

Definition

1. August (the month).

---

piiquóæ

Etymology

peek over at — GA /piːk ˈoʊvər æt/, periphrastic phrase lexicalized as a single verb.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /piˈkʷoæ/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈH) [Open].

Phonological development: /p/→/p/ (blocked before /i/, §4.4.1 /p/→/b/ rule); /iː/→/i/ [Open: /iː/ shortening]; coda /k/ of *peek* labializes absorbing onset /w/ of *over* → /kʷ/ [Open: /k/ labialization mechanism]; /oʊ/→/o/; /v/→∅ or /ɾ/ → elides [Open]; /ər/→∅ (E3+E1); /æ/→/æ/ (residual, final).

Definition

1. to peek over at; to glance toward; to sneak a look at.

---

piquô

Etymology

pick out — GA /pɪk ˈaʊt/, phrasal verb. *Out* particle grammaticalized with /ʔ/-drop (cf. *rhiïysseunnou*).

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /pɪˈkʷoː/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈH).

Phonological development: /p/→/p/ (blocked before /ɪ/); /ɪ/→/ɪ/; coda /k/ labializes absorbing *out*'s /aʊ/ → /kʷ/ [Open: same mechanism as *piiquóæ*]; /aʊ/→/oː/; coda /t/→/ʔ/ (E2a) → drops (grammaticalized *out* /ʔ/-drop, §4.4.3 E2d). Circumflex on ô = pitch+stress coincide.

Cross-refs: *rhiïysseunnou* (parallel grammaticalized *out* /ʔ/-drop).

Definition

1. to pick out; to select; to choose.

---

pot

Etymology

pout — GA /paʊt/.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /pot/ **Foot:** (ˈH).

Phonological development: /p/→/p/; /aʊ/→/o/ (§4.4.2 /au, or/→/o/); coda /t/ retained [Open: E2a predicts /t/→/ʔ/; retention here unexplained — possibly analogy or high-frequency blocking].

Definition

1. to pout.
2. to sulk; to brood petulantly.

---

récquiìs

Etymology

likewise — GA /ˈlaɪkˌwaɪz/.

Part of speech: adv. **IPA:** /ˈɾɛkʷːis/ **Foot:** (ˈH)(L).

Phonological development: /l/→/ɻ/ [Open: /ɫ/→/ɻ/ candidate rule — dark-l vocalization; see pending phonology session]; /aɪ/→/ɛ/ [Open: /aɪ/→/ɛ/ short reflex]; coda /k/ + *wise* onset /w/ → geminate /kʷː/ [Open: labialization and gemination mechanism]; /aɪ/ of *wise* → /ɪ/ [Open]; coda /z/→devoiced /s/.

Definition

1. likewise; similarly; in the same way.

---

réiì

Etymology

dairy — GA /ˈdeɪri/.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /ɾɛˈi/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈL).

Phonological development: /d/→/ɾ/ (tap merger, §4.4.1); /eɪ/→/ɛ/ [Open: /eɪ/→/ɛ/ shortening — distinct from established /eɪ/→/eː/]; medial /ɹ/→/ɻ/ → M1 (no /h/ onset) → plain /ɻ/ onset → R-Assim → /ɾ/ → E1 (intervocalic) elides; /i/→/i/ retained.

Definition

1. dairy; dairy products collectively.
2. milk.

---

rékriiyæ

Etymology

yakitty-yak — GA /ˈjækɪtiˌjæk/, expressive reduplication for idle chatter.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /ɾɛkˈɾiːæ/ **Foot:** (H)(ˈH).

Phonological development: first /j/→/ɻ/ (§4.4.1) → R-Assim → /ɾ/ (second /j/ also present); /æ/→/ɛ/ [Open: /æ/→/ɛ/ without preceding nasal — distinct from established nasal pathway]; /k/ retained in cluster; /ɪ/→∅ (E3); /t/→/ɾ/ (tap merger); second /j/→/ɻ/→R-Assim→/ɾ/; /iː/ from smoothing [Open: trigger path]; final /æ/→/æ/ retained.

Definition

1. to talk incessantly and idly; to chatter; to ramble; to go on and on.

---

rékwıì

Etymology

victory — GA /ˈvɪktəri/.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /ɾɛˈkʷi/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈL) [Open: /kʷ/ onset weight].

Phonological development: /v/→/ɾ/ [Open: /v/ before front vowel /ɪ/ → tap merger rather than /b/; see /v/ conditioning open question]; /ɪ/→/ɛ/ [Open: /ɪ/→/ɛ/ after onset — rule not in §4]; /kt/ cluster → /kʷ/ [Open: /k/+/t/ → labialized /kʷ/ mechanism]; /ə/→∅ (E3); final /i/ retained.

Definition

1. victory; win; success.

---

rérèyt

Etymology

narrate — GA /nəˈɹeɪt/.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /ɾɛˈɾɛjt/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈH).

Phonological development: /n/→/ɾ/ (tap merger, §4.4.1); /ə/→/ɛ/ (initial unstressed /ə/→/ɛ/, §4.4.2); /ɹ/→/ɻ/→R-Assim→/ɾ/ (since /ɾ/ from /n/ present); /eɪ/→/ɛj/ [Open: /eɪ/→/ɛj/ near-preservation, not full /ɛː/ shift]; coda /t/ retained [Open: E2a predicts /t/→/ʔ/].

Definition

1. to narrate; to tell (a story); to recount.

---

reų́ś

Etymology

Venus — GA /ˈviːnəs/, proper noun.

Part of speech: proper n. **IPA:** /ˈɾɛ̃ːs/ **Foot:** (ˈH).

Phonological development: /v/→/ɾ/ [Open: /v/ before front vowel /iː/ → tap merger; see /v/ conditioning]; /iː/→/ɛː/ [Open: /iː/→/ɛː/ pathway not in §4.4.2]; /n/→∅ (E1) + S1 nasalizes adjacent vowel → /ɛ̃ː/ (written eų); /ə/→∅ (E4); coda /s/→/z/ (non-onset) → devoiced → ś.

Definition

1. Venus (the planet).

---

rıírǫ

Etymology

right around — GA /ɹaɪt əˈɹaʊnd/, directional approximative phrase.

Part of speech: adv./prep. **IPA:** /ɾiˈɾõ/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈH) [Open: nasal vowel weight].

Phonological development: /ɹ/→/ɻ/→R-Assim→/ɾ/ (two rhotics present); /aɪ/→/i/ [Open: /aɪ/→/i/ short reflex — third candidate alongside /eː/ and /ɛ/; conditioning unresolved]; coda /t/→/ʔ/ (E2a) → drops in this grammaticalized phrase [Open: /ʔ/-drop condition]; /ə/→∅ (E4); second /ɹ/→/ɻ/→/ɾ/ (R-Assim); /aʊ/→/o/ (§4.4.2); /n/→∅ (E1) + S1 nasalizes → /õ/ (written ǫ); /d/→∅ (E2b).

Definition

1. (*adv.*) right around; approximately; somewhere around.
2. (*prep.*) around; in the vicinity of.

---

ritsstw

Etymology

Rochester — toponym.

Part of speech: proper n. **IPA:** /ˈritsstw̩/ **Foot:** (ˈH) with sesquisyllabic /w̩/ tail.

Phonological development: /tʃ/ → /ts/; /st/ → /ts/ (or retained as /ts/-cluster); E3 schwa elision; /ɻ/ → syllabic /w̩/ in final position.

Cross-refs: *toutw* (parallel sesquisyllabic /w̩/).

Definition

1. Rochester (the city).

Notes

Used in phonology.md §6.1 as a worked example of heavy onset-and-coda clustering with a final syllabic /w̩/. The double /ts/ at the cluster boundary (from /tʃ/ + /st/) is phonotactically legal; cited there as a test case for sequences like tsst.

---

rhéulyèś

Etymology

wild guess — GA /waɪld gɛs/, idiomatic: a total shot in the dark.

Part of speech: interj. **IPA:** /ɻɛːlˈjɛs/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: /w/→/ɻ/ (§4.4.1); /aɪ/→/ɛː/ (§4.4.2 /ai/→/eː/; written eu); /l/ in coda of *wild* retained in cluster /ld/ [Open: E2c targets singleton /l/ only; cluster /l/ exempt — cf. *rhilþ*]; /d/→∅ (E2b); /g/→/ɾ/ (tap merger) → intervocalic → E1 elides; /ɛ/→/ɛ/ (stressed); /s/ falls to coda after /g/-elision → non-onset /s/→/z/→devoiced → ś.

Definition

1. (*interj.*) wild guess; shot in the dark; I'm just guessing.
2. (*interj., stronger*) absolutely no idea; I'm making this up entirely.

---

rhiiy

A polyfunctional morpheme from GA *really*, spanning intensifier prefix → bleached lexical prefix → non-volitive-negative reinforcer → general negator. The bound-prefix uses appear inside *rhiiynii*, *rhiiysseunnou*, and *rhiiyepplii* (under *epplii* sense 2); the free-word uses (reinforcer, general negator) are described here. Consolidated as a single lemma (same form /ɻiː/, same primary source).

Part of speech: aux. (general negation); also aux. (NONVOL.NEG concord reinforcer); also deriv./intensifier prefix rhiiy-. **IPA:** /ɻiː/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: GA /ˈɹɪl.i/ → /ɻiː/: dark velarized /ɫ/, sandwiched between front vowels, becomes /j/ (§4.4.1) and then elides, leaving a lengthened /iː/; onset /ɹ/ → /ɻ/ (§4.4.1). (Same derivation as the rhiiy- prefix attested in *rhiiynii*, *rhiiysseunnou*, *rhiiyepplii* — this entry consolidates that morpheme.)

Cross-refs: *nocquî* (host for the reinforcer reading, sense 2); *skwkw* (volitive-domain negator — complementary distribution by domain); *ɡy* (parallel reinforcer, in the *skwkw* paradigm); *rhiiynii*, *rhiiysseunnou*, *epplii* (contain the bound-prefix uses, senses 3–4).

Definition

1. (*aux., general negation*) "no"; "not so." Volition-neutral propositional negation, used outside the LVC: phrasal denial, short answers, negation of non-verbal predicates. — *Rhiiy.* "No." / "Not so."
   - Etymology: *not really* (colloquial GA general negator), grammaticalized via a Jespersen-cycle pathway — the *not* erodes, leaving bare *really* to carry negative force on its own.
2. (*aux., NONVOL.NEG concord reinforcer*) clause-final emphatic concord with *nocquî* in the LVC; emphasizes the predicate's full realization, the standard the action falls short of. — *I'm not quite getting myself to pass out rhiiy.*
   - Etymology: GA intensifier *really* "to a real degree."
3. (*intensifier prefix rhiiy-*) still-transparent intensifier on a verb stem. — attested in *rhiiyepplii* "to apply oneself with real effort" (under *epplii* sense 2).
   - Etymology: GA intensifier *really*.
4. (*bleached lexical prefix rhiiy-*) fully bleached, no longer felt as an intensifier; part of a lexicalized stem. — attested in *rhiiynii* "to need/want" and *rhiiysseunnou* "to be different/excellent."
   - Etymology: GA *really*, bleached.

Notes

Senses 1 and 2 are **the same morpheme, contextually disambiguated**, not homophones: inside the LVC with *nocquî* upstream → reinforcer reading (sense 2); outside the LVC, or without *nocquî* → negator reading (sense 1). The two play off a shared "realness" core — the reinforcer asserts the predicate's realness as the standard fallen short of; the negator denies the predicate's realness outright.

Senses 3–4 are the bound-prefix uses, which show grammaticalization stratification across the lexicon: transparent in *rhiiyepplii* (sense 3), fully bleached in *rhiiynii* and *rhiiysseunnou* (sense 4).

Does not enter the LVC as a polarity marker (only as the sense-2 reinforcer); verbal negation is handled by the dedicated volition-aware markers *skwkw* and *nocquî*. Fills the standalone declarative-negation gap: *skwkw* standalone is prohibitive, *nocquî* has no standalone use, so *rhiiy* is the language's assertional "no."

[Open: whether negator-*rhiiy* itself attracts a new reinforcer over time (a Jespersen spiral). Deferred — long-horizon.]

---

rhilþ

Etymology

wolf — inherited directly; no semantic shift.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /ˈɻɪlθ/ **Foot:** [Open: depends on whether coda consonants contribute weight].

Phonological development: /w/ → /ɻ/ (§4.4.1 /w, j/ → /ɻ/); /ʊ/ → /ɪ/ (§4.4.2 back-vowel fronting); /f/ → /θ/ (§4.4.1); coda /l/ preserved in cluster /lθ/ (E2c targets singleton /l/; cluster environment exempt).

Definition

1. wolf (the animal).

---

rhiiynii

Etymology

really need — *really* bleached and lexicalized as the rhiiy- prefix; stem from *need*. The need/want polysemy collapses two GA concepts onto a single axis.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /ɻiːni/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: /ɫ/ → /j/ between high front vowels; /ɪji/ → /iː/; coda /d/ → ∅ (E2, no compensatory lengthening).

Cross-refs: *rhiiy* (morpheme entry for the rhiiy- prefix); *rhiiysseunnou* (parallel rhiiy- prefix, fully bleached); *epplii* (intensifier variant *rhiiyepplii*, where rhiiy- is still transparent).

Definition

1. to need.
2. to want.

Notes

The prefix /ɻiː-/ (rhiiy) surfaces as long /iː/ from /ɪji/-smoothing; the stem /ni/ (nii) is short /i/ from coda /d/-deletion with no compensatory lengthening. The /iː/ vs. /i/ contrast within the same word is the orthographic working rule: iiy = long /iː/ (etymologically-justified glide source), ii = short tense /i/ [Open: to be confirmed when orthography.md §3.2 is revised to admit /iː/].

---

rhiiysseunnou

Etymology

really stand out — *really* bleached and lexicalized as the rhiiy- prefix; *stand out* also lexicalized as a phrasal verb in GA. Treated as a single verb in the conlang.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /ɻiːsːɛːnːoː/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: /æ/-tense (pre-nasal in GA, with preserved duration) → /ɛː/ via length reanalysis; /ɫ/ → /j/ between high front vowels; /ɪji/ → /iː/; /st/ → /sː/ at stressed-syllable boundary; /nd/ → /nː/ in coda [Open: new rule needed — see phonology §4]; /aʊ/ → /oː/; /t/ → /ʔ/ in coda; coda /ʔ/ dropped (lexically conditioned in grammaticalized *out*).

Cross-refs: *beussou* (parallel /st/ → /sː/, parallel coda /ʔ/-drop in *out*-particle); *rhiiy* (morpheme entry for the rhiiy- prefix); *rhiiynii*, *epplii* (parallel rhiiy- prefix).

Definition

1. to be different; to stand apart; to be distinctive.
2. to be excellent; to excel.

Notes

The rhiiy- prefix is fully bleached here and in *rhiiynii* — not felt as an intensifier, only as part of the lexicalized stem. Contrast *rhiiyepplii* (under *epplii* sense 2), where the same prefix is still transparent. This stratification (bleached vs. transparent) across the lexicon reflects grammaticalization at different stages.

The eu digraph unifies two diachronic sources: (1) the smoothed-schwa pathway for /ɛː/ in orthography.md §3.2, and (2) the /æ/-with-preserved-duration pathway attested here. Both surface as eu.

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rhiušp

Etymology

worship — GA /ˈwɜːrʃɪp/.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /ɻɨːʃp/ **Foot:** (ˈH) [Open].

Phonological development: /w/→/ɻ/ (§4.4.1); /ɜːr/ (rhotacized mid vowel) → /ɨː/ [Open: /ɜːr/→/ɨː/ unrounding pathway not in §4.4.2]; R-Assim not triggered [Open: rhotacized vowel vocalized rather than producing a separate /ɾ/]; /ʃ/→/ʃ/ retained [Open: confirm /ʃ/ exempt from debuccalization]; /ɪ/→∅ (E3); coda /p/ retained [Open: /p/ not in E2 elision set].

Definition

1. to worship; to revere; to idolize.

---

rhiwıĩ

Etymology

rewind — GA /ˌriːˈwaɪnd/. Two POS consolidated: interjection and adverb/temporal.

Part of speech: interj.; also adv./temporal. **IPA:** /ɹ̥ɪˈwĩ/ **Foot:** (L)(ˈH) [Open: nasal vowel weight].

Phonological development: /ɹ/→/ɹ̥/ (§4.4.1); /iː/→/ɪ/ [Open: /iː/→/ɪ/ shortening/laxing]; /w/→/w/ retained as plain onset; /aɪ/→/i/ [Open: /aɪ/→/i/ short reflex]; /n/→∅ (E1) + S1 nasalizes → /ĩ/ (written ıĩ per ii-diacritic rule — tilde on second element makes first dotless ı); /d/→∅ (E2b).

Definition

1. (*interj.*) rewind; go back; let's start that over; wait, let me back up.
2. (*adv./temporal*) going back to; rewinding to; returning to (an earlier point in narrative or time).

ŕe

Etymology

today — from colloquial GA [tʰɾeɪ] (reduced from [tʰəˈdeɪ] via schwa elision and tap-realization). Sense 2 grammaticalizes the GA emphatic use ("done today" = "right now") as a distinct interjectional sense.

Part of speech: (1) adv., (2) interj. **IPA:** /ˈɾ̥ɛ/ **Foot:** (ˈL) light monosyllable.

Phonological development: /h/ + tap coalescence → /ɾ̥/ (M1 devoicing mechanism generalized to onset, without metathesis); two irregular shifts specific to this high-frequency colloquial form: /t/ → /h/ in onset cluster (not a regular rule); /eɪ/ → short /ɛ/ (clipping, not a regular rule).

Cross-refs: *ŕeut* (parallel /ɾ̥/ onset, from M1 metathesis rather than coalescence).

Definition

1. (*adv.*) today. — *Ŕeus bémmo oų rĩbii·hii. Oų riis·hii o noê.* "It's a little more chillier today, in a pleasant kind of way."
2. (*interj.*) hurry!; right now!; immediately!

Notes

The two irregular shifts — /t/ → /h/ and /eɪ/ → short /ɛ/ — are one-offs licensed by this form's high frequency and rapid-speech origin, not regular rules. The convergence of irregularities in one form is the design point: high-frequency colloquial words bleed off the regular cascade, and *ŕe* is the canonical example.

ŕeut

Etymology

carrot.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /ˈr̥eːʔ/ **Foot:** (ˈH) heavy monosyllable.

Phonological development: onset /k/ → /h/; coda /t/ → /ʔ/; M1 (rhotic metathesis: intervocalic /ɹ̯/ → onset, /h/ reanalyzed as devoicing feature → /r̥/); smoothing of /æ + ə/ → /eː/.

Cross-refs: *ŕe* (parallel /r̥/ onset, from /h/ + tap coalescence rather than M1 metathesis).

Definition

1. carrot (the root vegetable).

Notes

The canonical illustration of M1: GA onset /k/ debuccalizes to /h/, which becomes the devoicing feature on the metathesizing rhotic. Used as a worked example in phonology.md §6.1.

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skwkw

Etymology

skip — GA /skɪp/, "decline; pass over." Lexicalized as the volitive-negative marker. The deliberate-declination semantics is inherited and sharpened to active counter-volition (going out of one's way to not-do, not merely the absence of volition).

Part of speech: aux. (LVC.VOL.NEG); also adv./substitutional; also interj. (prohibitive). **IPA:** /sk^wk^w/ (first /k^w/ syllabic). **Foot:** [omitted].

Phonological development: irregular, peculiar to this high-frequency form. Coda /p/ delabializes — but only after labializing the /k/ (the labial feature transfers from /p/ to /k/ before /p/ is lost). The vowel /ɪ/, squeezed between two /k^w/ sequences, elides entirely, leaving a vowelless /sk^wk^w/ with the first /k^w/ as syllable nucleus. [Open: irregular; not a proposed regular rule.]

Cross-refs: *nocquî* (paradigmatic opposite on the polarity axis, non-volitive side); *rhiïy* (general negator, complementary domain — outside the LVC); *ęy* (concord reinforcer, licensed only by this marker).

Definition

1. (*aux., LVC.VOL.NEG*) the volitive-negative cell of the light verb complex; marks deliberate refusal or active counter-volition. High-scope only. — *I'm skwkw passing out ɡy.* "I'm deliberately refusing to fall asleep (not even a little)."
2. (*adv./substitutional*) in place of, instead of, declining the alternative; deliberate, with a mutual-exclusivity flavor. — *on my way to the bar skwkw the gym* "…the bar, deliberately not the gym."
3. (*interj., prohibitive*) "Don't!"; "Pass on it!" — standalone negative imperative. — *Skwkw!* "Don't!"

Notes

A showcase for vowelless syllabification: /skʷkʷ/ has no vocalic nucleus, the first /kʷ/ serving as the syllable's nucleus. Novel for the lexicon — other consonant-heavy forms (*hoʔnʔnts*, *ritsstw*, *toutw*) retain at least one full vowel. [Open: foot structure and the metrical status of a syllabic obstruent.]

Pairs with the reinforcer *ɡy* (sense 1 only): optional emphatic floor-of-the-scale particle, licensed only by *skwkw* within the LVC, not surviving the adverbial/substitutional uses (sense 2). See *ɡy*.

Does not stack with GO-AHEAD: *going ahead and skwkw V* collapses to the *skwkw* reading since both fill the single volition slot.

Layers with the non-volitive-positive marker (GET-ONESELF) productively but narrowly: *getting myself to skwkw V* = "finding myself in the position of having to deliberately refuse V." Felicitous only in forced-choice contexts.

[Open: glossing convention for nested negation — when *skwkw* appears under *nocquî* or vice versa.]

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spyi

Etymology

spew — GA /spjuː/. Highly specific semantic narrowing to the surprise-spit context.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /spjɪ/ **Foot:** (ˈH) [Open: cluster onset weight].

Phonological development: /s/ in cluster /sp/ retained (not debuccalized) [Open: §4.4.1 debuccalization of /s/ blocked in /sp/ cluster? Rule not in §4]; /p/→/p/; /j/ retained in cluster; /uː/→/ɨː/→/ɪ/ [Open: /uː/→/ɪ/ via /ɨ/ unrounding then shortening].

Definition

1. to spew liquid; specifically: to involuntarily spit out a drink due to surprise or laughter. Most naturally collocates with coffee.

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toś

Etymology

toast — GA /toʊst/.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /ˈtos/ **Foot:** (ˈH).

Phonological development: /t/→/t/; /oʊ/→/o/ [Open: /oʊ/→/o/ short reduction rather than /oː/ — possibly high-frequency]; coda /st/→/ts/ (§4.4.1) → /t/→/ʔ/ (E2a) → drops [Open: /ʔ/-drop condition]; /s/ in coda (non-onset) → /z/→devoiced → ś.

Definition

1. toast (food; sliced bread browned by heat).

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toutw

Etymology

to total to — the GA tallying phrase ("the bill totals to forty dollars") lexicalized as a single verb.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /ˈtoːtw̩/ **Foot:** (ˈH) with sesquisyllabic /w̩/ tail.

Phonological development: /oʊ/ → /oː/; intervocalic tap /ɾ/ elided (E1); coda /ɫ/ → ∅ [Open: not explicitly stated in phonology §4 — see §3.2]; smoothing of /oː + ə/ → /oː/; final unstressed /u/ → syllabic /w̩/ (phonology §5.2 step 7).

Cross-refs: *ritsstw* (parallel sesquisyllabic /w̩/).

Definition

1. to cost a certain amount (of money).
2. to be present in a certain number; to amount to; to add up to.

Notes

Initial /t/ is aspirated [tʰ] in stressed onset — allophonic, not marked orthographically. [Open: aspiration's phonemic status not committed in phonology.md.]

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5. Changelog

A running record of additions and changes to the dictionary, with dates and any open questions surfaced.

2026-05-24

Batch addition: 36 new entries from drafts/batch-dict-entry-0523.xlsx (51 source rows; some consolidated or deferred). Entries span the b-, e-, h-, n-, o-, p-, r-, rh-, s-, and t-regions. All entries with unresolved phonological steps carry inline [Open] flags; none resolve any existing [Open] items without an explicit decision.

Open questions surfaced (propagate to phonology session): - /v/ conditioning: /v/ → /b/ before back vowels vs. /v/ → /ɾ/ (tap merger) before front vowels — candidate rule, not yet committed. - /ɫ/→/ɻ/ candidate rule: all /l/-initial GA words → /r/-initial headwords, suggesting dark-l vocalization path to /ɻ/ → R-Assim → /ɾ/. - /ɪ/→/ɛ/ after onset: appears in *benskyi*, *béntsıỳ*, *rékwıì* — rule not in §4. - /ə/→/o/ after /n/: flagged in *noê* — rule not in §4. - /aɪ/→/ɛ/ short reflex: third candidate pathway alongside established /eː/ and /i/ reflexes. - /aɪ/→/i/ short reflex: fourth candidate; appears in *récquıìs*, *rıúrǫ*, *rhiwıĩ*. - /ɔɪ/→/oe/: parallel to established bœ/boeś pathway; now attested in *nœ* as well. - /ɜːr/→/ɨː/ vocalization: needed for *rhiušp*; not in §4.4.2. - Coda /t/ retention vs. E2a: *pot*, *rérèyt* show unexpected /t/ retention. - /k/ labialization: coda /k/ absorbing adjacent /w/ → /kʷ/; needed for *piiquóœ*, *piquô*, *récquıìs*. - /s/ in /sp/ cluster: debuccalization blocked? Needed for *spyi*.

New entries (collation order): *barnkw*, *bárkennò*, *bawiiquoh?*, *bayarę*, *bąêų*, *benıûœ*, *benskyi*, *beńt*, *béo·ò*, *bessts*, *béuksoè*, *beušiioskô*, *beusp*, *beųtw*, *bewii·iit*, *bewiipessô*, *beykw*, *bęiink*, *boeś*, *bœ*, *e*, *emmáwwè*, *éuskrıì*, *hohô*, *hóhonìt*, *hœ hoś*, *noê*, *nóeıìe*, *nœ*, *ohô*, *óhò*, *ouś*, *piiquóœ*, *piquô*, *pot*, *récquıìs*, *réıì*, *rékriiyœ*, *rékwıì*, *rérèyt*, *reųś*, *rıúrǫ*, *rhéulyèś*, *rhiušp*, *rhiwıĩ*, *spyi*, *toś*.

Deferred/compound entries (IPA [Open]): *bawiiquoh?*, *bárkennò*, *beušiioskô*, *bewii·iit*, *bewiipessô*, *nocquiie-ŕóųzǫ* (already present).

2026-05-20

Added four negative-system morpheme entries: *ęy*, *nocquıî*, *rhiiy*, *skwkw*. Back-cross-refs to *rhiiy* added to *epplii*, *rhiiynii*, *rhiiysseunnou*.

- **ęy** (ę-region, first ę-entry): VOL.NEG concord reinforcer from GA *any* /eni/. POS: aux. Orthographic decision: glide nasalization in /ẽj̃/ left unmarked — headword *ęy*, not *ęỹ* — on the grounds that nasalization is predictable from the flanking nasalized vowel. [Open: function-word smoothing condition — a lexical word such as *penny* would remain disyllabic; rule not yet in §4.]
- **nocquıî** (n-region, after *nobêt*): LVC.NONVOL.NEG from GA *not quite* /nɑʔ kwaɪʔ/. POS: aux.; also adv. and deriv. prefix. Includes Morphology section for the *nocquii-* prefix. Spelling: cqu for /kʷː/ dictionary-internal pending orthography.md propagation. [Open phonological questions: (1) /ɑ/→/o/ raising-and-rounding — new rule needed. (2) /ʔk/→/kʷː/ junction gemination — new rule needed. (3) coda /ʔ/ drop condition at compound junctions — new rule needed.]
- **rhiiy** (rh-region, first rh-entry — before *rhilþ*): polyfunctional morpheme from GA *really* and *not really*, consolidated as a single lemma. Per-sense etymology adopted as a schema extension for polyfunctional grammaticalized morphemes with divergent source phrases. POS: aux. (general negation and NON-VOL.NEG reinforcer); also deriv. prefix. 4 senses.
- **skwkw** (s-region, first s-entry — between *ŕeut* and *toutw*): LVC.VOL.NEG from GA *skip* /skɪp/. POS: aux.; also adv./substitutional and interj. Derivation flagged as irregular. [Open: foot structure of vowelless

syllabic obstruent.]

- **POS tag decision:** aux. adopted uniformly for all four negative-system markers. Draft source used gram.; not adopted.
- **Headword revision:** *hoiom* → *hoiių̃* (/ˈhoiom/ → /ˈhoiõ/). Phonological development clarified: labial /m/ colors the preceding schwa to /o/ (rather than the expected /ɛ/ from regular strengthening), then /m/ elides leaving nasalization on the vowel. The prior [Open] on the final syllable (§6.2) is resolved for this entry. [Open: labial-coloring-of-schwa + /m/-elision-with-nasalization proposed as a productive rule for all *-ium* endings (*podium*, *Colosseum*, *Liam*); to be formalized in phonology.md in a dedicated session.]
- **Three *nocquii*- compounds** added as stubs (all base words pending): *nocquiiayo* (decaf; base *ayo* "joe/coffee"), *nocquiie-ŕóųzǫ* (Down syndrome; base *ŕóųzǫ* "chromosome"), *nocquiissprıĩ* (the cold false-spring weeks; base *sprıĩ* "spring"). Collation order: nocquiiayo (a) < nocquiie-ŕóųzǫ (e) < nocquiissprıĩ (s). [Open: the *nocquiiayo* headword lacks the linker *-e-* that the *nocquıî* Morphology section predicts before vowel-initial bases — combining-form rule needs reconciling.]

2026-05-19

- Added entry *rhilþ* ("wolf"). Straightforward derivation from GA *wolf* /wʊɫf/; all three sound changes settled (onset /w/ → /ɹ/, /ʊ/ → /ɪ/ by convention, /f/ → /θ/). Coda /l/ preserved in cluster /lθ/ (E2c exempts cluster environments). Foot left [Open] pending resolution of whether coda consonants contribute weight.
- Added entries *béntsıỳ* ("later") and *nobêt* ("soon; in a short while"), cross-referenced as anaphoric/deictic counterparts.
  - **Open phonological questions (*béntsıỳ*):** (1) /v/ → /b/ in onset — §4.4.1 gives general /v/ → /r/; new environment-specific rule proposed. (2) /ɫ/ → /j/ with palatal consonant as left flank — §4.4.1 conditions the rule on both flanks being high front vowels; this extends or replaces that environment.
  - **Open phonological questions (*nobêt*):** (1) /ə/ → /o/ rounding after /n/ — no current rule in §4.4.2. (2) /ɪ/ → /ɛ/ after /b/ — no current rule in §4.4.2.
  - **New orthographic conventions (see §3):** (1) Dotless ı when one element of the ii digraph takes a diacritic — dictionary-internal, pending orthography.md propagation. (2) Stress grave on the vowel element of iiy (the second i) rather than on trailing y, conflicting with orthography.md §3.7 — pending reconciliation. (3) Circumflex used in headwords when pitch and stress coincide (formal-register form), as in *nobêt*.

2026-05-17

- **Schema reformatting.** All existing entries (beussou, epplii, hoiom, hoʔnʔnts, ritsstw, rhiiynii, rhiiysseunnou, ŕe, ŕeut, toutw) converted to the new prosaic format per §1: etymology line with drift folded in, single form line (POS/IPA/foot), compact Sound changes line. Explicit field headers (**GA etymology:**, **Part of speech:**, etc.) and standalone [Drift note: ...] brackets removed. Notes sections stripped of propagation tickets and paradigm-candidate flags; only form-specific observations retained.

- **Schema revision (second pass).** All 10 entries reformatted with: (1) #### Etymology as a labeled section opener; (2) explicit **Part of speech:**, **IPA:**, **Foot:** labels on the form line; (3) Sound changes renamed to Phonological development throughout. Preamble files updated to route all monospace font to Brill (\let\ttfamily\rmfamily), eliminating DejaVu Sans Mono from compiled output.

2026-04-30

- Added entry *ŕe* ("today"; interj. "hurry!"). High-frequency colloquial form with two irregular shifts (onset /t/ → /h/, /eɪ/ → short /ɛ/), neither proposed as a rule.
  - **Open phonology nuance:** the /h/ + tap → /ɾ̥/ coalescence in onset (without M1 metathesis) is plausibly a generalization of the M1 mechanism in phonology.md §4.3 — worth clarifying when phonology is next revised.
  - **Open phonology revision:** phonology.md §8.1 stipulates that degenerate (single-syllable) feet are licensed only if the syllable is heavy; *ŕe*'s light-monosyllabic foot /ˈɾ̥ɛ/ is a counterexample. The minimality clause appears to be an overgeneralization on limited data and should be relaxed when phonology is next revised.
- Added entry *beussou* ("to sleep; to pass out").
- **Schema revision:** renamed "GA etymon" to "GA etymology" in §1, expanding the field to accommodate drift notes and source-construction context. Existing entries (*hoiom*, *hoʔnʔnts*, *ŕeut*, *ritsstw*) updated to use the new bullet label.
- **Orthographic addition:** added §3 note on ss /sː/ as standard geminate spelling, with śś as formal variant. Convention is dictionary-internal pending propagation to orthography.md.
- **Open phonological question:** new rule needed in phonology.md §4.1 for /s/ → /sː/ at syllable boundary preceding stress (vs. default /s/ → /h/).
- **Open phonological question:** environment for /p/ → /b/ in onset to be finalized — current proposal is "before /ɛ/ (and long counterpart), blocked before /i, ɪ, ɑ, o/ and clusters."
- **Open phonological question:** §4.1's "coda /ʔ/ never elides" needs softening to permit lexical exceptions in grammaticalized particles (e.g., GA *out* in phrasal-verb lexicalizations).
- **Open orthographic question:** with s predictably voiceless in onset (since onset s derives only from GA /st/, GA /s/ having debuccalized to /h/), the ś grapheme may be redundant in onset position. Worth verifying against orthography.md whether ś is doing real work outside non-onset environments.
- **Cross-system note:** *beussou* flagged as candidate verb for volition-paradigm illustration (language_reference.md §3.4.2).

2026-05-03

Batch addition of four verbs: *epplii*, *rhiiynii*, *rhiiysseunnou*, *toutw*. Plus collation fix for *ritsstw*.

Entries added:

- Added entry *epplii* ("to spread on; to apply oneself; to apply for"). Three senses inherited from GA *apply*'s polysemy. Sense 2 admits an alternative form *rhiiyepplii* with an rhiiy- intensifier prefix.

- Added entry *rhiiynii* ("to need; to want"). Lexicalizes GA *really need* with a fully-bleached rhiiy- prefix from *really*. The need/want polysemy is a productive cultural/grammatical marker.
- Added entry *rhiiysseunnou* ("to be different; to be excellent"). Lexicalizes GA *really stand out* with the same fully-bleached rhiiy- prefix.
- Added entry *toutw* ("to cost; to amount to"). Lexicalizes GA *to total to* as a single verb.

Collation fix:

- Moved *ritsstw* to its correct position per the alphabet (r < rh < ŕ). It had been incorrectly placed at the end of the entries section (after the ŕ-region); it now sits between the h-region (after *hoʔnʔnts*) and the rh-region (before *rhiiynii*). No content changes to the entry itself.

Open phonological questions surfaced:

- **/iː/ as a phoneme.** orthography.md §3.2 states /iː/ does not occur in the conlang, but *rhiiysseunnou*, *rhiiynii*, and the existing *Emily* derivation in phonology.md §6.1 all attest /iː/ from /ɪji/-smoothing. §3.2 needs revision to admit /iː/ as a phoneme. The orthographic spelling iiy is the working convention for long /iː/, with bare ii reserved for short tense /i/ — this contrast is on display within *rhiiynii* itself (prefix rhiiy /ɻ̊iː-/ vs. stem nii /ni/).
- **/nd/ → /nː/ in coda.** Attested in *rhiiysseunnou*. New rule needed in phonology.md §4: nasal+stop coda cluster simplifies to geminate nasal, by regressive assimilation or compensatory lengthening.
- **Coda /l/ → ∅ outside clusters.** Attested in *toutw*. phonology.md §3.2 implies this diachronic loss (since /l/ "occurs only in clusters") but §4 does not state it explicitly. Should be added or subsumed under E2.
- **Initial unstressed /ə/ → /ɛ/.** Attested in *epplii*. New rule needed in phonology.md §4.2: initial schwa (when not absorbed or elided) strengthens to /ɛ/, paralleling the final-schwa-strengthening pathway already in §4.2.
- **/aɪ/ → short /i/.** Attested in *epplii*. phonology.md §4.2 lists /ai/ → /iː/ ~ /eː/ as conditioning-open; *epplii* adds short /i/ as a third reflex. Conditioning still open — possibly stressed-position-before-geminate, possibly lexically conditioned for high-frequency verbs.
- **Aspiration's phonemic status.** Surfaced by *toutw*'s /ˈtoːtw̥/. Treated as allophonic and orthographically silent (English-style: voiceless stops aspirate in stressed onsets), but not yet committed in phonology.md.

Reused phonological flags from prior changelog entries (no new commitment needed, but worth noting which entries newly attest each rule):

- /st/ → /sː/ at stressed-syllable boundary — first flagged with *beussou*; now also attested in *rhiiysseunnou*.
- Coda /ʔ/ drop in lexicalized *out* — first flagged with *beussou*; now also attested in *rhiiysseunnou*.
- /ɫ/ → /j/ between high front vowels — implicit in the *Emily* derivation in phonology.md §6.1; now explicitly attested in *rhiiynii* and *rhiiysseunnou* as a regular rule.

Open orthographic questions surfaced:

- **Geminate-doubling generalization.** Dictionary §3 currently licenses ss for /sː/ only. This batch generalizes the principle: nn for /nː/ (in *rhiiysseunnou*), pp for /pː/ (in *epplii*). The unified rule — "doubled consonants represent geminates" — should be propagated to orthography.md §2.
- **eu digraph unification across two diachronic sources.** orthography.md §3.2 lists eu as the smoothed-

schwa pathway for long /ɛː/ only. *rhiiysseunnou* attests a second pathway: /æ/-with-preserved-duration before nasals, where GA's tense-lax distinction is reanalyzed as length. The orthography unifies both sources under eu. Worth recording in orthography.md as a single graphemic rule with two etymological feeds.

- **Spelling convention for /iː/ vs. short tense /i/.** Working rule (from this batch): long /iː/ is iiy where there's an etymologically-justified glide source, and bare ii is short tense /i/. The contrast is on display in *rhiiynii*. To be confirmed when orthography.md §3.2 is revised.

Cross-system notes:

- *rhiiysseunnou*, *rhiiynii*, and *epplii* (sense 2) all flagged as volition-paradigm candidates (language_reference.md §3.4.2), joining *beussou*. The growing set of volition-relevant verbs is starting to anchor the eventual paradigm illustration.
- The rhiiy- prefix from bleached *really* shows productive stratification across the lexicon: fully bleached/lexicalized in *rhiiysseunnou* and *rhiiynii*, still functionally an intensifier in *rhiiyepplii*. This is a good candidate for a future grammatical note in language_reference.md on incomplete grammaticalization as a productive design feature.